

DATA PROTECTION & PRIVACY POLICY

(GDPR-Aligned)

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1. Purpose

1.1 Purpose of the Policy

The **Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX** recognizes that the protection of personal data and respect for the privacy of individuals are fundamental rights and essential components of good governance, ethical conduct, organizational integrity, and public trust.

As a non-profit organization committed to digital transformation, education, research, innovation, community development, and international cooperation, ADP routinely processes personal data relating to its members, employees, volunteers, consultants, donors, beneficiaries, project participants, partners, website users, and other stakeholders. The organization acknowledges its responsibility to ensure that such data are processed lawfully, fairly, transparently, securely, and with full respect for the rights and freedoms of individuals.

The purpose of this Data Protection & Privacy Policy is to establish a comprehensive framework governing the collection, use, storage, sharing, retention, protection, and disposal of personal data processed by ADP in all organizational activities. The Policy also defines the responsibilities of individuals working on behalf of ADP and establishes common standards for privacy management across all departments, projects, digital platforms, and operational processes.

This Policy seeks to ensure that personal data are processed only for legitimate and clearly defined purposes, that only the minimum amount of information necessary is collected, and that appropriate technical and organizational safeguards are implemented throughout the entire data lifecycle.

ADP further recognizes that responsible management of personal information is not merely a legal obligation but an ethical commitment that strengthens transparency, accountability, institutional credibility, and stakeholder confidence.

1.2 Objectives

The objectives of this Policy are to:

- ensure compliance with applicable data protection legislation, including the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the personal data protection laws applicable in the Republic of North Macedonia;

- protect the privacy, dignity, and fundamental rights of all individuals whose personal data are processed by ADP;
 - establish consistent organizational standards for collecting, processing, storing, transferring, sharing, retaining, and securely disposing of personal data;
 - define clear roles, responsibilities, and accountability for all personnel, volunteers, contractors, consultants, and partners involved in personal data processing activities;
 - integrate privacy considerations into organizational governance, project management, procurement, research activities, digital services, and information systems;
 - promote the principles of Privacy by Design and Privacy by Default throughout the planning, implementation, and operation of all projects, services, and digital platforms;
 - ensure that appropriate security measures are implemented to protect personal data against accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration, unauthorized disclosure, or unauthorized access;
 - establish procedures for managing personal data breaches, responding to data subject requests, and maintaining regulatory compliance;
 - support ethical and responsible use of Artificial Intelligence technologies involving personal data in accordance with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
 - promote transparency and strengthen trust among beneficiaries, donors, funding agencies, partners, employees, volunteers, researchers, and the wider public.
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1.3 Organizational Commitment

ADP is committed to maintaining the highest standards of privacy and data protection across all of its operations.

The organization shall:

- process personal data only when there is a lawful basis for doing so;
- implement risk-based technical and organizational measures appropriate to the sensitivity of the information being processed;
- continuously improve its privacy management practices through regular reviews, internal audits, staff training, and lessons learned;
- ensure that every new project, information system, research activity, digital service, or technological innovation considers privacy risks from the earliest stages of planning;
- foster a culture in which every employee, volunteer, consultant, Board member, and project partner understands that protecting personal data is a shared organizational responsibility rather than solely an information technology function.

ADP considers privacy protection to be an integral component of ethical governance, digital responsibility, cybersecurity, research integrity, and organizational sustainability.

1.4 Relationship with Other ADP Policies

This Policy shall be read and implemented together with the following organizational documents:

- Statute of the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX;
- Code of Ethics;
- Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;

- Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy;
- Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy;
- Safeguarding & Protection Policy;
- Conflict of Interest Policy;
- Risk Management Policy;
- Project Management Manual;
- Financial Management Manual;
- Procurement Rules;
- Communication & Media Policy;
- HR & Volunteer Handbook; and
- any additional internal procedures, guidelines, or standards adopted by ADP from time to time.

Where two or more policies apply simultaneously, they shall be interpreted in a complementary manner to provide the highest level of protection for personal data, information security, and the rights of individuals.

2. Scope

2.1 Purpose of the Scope

This Policy applies to all personal data processed by the **Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX** regardless of the format in which the information is collected, stored, transmitted, or processed.

The Policy establishes minimum mandatory requirements for all organizational activities involving personal data and applies equally to traditional paper-based records, electronic information systems, cloud services, mobile applications, websites, research databases, artificial intelligence systems, and any other technologies used by ADP.

Compliance with this Policy is mandatory for every person acting on behalf of ADP.

2.2 Organizational Scope

This Policy applies to every organizational unit and operational activity carried out by ADP.

The Policy covers:

- the Board of Directors;
- the Executive Director;
- permanent and temporary employees;
- volunteers;
- interns;
- consultants;
- project managers;
- researchers;

- trainers and educators;
- IT administrators;
- communications and media personnel;
- finance and administrative staff;
- external contractors;
- partner organizations acting on behalf of ADP;
- service providers processing personal data under contractual arrangements.

Where external organizations process personal data on behalf of ADP, appropriate contractual safeguards shall be established before any processing activities commence.

2.3 Operational Scope

This Policy applies throughout the complete lifecycle of personal data.

The requirements apply to activities including, but not limited to:

- collection;
- recording;
- organization;
- structuring;
- storage;
- adaptation;
- updating;
- consultation;
- retrieval;
- analysis;
- sharing;
- transmission;
- publication where legally justified;
- anonymization;
- pseudonymization;
- archiving;
- secure destruction.

The Policy applies regardless of whether processing is performed manually or through automated systems.

2.4 Categories of Activities Covered

This Policy applies to all ADP activities, including:

Governance

- organizational administration;
- Board operations;
- membership management;
- strategic planning.

Human Resources

- recruitment;
- employment administration;
- volunteer management;
- internship programmes;
- performance management;
- payroll administration.

Projects

- Erasmus+ projects;
- Horizon Europe projects;
- IPA projects;
- Interreg projects;
- research projects;
- community development initiatives;
- humanitarian programmes;
- educational activities;
- digital transformation initiatives.

Training and Education

- participant registration;
- attendance records;
- certification;
- examinations;
- online learning platforms;
- webinars;
- workshops.

Research

- surveys;
- questionnaires;
- interviews;
- scientific studies;
- statistical analysis;
- anonymized datasets;
- AI-assisted research.

Communication

- newsletters;
- mailing lists;
- media relations;
- event registrations;
- social media management;
- website administration.

Financial Operations

- donor management;
- grant administration;

- accounting;
 - procurement;
 - vendor management;
 - reimbursement procedures.
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2.5 Information Assets Covered

This Policy applies to all information assets containing personal data, including:

- paper documents;
 - personnel files;
 - membership records;
 - volunteer files;
 - project documentation;
 - research databases;
 - financial records;
 - contracts;
 - photographs;
 - videos;
 - audio recordings;
 - attendance lists;
 - email communications;
 - cloud storage;
 - backup systems;
 - portable storage devices;
 - laptops;
 - desktop computers;
 - smartphones;
 - servers;
 - collaboration platforms;
 - customer relationship management systems (CRM);
 - learning management systems (LMS);
 - project management software;
 - artificial intelligence platforms authorized by ADP.
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2.6 Individuals Covered

This Policy protects the personal data of all identifiable individuals whose information is processed by ADP.

This includes, but is not limited to:

- members;
- employees;
- volunteers;
- interns;
- consultants;
- job applicants;

- donors;
 - beneficiaries;
 - children and young people;
 - parents and guardians;
 - researchers;
 - trainers;
 - project participants;
 - suppliers;
 - contractors;
 - website visitors;
 - event participants;
 - public officials;
 - representatives of partner organizations;
 - any other identifiable natural person interacting with ADP.
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2.7 Geographical Scope

This Policy applies irrespective of the physical location where personal data are processed.

Accordingly, the Policy covers processing activities carried out:

- within the Republic of North Macedonia;
- within Member States of the European Union;
- during international projects;
- through international cloud service providers;
- during international conferences;
- during study visits;
- during training programmes abroad;
- by remote employees and volunteers;
- by international project partners acting on behalf of ADP.

Whenever personal data are transferred across national borders, such transfers shall comply with applicable legal requirements and the safeguards established under Chapter 13 of this Policy.

2.8 Digital Environment

This Policy applies to all digital environments operated or used by ADP, including:

- official websites;
- mobile applications;
- learning platforms;
- cloud infrastructure;
- collaboration tools;
- document management systems;
- project management software;
- AI-enabled services;
- electronic communication platforms;
- email systems;

- online forms;
 - electronic signature systems;
 - databases;
 - application programming interfaces (APIs);
 - analytics services;
 - digital archives.
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2.9 Exclusions

This Policy does not apply to:

- personal activities performed by individuals entirely outside ADP operations;
- information that has been irreversibly anonymized and can no longer identify an individual;
- publicly available information where no personal data processing is carried out by ADP;
- information processed exclusively for household or private purposes by individuals acting in their personal capacity.

Nevertheless, whenever uncertainty exists regarding whether information constitutes personal data, ADP shall apply the precautionary principle and treat the information as protected until an appropriate assessment has been completed.

2.10 Policy Applicability

Compliance with this Policy is a mandatory condition for employment, volunteering, consultancy, project participation, and contractual cooperation with ADP.

Failure to comply with this Policy may result in:

- disciplinary action;
- suspension of access to organizational systems;
- termination of contractual relationships;
- financial liability where permitted by law;
- reporting to competent supervisory authorities where required;
- other corrective measures deemed appropriate by ADP.

Every individual covered by this Policy shares responsibility for protecting personal data and maintaining the trust placed in ADP by its members, beneficiaries, partners, donors, and the wider public.

3. Legal and Regulatory Framework

Chapter 3 – Legal and Regulatory Framework

3.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to ensuring that all processing of personal data is conducted in accordance with applicable legal, regulatory, contractual, and ethical requirements.

This Policy establishes a governance framework aligned with internationally recognized privacy principles and reflects ADP's commitment to protecting the rights and freedoms of individuals whose personal data are processed through its activities.

Compliance with applicable data protection legislation is considered a minimum organizational requirement. Where different legal standards apply, ADP shall implement the highest level of protection reasonably applicable to the specific processing activity.

3.2 Primary Legislation

ADP shall conduct all personal data processing activities in accordance with the following primary legal instruments.

3.2.1 General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)

The **General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679)** serves as the principal reference framework for this Policy.

Although ADP is established in the Republic of North Macedonia, many of its activities involve cooperation with institutions, funding bodies, universities, research organizations, civil society organizations, donors, technology providers, and individuals located within the European Union.

Accordingly, ADP voluntarily aligns its internal governance framework with the principles and requirements of the GDPR in order to:

- promote internationally recognized best practices;
- facilitate participation in European Union funded programmes;
- strengthen trust among international partners;
- ensure high standards of privacy protection;
- improve organizational accountability.

The GDPR principles contained within this Policy shall be applied wherever appropriate, even where national legislation provides less detailed procedural requirements.

3.2.2 Personal Data Protection Law of the Republic of North Macedonia

ADP shall comply with all applicable provisions of the **Law on Personal Data Protection** of the Republic of North Macedonia, together with all implementing regulations, official guidance, and decisions issued by the competent supervisory authority.

Where national legislation imposes stricter obligations than those contained within this Policy, the requirements of national legislation shall prevail.

3.2.3 Convention 108+

ADP supports the principles established by the Council of Europe Convention for the Protection of Individuals with regard to Automatic Processing of Personal Data (Convention 108+).

The organization recognizes Convention 108+ as an important international instrument promoting:

- human dignity;
 - privacy;
 - transparency;
 - accountability;
 - cross-border cooperation;
 - lawful international data transfers.
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3.3 Other Applicable Legal Requirements

Depending on the nature of specific projects, ADP may also be required to comply with additional legal or contractual obligations arising from:

- European Union legislation;
- national legislation of partner countries;
- international cooperation agreements;
- donor requirements;
- grant agreements;
- contractual obligations;
- research ethics approvals;
- public procurement regulations;
- employment legislation;
- tax and accounting legislation;
- safeguarding regulations relating to children and vulnerable persons.

Project managers shall identify applicable legal requirements during project planning and ensure that adequate privacy measures are incorporated before personal data processing begins.

3.4 European Union Funding Requirements

Many ADP activities are financed or co-financed through European and international funding programmes.

Accordingly, this Policy supports compliance with privacy obligations commonly required by programmes such as:

- Erasmus+;
- Horizon Europe;
- Interreg;
- IPA III;
- Creative Europe;
- Digital Europe Programme;
- European Solidarity Corps;
- CERV (Citizens, Equality, Rights and Values Programme);
- EU4Health;

- LIFE Programme;
- European Social Fund Plus (where applicable);
- United Nations development programmes;
- Council of Europe projects;
- bilateral development assistance programmes.

Where funding agreements establish privacy or security obligations exceeding those contained in this Policy, the stricter contractual requirements shall apply.

3.5 International Standards and Best Practices

In addition to legal compliance, ADP seeks alignment with internationally recognized standards and good practices, including:

- ISO/IEC 27001 — Information Security Management Systems;
- ISO/IEC 27701 — Privacy Information Management Systems;
- ISO/IEC 27002 — Information Security Controls;
- ISO 31000 — Risk Management;
- ISO 9001 — Quality Management;
- ISO 37301 — Compliance Management Systems;
- OECD Privacy Guidelines;
- OECD AI Principles;
- NIST Privacy Framework;
- NIST Cybersecurity Framework;
- United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (where applicable to organizational activities).

These standards provide guidance for continuous improvement but do not replace applicable legal obligations.

3.6 Regulatory Authorities

ADP shall cooperate openly and transparently with competent supervisory authorities responsible for personal data protection.

The organization shall:

- respond promptly to lawful requests for information;
- facilitate inspections where legally required;
- report personal data breaches when mandatory;
- implement corrective measures arising from regulatory decisions;
- maintain accurate documentation demonstrating compliance.

Employees shall immediately notify the Executive Director or designated privacy representative upon receiving any formal communication from a supervisory authority.

3.7 Relationship with Internal ADP Policies

This Policy forms part of ADP's integrated governance framework and shall be interpreted together with other organizational policies.

In particular, this Policy complements:

- Code of Ethics;
- Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
- Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy;
- Safeguarding & Protection Policy;
- Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy;
- Conflict of Interest Policy;
- Risk Management Policy;
- Project Management Manual;
- Financial Management Manual;
- Procurement Rules;
- Communication & Media Policy;
- HR & Volunteer Handbook.

Where multiple policies apply simultaneously, they shall be interpreted consistently to provide the highest practicable level of protection for personal data, organizational information assets, and the rights of individuals.

3.8 Compliance Responsibility

Every individual acting on behalf of ADP shares responsibility for ensuring compliance with this Policy and with applicable data protection legislation.

Managers shall ensure that:

- privacy obligations are incorporated into operational procedures;
- personnel receive appropriate training;
- privacy risks are assessed before new processing activities commence;
- documented evidence of compliance is maintained;
- corrective actions are implemented where deficiencies are identified.

Compliance with data protection requirements is considered an essential component of organizational governance, ethical leadership, digital responsibility, and institutional accountability.

- GDPR (EU Regulation 2016/679)
- North Macedonia Personal Data Protection Law
- Council of Europe Convention 108+
- Relevant EU Directives
- Other Applicable Requirements

4. Definitions

4.1 Purpose

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a common understanding of the terminology used throughout this Policy.

Unless otherwise required by applicable legislation, the following definitions shall apply to all ADP activities involving personal data.

Where a definition in applicable law differs from the definitions contained in this Policy, the legal definition shall prevail.

4.2 Personal Data

Personal Data means any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person ("Data Subject").

A person is considered identifiable where they can be identified directly or indirectly, particularly by reference to an identifier such as:

- name;
- surname;
- personal identification number;
- passport number;
- employee number;
- student identification number;
- membership number;
- postal address;
- email address;
- telephone number;
- online identifier;
- IP address;
- cookie identifier;
- location data;
- biometric identifier;
- photograph;
- video recording;
- voice recording;
- or any combination of information capable of identifying an individual.

Personal data may exist in electronic, paper-based, photographic, audio, video, or any other form.

4.3 Data Subject

A **Data Subject** is any living natural person whose personal data are processed by ADP.

Examples include:

- members;
- employees;
- volunteers;

- interns;
 - consultants;
 - trainers;
 - researchers;
 - donors;
 - beneficiaries;
 - project participants;
 - students;
 - children;
 - parents or guardians;
 - website visitors;
 - suppliers acting as sole traders;
 - representatives of partner organizations.
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4.4 Special Categories of Personal Data

Special Categories of Personal Data (sometimes referred to as **Sensitive Personal Data**) include information revealing:

- racial or ethnic origin;
- political opinions;
- religious or philosophical beliefs;
- trade union membership;
- genetic data;
- biometric data used for unique identification;
- health information;
- disability status;
- sexual orientation;
- information concerning a person's sex life.

ADP shall process such information only where a lawful basis exists and additional safeguards have been implemented.

Processing of special categories of personal data shall be subject to enhanced security controls.

4.5 Processing

Processing means any operation performed on personal data, whether by automated means or not.

Processing includes, but is not limited to:

- collection;
- recording;
- organization;
- storage;
- consultation;
- adaptation;
- modification;
- retrieval;

- analysis;
 - use;
 - disclosure;
 - transmission;
 - publication;
 - restriction;
 - anonymization;
 - pseudonymization;
 - archiving;
 - deletion;
 - destruction.
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4.6 Data Controller

A **Data Controller** is the natural or legal person that determines the purposes and means of processing personal data.

For the purposes of this Policy, the **Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX** generally acts as the Data Controller for personal data processed within its own activities.

4.7 Data Processor

A **Data Processor** is a natural or legal person that processes personal data on behalf of the Data Controller.

Examples include:

- cloud service providers;
- website hosting companies;
- payroll providers;
- accounting service providers;
- IT maintenance contractors;
- learning management system providers;
- survey platforms;
- email service providers;
- external consultants processing personal data.

All processors shall operate under written contractual arrangements containing appropriate data protection obligations.

4.8 Joint Controllers

Joint Controllers are two or more organizations that jointly determine the purposes and means of processing personal data.

This may occur during:

- joint research projects;

- Erasmus+ partnerships;
- Horizon Europe projects;
- international consortiums;
- shared digital platforms;
- collaborative educational initiatives.

Where joint controllership exists, responsibilities shall be documented in writing.

4.9 Consent

Consent means:

any freely given, specific, informed and unambiguous indication of the Data Subject's wishes by which they signify agreement to the processing of their personal data through a clear affirmative action.

Consent shall:

- be voluntary;
- be informed;
- be understandable;
- be documented where appropriate;
- be capable of being withdrawn at any time.

Silence, inactivity, or pre-ticked boxes shall not constitute valid consent.

4.10 Legitimate Interest

Legitimate Interest refers to a lawful basis for processing personal data where:

- ADP has a genuine organizational interest;
- the processing is necessary;
- the interests or fundamental rights of the Data Subject do not override that interest.

Whenever Legitimate Interest is relied upon, ADP shall conduct an appropriate balancing assessment.

4.11 Profiling

Profiling means any automated processing used to evaluate personal aspects relating to an individual.

Examples include automated evaluation of:

- educational performance;
- participation trends;
- digital engagement;
- project statistics;
- learning analytics.

ADP shall not use profiling to make decisions producing legal or similarly significant effects without appropriate safeguards.

4.12 Automated Decision-Making

Automated Decision-Making refers to decisions made solely by automated systems without meaningful human involvement.

As a general organizational principle, ADP does not rely exclusively on automated decision-making where such decisions may significantly affect individuals.

Meaningful human oversight shall always be maintained.

4.13 Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Artificial Intelligence refers to computational systems capable of assisting in tasks such as:

- data analysis;
- language processing;
- image processing;
- document classification;
- educational support;
- predictive analytics;
- research assistance;
- administrative automation.

Use of AI involving personal data shall comply with:

- this Policy;
 - the Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
 - applicable legal requirements;
 - human oversight principles.
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4.14 Pseudonymisation

Pseudonymisation means processing personal data in such a manner that the information can no longer be attributed to a specific individual without additional information.

The additional identifying information shall be:

- stored separately;
- encrypted where appropriate;
- subject to strict access controls.

Pseudonymised data remain personal data under applicable legislation.

4.15 Anonymisation

Anonymisation means the irreversible removal of identifying elements so that an individual can no longer be identified by any reasonably available means.

Properly anonymised information is no longer considered personal data.

ADP shall verify that anonymisation cannot reasonably be reversed before treating datasets as anonymous.

4.16 Personal Data Breach

A Personal Data Breach means any security incident leading to:

- accidental destruction;
- unlawful destruction;
- loss;
- alteration;
- unauthorized disclosure;
- unauthorized access;
- accidental publication;
- accidental transmission;
- unauthorized availability

of personal data.

Not every cybersecurity incident constitutes a personal data breach, but every suspected breach shall be assessed promptly.

4.17 Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)

A DPIA is a structured process used to identify, evaluate, and reduce privacy risks before commencing high-risk personal data processing activities.

A DPIA shall normally be required where processing involves:

- children;
 - vulnerable persons;
 - large-scale processing;
 - innovative technologies;
 - artificial intelligence;
 - biometric information;
 - systematic monitoring;
 - high-risk research activities.
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4.18 Privacy by Design

Privacy by Design means incorporating privacy and data protection measures into the planning, development, procurement, implementation, and operation of systems, services, and projects from the earliest possible stage.

Privacy considerations shall not be treated as an afterthought.

4.19 Privacy by Default

Privacy by Default requires that information systems and organizational processes automatically apply the highest practical level of privacy protection unless an alternative setting is demonstrably necessary and lawful.

Only the minimum amount of personal data necessary for a defined purpose shall be processed by default.

4.20 Data Protection Officer (DPO)

Where required by applicable legislation or deemed appropriate by the Board of Directors, ADP may designate a **Data Protection Officer (DPO)**.

The DPO shall:

- monitor compliance;
- advise management;
- support DPIAs;
- provide staff guidance;
- cooperate with supervisory authorities;
- monitor privacy risks;
- promote continuous improvement.

Where no formal DPO has been appointed, the Executive Director shall designate an appropriate individual or function to coordinate privacy compliance responsibilities.

5. Data Protection Principles

5.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that effective protection of personal data begins with adherence to a set of fundamental principles that govern every stage of the data lifecycle.

These principles provide the foundation for all organizational decisions involving the collection, use, storage, sharing, retention, and disposal of personal data.

Every employee, volunteer, consultant, contractor, researcher, and partner acting on behalf of ADP shall ensure that personal data are processed in accordance with these principles.

Compliance with these principles shall be considered mandatory irrespective of the technology, project, or legal basis for processing.

5.2 Principle of Lawfulness, Fairness and Transparency

All personal data shall be processed lawfully, fairly, and in a transparent manner.

ADP shall ensure that:

- every processing activity has a valid legal basis;
- individuals understand why their data are collected;
- privacy information is presented in clear and understandable language;
- misleading or deceptive processing practices are prohibited;
- hidden or undisclosed processing activities are not permitted;
- individuals are informed of their rights before or at the time their personal data are collected.

Transparency shall be maintained throughout the entire lifecycle of personal data processing.

5.3 Principle of Purpose Limitation

Personal data shall be collected only for specific, explicit, and legitimate purposes.

ADP shall not process personal data for purposes incompatible with the original reason for collection unless:

- a new lawful basis exists;
- additional consent has been obtained where required;
- processing is authorized by applicable law.

Every project, database, application, and information system shall clearly document the purpose for which personal data are processed.

Mission expansion shall never justify unnecessary expansion of personal data processing.

5.4 Principle of Data Minimisation

Only the minimum amount of personal data necessary to achieve a legitimate purpose shall be collected and processed.

Before collecting any information, ADP personnel shall consider:

- Is this information genuinely necessary?
- Can the objective be achieved with less data?
- Can anonymised or pseudonymised information be used instead?
- Is every requested field essential?

Data collection forms shall be reviewed periodically to eliminate unnecessary personal information.

Collecting information "just in case it may be useful in the future" is prohibited unless supported by a lawful and documented purpose.

5.5 Principle of Accuracy

Personal data shall be accurate, complete where necessary, and kept up to date.

ADP shall implement procedures to:

- verify information before use where appropriate;
- allow individuals to request corrections;
- update outdated records;
- remove duplicated records;
- correct identified inaccuracies without undue delay.

Where inaccurate information may significantly affect an individual, correction shall be treated as a priority.

5.6 Principle of Storage Limitation

Personal data shall not be retained longer than necessary.

Retention periods shall be determined according to:

- legal obligations;
- contractual requirements;
- donor requirements;
- research ethics requirements;
- financial regulations;
- operational necessity.

Upon expiry of the applicable retention period, personal data shall be:

- securely deleted;
- permanently anonymised; or
- archived where legally required.

Retention periods shall be documented within the ADP Data Retention Schedule.

5.7 Principle of Integrity and Confidentiality

Personal data shall be protected against unauthorized or unlawful processing and against accidental loss, destruction, or damage.

ADP shall implement appropriate technical and organizational measures including:

- access controls;
- strong authentication;
- encryption where appropriate;
- secure backup procedures;
- logging and monitoring;
- malware protection;
- physical security;
- secure disposal of records;

- cybersecurity awareness training.

Every individual processing personal data shares responsibility for maintaining confidentiality.

5.8 Principle of Accountability

ADP accepts responsibility for demonstrating compliance with applicable privacy legislation.

Accordingly, the organization shall maintain documented evidence of compliance, including:

- policies;
- procedures;
- processing records;
- training records;
- risk assessments;
- DPIAs;
- consent records;
- breach registers;
- audit reports;
- corrective action records.

Compliance shall be demonstrable at all times.

The absence of documentation may be treated as evidence of inadequate compliance.

5.9 Principle of Privacy by Design

Privacy considerations shall be incorporated into every new:

- project;
- research activity;
- website;
- software application;
- database;
- procurement activity;
- digital service;
- AI implementation;
- organizational process.

Privacy requirements shall be considered during planning rather than after implementation.

Project managers shall identify privacy risks before collecting personal data.

5.10 Principle of Privacy by Default

Systems developed, procured, or operated by ADP shall automatically apply privacy-protective settings.

By default:

- only necessary data shall be collected;
- unnecessary user tracking shall be disabled;
- optional data fields shall remain optional;
- personal profiles shall not be publicly visible unless explicitly authorized;
- access permissions shall follow the principle of least privilege.

Users shall not be required to reduce their privacy in order to access ordinary organizational services.

5.11 Principle of Security by Design

Information security shall be integrated into every stage of system development and operation.

Security controls shall be considered during:

- procurement;
- software development;
- cloud migration;
- AI deployment;
- infrastructure planning;
- project implementation;
- database design.

Privacy and cybersecurity shall be treated as complementary organizational responsibilities.

5.12 Principle of Human Oversight

Where automated systems or Artificial Intelligence are used to process personal data, meaningful human oversight shall always be maintained.

ADP shall ensure that:

- automated systems support rather than replace human judgment;
- individuals may request human review where appropriate;
- AI outputs are verified before significant decisions are made;
- staff understand the limitations of automated systems.

Human accountability shall never be delegated entirely to technology.

5.13 Principle of Ethical Processing

ADP recognizes that lawful processing alone is not always sufficient.

All processing activities shall also be:

- ethical;
- proportionate;
- respectful;
- socially responsible;
- consistent with the values of the organization.

Personal data shall never be processed in ways that may unfairly discriminate against, exploit, stigmatize, or unjustifiably disadvantage individuals.

Special care shall be exercised when processing data relating to:

- children;
 - vulnerable persons;
 - minority communities;
 - persons with disabilities;
 - research participants.
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5.14 Principle of Continuous Improvement

Privacy management is an ongoing organizational process.

ADP shall regularly:

- review this Policy;
- assess privacy risks;
- conduct internal audits;
- monitor legal developments;
- evaluate new technologies;
- update procedures;
- strengthen technical safeguards;
- improve staff awareness.

Lessons learned from audits, incidents, complaints, and completed projects shall be incorporated into future improvements.

5.15 Organizational Commitment

The principles established in this chapter apply to every processing activity undertaken by ADP.

Every organizational decision involving personal data shall be capable of demonstrating compliance with these principles.

Where uncertainty exists regarding the appropriate handling of personal data, ADP personnel shall apply the principle that provides the **highest reasonable level of protection** for the rights, freedoms, and legitimate interests of the Data Subject until appropriate guidance has been obtained.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

6.1 Purpose

Effective protection of personal data requires clearly defined responsibilities at every level of the organization.

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that privacy protection is not solely an Information Technology function but a shared organizational responsibility involving leadership, management, employees, volunteers, project teams, researchers, contractors, and external partners.

Every individual acting on behalf of ADP shall understand their responsibilities before accessing or processing personal data.

6.2 Organizational Accountability

ADP shall establish and maintain an organizational governance structure that promotes lawful, ethical, secure, and transparent processing of personal data.

The organization shall ensure that:

- responsibilities are clearly assigned;
- sufficient resources are allocated to privacy management;
- management demonstrates leadership and commitment;
- privacy responsibilities are integrated into operational procedures;
- accountability is documented and periodically reviewed.

Responsibility for privacy cannot be delegated entirely to external service providers or technology solutions.

6.3 Board of Directors

The Board of Directors bears ultimate responsibility for organizational governance relating to data protection and privacy.

The Board shall:

- approve this Policy and any major revisions;
- promote a culture of ethical data governance;
- ensure adequate organizational resources for privacy compliance;
- oversee strategic privacy risks;
- review significant data protection incidents;
- ensure that privacy considerations are integrated into organizational strategy;
- appoint a Data Protection Officer (where legally required or organizationally appropriate);
- monitor overall compliance through periodic reporting.

The Board may delegate operational responsibilities but retains ultimate governance accountability.

6.4 Executive Director

The Executive Director is responsible for the implementation and day-to-day management of this Policy.

Responsibilities include:

- ensuring organizational compliance;
- assigning operational responsibilities;

- approving privacy procedures;
- ensuring adequate staff training;
- promoting continuous improvement;
- supporting internal audits;
- ensuring timely response to regulatory authorities;
- ensuring corrective actions are implemented;
- overseeing organizational privacy risks.

The Executive Director shall ensure that privacy considerations are incorporated into organizational planning and decision-making.

6.5 Managers and Project Leaders

Managers, department heads, and project managers are responsible for ensuring that privacy requirements are implemented within their respective areas.

They shall:

- identify personal data processing activities;
- determine lawful processing purposes;
- ensure only necessary data are collected;
- conduct privacy risk assessments where appropriate;
- ensure team members receive adequate guidance;
- approve access permissions according to operational needs;
- report suspected privacy incidents without delay;
- ensure project documentation complies with this Policy.

Every new project involving personal data shall undergo an initial privacy assessment before implementation.

6.6 Employees

Every employee of ADP has an individual responsibility to protect personal data.

Employees shall:

- process personal data only where authorized;
- comply with this Policy and related procedures;
- maintain confidentiality;
- protect passwords and authentication credentials;
- prevent unauthorized disclosure;
- report security incidents immediately;
- participate in mandatory privacy training;
- cooperate during internal investigations;
- avoid collecting unnecessary personal information.

Employees shall not disclose personal data to unauthorized persons even after their employment has ended.

Confidentiality obligations continue beyond termination of employment.

6.7 Volunteers

Volunteers frequently interact with beneficiaries, participants, and communities.

Accordingly, volunteers shall:

- receive appropriate privacy guidance before commencing activities;
- process personal data only under authorized supervision;
- protect confidential information;
- avoid storing organizational data on personal devices unless specifically authorized;
- immediately report suspected incidents;
- return or securely destroy organizational records at the end of assignments.

Volunteer access to personal data shall be limited to what is necessary for assigned responsibilities.

6.8 Researchers

Researchers conducting studies under ADP shall ensure that personal data are processed ethically and lawfully.

Researchers shall:

- obtain necessary approvals before data collection;
- ensure informed consent where required;
- minimize personal data collection;
- anonymize research data whenever possible;
- protect research participants;
- securely store research datasets;
- comply with applicable research ethics requirements;
- cooperate with institutional ethics committees where appropriate.

Publication of research shall not compromise participant privacy.

6.9 Information Technology Administrator

The IT Administrator plays a key role in maintaining secure processing environments.

Responsibilities include:

- implementing technical safeguards;
- maintaining secure infrastructure;
- managing user accounts;
- monitoring system access;
- maintaining backup systems;
- supporting encryption technologies;
- applying security updates;
- monitoring cybersecurity threats;
- assisting investigations following privacy incidents.

The IT Administrator shall not access personal data unless required for legitimate operational purposes.

Administrative privileges shall be used only where necessary.

6.10 Communications and Media Personnel

Personnel responsible for communication activities shall ensure that publication of personal information complies with this Policy.

They shall:

- verify publication permissions;
- respect consent requirements;
- ensure appropriate use of photographs and videos;
- avoid unnecessary disclosure;
- coordinate with project managers regarding publicity obligations;
- ensure website privacy notices remain current.

Special care shall be taken when publishing photographs or information relating to children and vulnerable persons.

6.11 External Contractors and Service Providers

Organizations processing personal data on behalf of ADP shall:

- sign appropriate contractual agreements;
- comply with applicable privacy legislation;
- implement appropriate security measures;
- notify ADP of personal data breaches without undue delay;
- cooperate during audits where contractually agreed;
- return or securely destroy personal data following completion of services.

No contractor shall process personal data beyond the scope defined within contractual arrangements.

6.12 Partner Organizations

Where projects are implemented jointly with partner organizations, responsibilities for data protection shall be clearly documented before personal data processing begins.

Written agreements shall specify:

- processing purposes;
- legal basis;
- security responsibilities;
- breach notification procedures;
- retention responsibilities;
- data subject rights management;

- international transfer arrangements where applicable.

6.13 Data Protection Officer (DPO)

Where appointed, the Data Protection Officer shall operate independently.

The DPO shall:

- advise management;
- monitor compliance;
- support DPIAs;
- provide privacy guidance;
- monitor legal developments;
- coordinate with supervisory authorities;
- support staff training;
- review internal procedures;
- assist during investigations.

The DPO shall perform duties without conflict of interest.

Where no formal DPO has been appointed, these responsibilities shall be assigned to a designated Privacy Coordinator or another competent individual appointed by the Executive Director.

6.14 Every Individual's Responsibility

Every person processing personal data on behalf of ADP shall:

- act honestly;
- protect confidentiality;
- process only necessary information;
- follow approved procedures;
- immediately report concerns;
- seek guidance when uncertain;
- participate in training;
- contribute to continual improvement.

Failure to report known privacy risks may itself constitute a breach of organizational responsibilities.

6.15 Responsibility Matrix

To ensure clarity and accountability, ADP shall maintain a documented **Responsibility Matrix (RACI Model)** identifying the roles responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed for key privacy-related activities.

The matrix shall include, at a minimum:

Activity	Board	Executive Director	Project Manager	IT Administrator	DPO/Privacy Coordinator	Staff
Policy approval	A	C	I	I	C	I

Privacy compliance	A	A	R	R	R	R
Data breach response	I	A	R	R	R	R
DPIA	I	A	R	C	R	C
Staff training	I	A	C	C	R	R
Access control	I	A	C	R	C	R
Internal audits	A	R	C	C	R	C

Legend:

- **A – Accountable:** Ultimately answerable for the activity.
- **R – Responsible:** Performs or implements the activity.
- **C – Consulted:** Provides input before decisions or actions.
- **I – Informed:** Kept informed of progress or outcomes.

The Responsibility Matrix shall be reviewed periodically and updated whenever significant organizational changes occur.

6.16 Commitment to a Culture of Privacy

ADP recognizes that effective data protection depends not only on policies and technical controls but also on organizational culture.

Accordingly, the organization shall promote a culture in which:

- privacy is considered everyone's responsibility;
- ethical handling of personal data is valued;
- concerns may be raised without fear of retaliation;
- continuous learning is encouraged;
- transparency and accountability guide decision-making.

Through this governance framework, ADP aims to ensure that privacy protection is embedded in every project, partnership, digital service, and organizational activity, thereby strengthening public trust and supporting the organization's mission of responsible digital progress.

7. Categories of Personal Data Processed

7.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX processes personal data only where necessary to fulfil its legal obligations, organizational objectives, contractual commitments, research activities, educational programmes, community initiatives, and public interest missions.

This chapter identifies the principal categories of personal data that may be processed during ADP operations.

The inclusion of a category within this Policy does not imply that such information is always collected. Personal data shall be processed only where there is a legitimate, lawful, and documented purpose.

7.2 General Principles

Before collecting any personal data, ADP shall ensure that:

- the information is necessary for a clearly defined purpose;
- an appropriate lawful basis exists;
- individuals are informed through a Privacy Notice where applicable;
- only the minimum necessary information is collected;
- appropriate security measures are implemented;
- retention periods have been established.

Collection of excessive or unnecessary personal data is prohibited.

7.3 Membership Data

To administer membership within the Association, ADP may process information including:

- full name;
- membership identification number;
- date of birth (where necessary);
- nationality (where required);
- postal address;
- email address;
- telephone number;
- occupation;
- organization represented;
- membership status;
- payment records;
- participation history.

Membership information shall be used exclusively for legitimate organizational purposes.

7.4 Employee Data

For employment administration, ADP may process:

- identification details;
- employment contracts;
- payroll information;
- tax information;
- banking details;
- emergency contact information;
- attendance records;
- performance evaluations;

- training records;
- leave records;
- disciplinary records where applicable.

Access to employee information shall be strictly limited to authorized personnel.

7.5 Volunteer Data

Volunteer management may require processing of:

- identification details;
- contact information;
- volunteer agreements;
- skills and qualifications;
- availability;
- participation records;
- emergency contacts;
- safeguarding checks where applicable;
- training records.

Volunteer records shall be retained only as long as operationally necessary.

7.6 Donor Data

To administer donations and maintain financial accountability, ADP may process:

- donor names;
- contact information;
- donation history;
- payment references;
- invoicing information;
- correspondence;
- acknowledgement records.

Financial information shall be handled in accordance with applicable accounting and financial regulations.

7.7 Beneficiary Data

Where ADP delivers projects or services to individuals or communities, beneficiary information may include:

- name;
- contact information;
- demographic information;
- eligibility information;
- participation history;
- programme outcomes;

- evaluation data.

Only information necessary for programme delivery and evaluation shall be collected.

7.8 Children and Young People

Projects involving children require enhanced safeguards.

Depending on the activity, ADP may process:

- child's name;
- age;
- educational institution;
- participation records;
- attendance;
- parental or guardian contact information;
- consent records;
- photographs or videos where authorized.

Processing involving children shall always comply with:

- this Policy;
- the Safeguarding & Protection Policy;
- applicable child protection legislation.

Children's information shall receive enhanced protection.

7.9 Training Participants

Educational activities may require processing of:

- registration information;
- attendance records;
- examination results;
- certificates;
- accessibility requirements;
- feedback forms;
- online learning platform accounts.

Training records shall not be published without an appropriate legal basis.

7.10 Researchers and Research Participants

Research activities may involve processing:

- informed consent documentation;
- participant identifiers;
- research questionnaires;
- interview recordings;
- survey responses;

- anonymised datasets;
- pseudonymised research data;
- statistical information.

Wherever possible, research datasets shall be anonymised or pseudonymised before analysis.

7.11 Website Visitors

ADP websites may process limited information including:

- IP address;
- browser information;
- device information;
- language preferences;
- cookies;
- session identifiers;
- website usage statistics;
- security logs.

Website tracking shall comply with applicable cookie requirements and the Website Privacy Notice.

7.12 Event Participants

Registration for conferences, seminars, workshops, and public events may involve:

- participant names;
- contact information;
- organization;
- dietary requirements;
- accessibility requirements;
- attendance records;
- photographs;
- video recordings;
- certificates.

Participants shall be informed where photography or video recording is planned.

7.13 Partners and Stakeholders

For partnership management ADP may process:

- professional contact information;
- organizational affiliation;
- contractual information;
- project responsibilities;
- communication records.

Only business-related information shall normally be processed.

7.14 Suppliers and Contractors

Supplier management may involve:

- contact information;
- banking information;
- tax registration details;
- contractual documentation;
- procurement records;
- invoices;
- payment history.

Supplier information shall be protected using the same security standards applied to other organizational records.

7.15 Digital Platform Users

Where ADP operates digital services, online platforms, mobile applications, or learning environments, the organization may process:

- user account information;
- authentication credentials (encrypted where applicable);
- login history;
- system usage records;
- support requests;
- activity logs;
- audit trails.

System logs shall primarily be used for security, troubleshooting, and service improvement.

7.16 Audio, Visual and Multimedia Data

ADP may process:

- photographs;
- video recordings;
- webinar recordings;
- livestream recordings;
- voice recordings;
- promotional media;
- documentary materials.

Collection and publication of multimedia content shall comply with applicable consent requirements and legitimate organizational purposes.

Special caution shall be exercised when images include children or vulnerable persons.

7.17 Special Categories of Personal Data

In limited circumstances ADP may process Special Categories of Personal Data where legally justified.

Examples include:

- accessibility or disability information;
- dietary requirements relating to health or religion;
- medical information necessary for event safety;
- safeguarding information;
- research involving health-related subjects.

Such processing shall be subject to enhanced safeguards, restricted access, and additional security measures.

7.18 Criminal Records Data

ADP does not routinely process criminal offence data.

Where safeguarding legislation, employment law, donor requirements, or legal obligations require background checks, such information shall:

- be processed only where legally authorized;
 - remain confidential;
 - be accessible only to specifically authorized personnel;
 - be retained only for the legally permitted period.
-

7.19 Artificial Intelligence Generated Data

Use of Artificial Intelligence may generate additional information such as:

- automated classifications;
- document summaries;
- language translations;
- metadata;
- analytical outputs;
- risk indicators;
- usage statistics.

AI-generated information shall not automatically be considered accurate.

Human review shall always be undertaken before significant decisions are made using AI-assisted outputs.

7.20 Data Inventory and Processing Register

To maintain transparency and accountability, ADP shall establish and maintain a comprehensive **Data Inventory and Records of Processing Activities (ROPA)**.

The register shall include, at minimum:

- categories of personal data processed;
- purposes of processing;
- lawful basis;
- data subjects;
- recipients;
- international transfers;
- retention periods;
- technical and organizational security measures;
- responsible organizational unit.

The register shall be reviewed periodically and updated whenever new processing activities are introduced.

7.21 Data Minimisation Commitment

The categories described in this chapter represent the maximum range of personal data that may be processed by ADP.

The existence of this list does not authorize unrestricted collection.

For every processing activity, ADP shall ensure that:

- only relevant data are collected;
- unnecessary categories are excluded;
- alternative approaches using anonymised or aggregated information are considered wherever feasible.

The organization remains committed to processing **the minimum amount of personal data necessary** to fulfil its mission while protecting the rights, freedoms, and dignity of every individual.

8. Lawful Bases for Processing

8.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX shall process personal data only where a valid legal basis exists under applicable data protection legislation.

Before initiating any processing activity, ADP shall identify, document, and periodically review the lawful basis supporting that activity.

The existence of a legitimate organizational objective alone shall not justify the processing of personal data. Every processing operation must be supported by one or more lawful bases established under applicable law.

Where no lawful basis exists, the processing activity shall not proceed.

8.2 General Principles

Before processing personal data, ADP shall ensure that:

- a lawful basis has been identified;
- the purpose of processing is clearly documented;
- individuals receive appropriate privacy information;
- the selected lawful basis is appropriate for the intended processing activity;
- supporting documentation is retained.

The lawful basis shall be determined before personal data are collected and shall not be changed retrospectively unless legally justified.

8.3 Consent

ADP may process personal data based on the freely given consent of the Data Subject.

Consent shall be used where:

- participation is voluntary;
- no other lawful basis is more appropriate;
- individuals have genuine freedom of choice.

Consent shall be:

- freely given;
- specific;
- informed;
- unambiguous;
- documented where appropriate;
- capable of being withdrawn at any time.

Examples within ADP include:

- newsletter subscriptions;
- optional mailing lists;
- publication of photographs or videos;
- promotional materials;
- participation in voluntary surveys;
- optional research activities;
- optional AI-assisted services.

Withdrawal of consent shall be as simple as providing consent.

Refusal or withdrawal of consent shall not result in unfair treatment unless the processing is essential for providing the requested service.

8.4 Performance of a Contract

Personal data may be processed where necessary for the performance of a contract or in order to take steps requested by an individual prior to entering into a contract.

Examples include:

- employment contracts;
- consultancy agreements;
- service contracts;
- procurement contracts;
- volunteer agreements;
- grant agreements;
- project participation agreements;
- training registrations requiring contractual administration.

Only information necessary for fulfilling contractual obligations shall be processed.

8.5 Compliance with Legal Obligations

ADP may process personal data where required to comply with applicable legal obligations.

Examples include:

- taxation requirements;
- accounting regulations;
- employment legislation;
- financial reporting obligations;
- audit requirements;
- court orders;
- lawful requests from competent public authorities;
- safeguarding obligations;
- anti-money laundering requirements where applicable.

Only information specifically required by law shall be processed under this legal basis.

8.6 Vital Interests

Personal data may be processed where necessary to protect the vital interests of an individual or another natural person.

This legal basis shall normally apply only in exceptional circumstances, including:

- medical emergencies;
- emergency contact situations;
- safeguarding emergencies;
- serious threats to health or safety;
- disaster response activities.

Use of this lawful basis shall be documented and limited to what is strictly necessary.

8.7 Public Interest

Where ADP performs activities carried out in the public interest or under official authorization provided by applicable legislation, personal data may be processed on this basis.

Examples may include:

- publicly funded educational programmes;
- community development initiatives;
- public awareness campaigns;
- research projects serving public policy objectives;
- collaborations with governmental institutions.

Processing under this basis shall always be supported by an identifiable legal or regulatory framework.

8.8 Legitimate Interests

ADP may process personal data where processing is necessary for its legitimate interests, provided such interests are not overridden by the rights and freedoms of the Data Subject.

Examples may include:

- organizational administration;
- internal governance;
- fraud prevention;
- network and information security;
- project management;
- quality assurance;
- statistical reporting;
- service improvement;
- internal communications;
- alumni and stakeholder engagement.

Whenever Legitimate Interests are relied upon, ADP shall conduct and document a **Legitimate Interest Assessment (LIA)** considering:

- the purpose of processing;
- the necessity of the processing;
- the impact on individuals;
- reasonable expectations of the Data Subject;
- safeguards implemented to protect individual rights.

Where the assessment indicates that the individual's interests override ADP's legitimate interests, another lawful basis shall be used or the processing shall not proceed.

8.9 Special Categories of Personal Data

Processing of Special Categories of Personal Data shall occur only where:

- explicit consent has been obtained;

- processing is necessary for employment or social protection obligations;
- vital interests are involved;
- processing relates to legitimate activities of a non-profit organization within its lawful objectives;
- processing is necessary for scientific or statistical research under appropriate safeguards;
- processing is otherwise permitted by applicable law.

Enhanced security measures shall always be applied.

8.10 Children's Personal Data

Where personal data relating to children are processed, ADP shall ensure that:

- the lawful basis is clearly identified;
- parental or guardian consent is obtained where required by law;
- information is presented in language appropriate to the child's level of understanding;
- only information strictly necessary for the activity is collected;
- additional safeguards are implemented in accordance with the Safeguarding & Protection Policy.

The best interests of the child shall always be a primary consideration.

8.11 Artificial Intelligence and Lawful Processing

The use of Artificial Intelligence does not create an independent lawful basis for processing personal data.

Before AI systems are used, ADP shall ensure that:

- an existing lawful basis supports the processing;
- AI processing is transparent;
- individuals are informed where appropriate;
- automated outputs are subject to meaningful human oversight;
- privacy risks have been assessed;
- AI processing complies with the Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

AI technologies shall enhance, not diminish, the rights of individuals.

8.12 Changing the Lawful Basis

Once personal data have been collected, ADP shall not change the lawful basis for processing unless:

- the change is legally permissible;
- the new purpose is compatible with the original purpose;
- individuals are informed where required;
- additional consent is obtained where necessary.

All changes shall be documented.

8.13 Documentation and Accountability

For every processing activity, ADP shall maintain documentation identifying:

- the lawful basis;
- processing purpose;
- categories of personal data;
- categories of Data Subjects;
- recipients;
- retention period;
- security measures;
- responsible department;
- applicable privacy notices.

This information shall form part of ADP's **Records of Processing Activities (ROPA)**.

8.14 Review of Lawful Bases

The lawful basis supporting each processing activity shall be reviewed:

- before new processing begins;
- when projects are substantially modified;
- when legislation changes;
- when new technologies are introduced;
- following significant privacy incidents;
- during periodic compliance audits.

Where a lawful basis is no longer valid, the processing activity shall be modified, suspended, or discontinued.

8.15 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that selecting the appropriate lawful basis is fundamental to lawful and ethical data processing.

Accordingly, no employee, volunteer, contractor, consultant, researcher, or project partner shall collect or process personal data without first ensuring that an appropriate lawful basis has been identified and documented.

Where uncertainty exists regarding the appropriate legal basis, processing shall not commence until guidance has been obtained from the Data Protection Officer (where appointed), the Privacy Coordinator, or the Executive Director.

By adhering to these principles, ADP seeks to ensure that every processing activity is lawful, transparent, accountable, and fully aligned with the organization's commitment to protecting the rights and freedoms of individuals.

9. Processing of Children's Data

9.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that children and young people require a higher level of protection regarding the processing of their personal data.

Children may be less aware of privacy risks, the consequences of sharing personal information, and their rights under data protection legislation. Accordingly, ADP is committed to ensuring that all processing involving children is lawful, fair, transparent, secure, and conducted in the best interests of the child.

This chapter establishes the principles and safeguards applicable whenever ADP processes personal data relating to children through its educational programmes, digital services, research activities, youth initiatives, community projects, and international cooperation programmes.

9.2 Best Interests of the Child

In every activity involving children's personal data, ADP shall treat the best interests of the child as a primary consideration.

Before collecting or processing children's information, ADP shall consider:

- whether the processing is genuinely necessary;
- whether the same objective can be achieved with less personal information;
- the possible impact on the child's privacy, dignity, and wellbeing;
- potential long-term consequences;
- the level of privacy risk involved.

No project objective shall override the fundamental rights and welfare of a child.

9.3 Lawful Basis for Processing

Personal data relating to children shall only be processed where an appropriate lawful basis exists.

Depending on the circumstances, this may include:

- parental or guardian consent where required;
- performance of an educational or training agreement;
- compliance with legal obligations;
- legitimate interests, provided such interests do not override the child's rights;
- public interest activities authorized by applicable law.

The lawful basis shall be documented before any processing begins.

9.4 Parental or Guardian Consent

Where consent is the appropriate lawful basis, ADP shall obtain valid consent from a parent or legal guardian before collecting or processing a child's personal data.

Consent procedures shall ensure that:

- the identity of the parent or guardian is reasonably verified;
- the purpose of processing is clearly explained;
- consent is freely given;
- consent is specific to the intended activity;
- consent may be withdrawn at any time;
- records of consent are securely maintained.

Withdrawal of consent shall not affect processing already carried out lawfully but shall prevent further processing unless another lawful basis applies.

9.5 Information Provided to Children

Privacy information provided directly to children shall be:

- written in clear and age-appropriate language;
- easy to understand;
- free from unnecessary legal or technical terminology;
- presented in accessible formats where appropriate.

Children shall be encouraged to ask questions about how their information is used.

Where appropriate, visual materials or simplified privacy notices may be used to improve understanding.

9.6 Data Minimisation

ADP shall collect only the minimum amount of personal data necessary to support educational, safeguarding, administrative, or project objectives.

Particular care shall be taken to avoid collecting unnecessary information regarding:

- family circumstances;
- medical information;
- financial status;
- behavioural assessments;
- sensitive personal characteristics.

Where anonymised or pseudonymised information is sufficient, identifiable personal data shall not be collected.

9.7 Educational Activities

During educational programmes ADP may process information necessary for:

- participant registration;
- attendance monitoring;
- learning management;
- certification;

- accessibility arrangements;
- safeguarding;
- communication with parents or guardians.

Educational records shall not be used for unrelated purposes without an appropriate lawful basis.

9.8 Photographs, Videos and Media

Photographs and video recordings involving children require enhanced protection.

ADP shall ensure that:

- an appropriate lawful basis exists before recording;
- parental or guardian authorization is obtained where required;
- children are treated respectfully and with dignity;
- photographs are appropriate to the activity;
- publication does not expose children to unnecessary risks;
- metadata revealing location or other sensitive information is removed where appropriate.

Photographs shall never be used in a manner that could embarrass, exploit, endanger, or stigmatize a child.

9.9 Online Services

Where children participate in online activities organized by ADP, additional safeguards shall be implemented.

These may include:

- secure authentication;
- restricted access to online platforms;
- moderated communication;
- limited profile visibility;
- secure password requirements;
- monitoring for inappropriate behaviour;
- protection against unauthorized access.

Platforms used for children shall comply with appropriate security and privacy standards.

9.10 Research Involving Children

Research involving children shall receive enhanced ethical consideration.

Researchers shall ensure that:

- participation is voluntary;
- parental consent is obtained where required;
- assent from the child is sought whenever appropriate;
- participation may be discontinued at any time without adverse consequences;
- unnecessary identifiers are removed;

- research findings are reported in anonymised form unless otherwise authorized by law.

Research involving children shall also comply with ADP's **Research Integrity & Open Science Policy** once adopted.

9.11 Sharing Children's Personal Data

Personal data relating to children shall not be shared unless:

- there is a lawful basis;
- sharing is necessary for the intended purpose;
- appropriate safeguards are implemented;
- recipients provide adequate protection.

Whenever possible, pseudonymised or anonymised information shall be shared instead of directly identifiable personal data.

9.12 International Projects

Where children's personal data are processed during international cooperation programmes, exchanges, or mobility projects, ADP shall ensure that:

- cross-border transfers comply with applicable legislation;
 - partner organizations maintain equivalent privacy standards;
 - contractual safeguards are established;
 - risks associated with international processing are assessed before transfers occur.
-

9.13 Safeguarding Integration

Processing of children's personal data shall always be coordinated with ADP's **Safeguarding & Protection Policy**.

Where safeguarding concerns arise, protection of the child shall take priority over routine administrative procedures.

Employees and volunteers shall immediately report safeguarding concerns in accordance with established safeguarding procedures.

9.14 Retention and Secure Disposal

Children's personal data shall not be retained longer than necessary.

Upon expiry of the applicable retention period, records shall be:

- securely deleted;
- permanently anonymised; or
- archived only where legally required.

Additional caution shall be exercised before retaining children's records for historical or research purposes.

9.15 Organizational Commitment

ADP is committed to creating educational, digital, and community environments in which children can participate safely and confidently.

Accordingly, every employee, volunteer, consultant, researcher, contractor, and project partner involved in activities relating to children shall:

- respect children's privacy;
- protect confidential information;
- process only the minimum necessary personal data;
- comply with this Policy and the Safeguarding & Protection Policy;
- report concerns promptly;
- place the rights, dignity, safety, and wellbeing of children above organizational convenience.

Through these commitments, ADP seeks to ensure that every child participating in its programmes is afforded the highest practicable standard of privacy protection and data security, consistent with international human rights principles and applicable data protection legislation.

10. Data Collection

10.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to collecting personal data in a lawful, fair, transparent, and proportionate manner.

Personal data shall be collected only where necessary to support the legitimate activities of the organization and only through methods consistent with applicable legislation, ethical standards, and this Policy.

ADP shall ensure that individuals understand why their personal data are collected, how the information will be used, how long it will be retained, and what rights they have regarding their information.

No personal data shall be collected merely because collection is technically possible.

10.2 General Principles of Data Collection

All collection of personal data shall comply with the following principles:

- lawfulness;
- fairness;
- transparency;
- purpose limitation;
- data minimisation;

- accuracy;
- confidentiality;
- accountability.

Before collecting any personal data, ADP personnel shall consider whether:

- the information is genuinely necessary;
- another lawful source already exists;
- anonymised information would be sufficient;
- collection creates unnecessary privacy risks.

Where uncertainty exists, the least intrusive method of collection shall be preferred.

10.3 Sources of Personal Data

Personal data may be collected directly from the Data Subject or indirectly from authorized and lawful sources.

Typical sources include:

- registration forms;
- membership applications;
- employment applications;
- volunteer applications;
- event registrations;
- surveys and questionnaires;
- interviews;
- project applications;
- training enrolment;
- research participation;
- website interactions;
- email correspondence;
- telephone communications;
- mobile applications;
- partner organizations where legally authorized;
- publicly available official sources where appropriate.

The source of personal data shall be documented where required.

10.4 Direct Collection

Whenever reasonably possible, ADP shall collect personal data directly from the individual concerned.

Direct collection promotes:

- transparency;
- accuracy;
- informed participation;
- respect for individual rights.

Individuals shall normally receive privacy information before or at the time their information is collected.

10.5 Indirect Collection

Personal data may occasionally be obtained from third parties where permitted by law.

Examples include:

- project consortium partners;
- educational institutions;
- funding agencies;
- employers participating in projects;
- public authorities;
- research collaborators.

Where personal data have not been obtained directly from the individual, ADP shall provide appropriate privacy information within the time limits established by applicable legislation unless a lawful exemption applies.

10.6 Online Forms

Online forms shall be designed according to the principles of Privacy by Design and Data Minimisation.

Forms shall:

- request only necessary information;
- distinguish mandatory and optional fields;
- provide access to the Privacy Notice;
- explain the purpose of collection;
- identify the lawful basis where appropriate;
- use secure transmission protocols (HTTPS);
- implement measures to prevent unauthorized submissions and automated abuse where appropriate.

Completed forms shall be transmitted and stored securely.

10.7 Paper Forms

Where paper-based forms are used, ADP shall ensure that:

- only authorized versions are used;
- completed forms are stored securely;
- transportation of documents is controlled;
- unauthorized copying is prohibited;
- unnecessary paper records are securely destroyed.

Paper records shall receive protection equivalent to electronic records.

10.8 Email Communications

Email shall only be used for collecting personal data where appropriate.

Personnel shall:

- avoid requesting unnecessary personal information by email;
- verify recipient addresses before sending or requesting information;
- use organizational email accounts for official communications;
- encrypt sensitive information where appropriate;
- promptly delete misdirected communications in accordance with incident procedures.

Confidential information shall not be sent through unsecured channels when more secure alternatives are available.

10.9 Telephone Communications

Where personal data are collected by telephone:

- identity shall be verified where appropriate;
- unnecessary information shall not be requested;
- confidential conversations shall be conducted privately;
- call recordings shall occur only where lawful and disclosed.

Personnel shall document only information relevant to the stated purpose.

10.10 Events and Conferences

Registration for meetings, conferences, workshops, seminars, and public events may require collection of personal information.

Collected information may include:

- name;
- organization;
- professional position;
- contact information;
- dietary requirements;
- accessibility requirements;
- attendance records.

Participants shall be informed in advance if photography, video recording, livestreaming, or media coverage is planned.

10.11 Educational and Training Activities

Educational programmes may require collection of:

- registration information;

- attendance;
- learning progress;
- certification records;
- accessibility information;
- evaluation forms.

Information collected for educational purposes shall not be used for unrelated marketing or promotional activities unless an appropriate lawful basis exists.

10.12 Research Activities

Researchers shall ensure that:

- participants receive appropriate information;
- informed consent is obtained where required;
- participation is voluntary;
- unnecessary identifiers are avoided;
- pseudonymisation or anonymisation is used wherever feasible.

Research protocols shall identify precisely what information is collected and why.

10.13 Digital Platforms and Mobile Applications

Where ADP operates digital services, collection of personal data shall be limited to what is necessary for:

- authentication;
- service delivery;
- security;
- system administration;
- user support;
- lawful analytics;
- improvement of digital services.

Privacy settings shall be configured to provide the highest practical level of protection by default.

10.14 Cookies and Similar Technologies

Where cookies or similar technologies are used, ADP shall ensure that:

- users receive clear information;
- consent is obtained where legally required;
- non-essential cookies remain optional;
- users can modify cookie preferences;
- tracking technologies are reviewed periodically.

Detailed requirements are established in **Chapter 20 – Cookies and Website Privacy**.

10.15 Artificial Intelligence-Assisted Collection

Artificial Intelligence technologies may support administrative processes involving personal data.

However:

- AI shall not collect personal data without an identified lawful basis;
- AI-generated information shall be verified by human personnel before significant use;
- automated extraction of personal information from public sources shall be subject to legal and ethical review;
- AI systems shall operate consistently with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

AI shall assist, but not replace, responsible human decision-making.

10.16 Collection from Third-Party Platforms

Where ADP uses third-party platforms (e.g., online registration systems, survey tools, learning management systems, collaboration platforms), the organization shall ensure that:

- the platform provides appropriate data protection safeguards;
- contractual obligations address privacy and security responsibilities;
- only necessary information is collected;
- data processing agreements are established where required.

Third-party platforms shall be subject to periodic review.

10.17 Data Collection Records

For accountability purposes, ADP shall maintain documentation describing:

- the source of the data;
- categories of information collected;
- processing purpose;
- lawful basis;
- responsible organizational unit;
- applicable retention period;
- recipients where applicable.

These records shall form part of ADP's **Records of Processing Activities (ROPA)**.

10.18 Prohibited Collection Practices

The following practices are prohibited unless expressly authorized by law:

- collecting excessive personal data;
- collecting information without a defined purpose;
- deceptive or misleading collection methods;
- unauthorized recording of conversations;
- hidden surveillance;
- collecting credentials or passwords belonging to individuals;

- scraping personal information from websites or social media without an appropriate legal basis;
- collecting children's personal data without appropriate safeguards;
- retaining personal data "just in case" it may become useful in the future.

Violations of these requirements may result in disciplinary action and, where appropriate, legal or regulatory consequences.

10.19 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that responsible data collection is the first and one of the most important stages of the personal data lifecycle.

Accordingly, every person acting on behalf of ADP shall ensure that personal data are collected:

- lawfully;
- transparently;
- respectfully;
- proportionately;
- securely;
- only for legitimate organizational purposes.

By limiting collection to what is genuinely necessary, ADP strengthens privacy protection, reduces organizational risk, supports regulatory compliance, and reinforces public confidence in the organization's commitment to ethical and responsible digital governance.

11. Use of Artificial Intelligence in Personal Data Processing

11.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes the transformative potential of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in education, research, digital services, project management, public engagement, and organizational administration.

At the same time, ADP acknowledges that AI systems may introduce significant privacy, ethical, legal, and cybersecurity risks when processing personal data.

The purpose of this chapter is to ensure that the use of AI within ADP supports human rights, protects personal privacy, promotes fairness and transparency, and remains fully aligned with applicable data protection legislation and ADP's organizational values.

Artificial Intelligence shall serve as a tool to assist human decision-making and shall never diminish the rights, freedoms, dignity, or autonomy of individuals.

11.2 Scope

This chapter applies whenever Artificial Intelligence is used to process, analyze, generate, classify, organize, retrieve, summarize, translate, or otherwise interact with personal data processed by ADP.

It applies regardless of whether AI services are:

- developed internally;
- provided by commercial vendors;
- accessed through cloud services;
- integrated into third-party platforms;
- embedded within research tools;
- used experimentally or operationally.

The requirements apply equally to Generative AI, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Computer Vision, predictive analytics, recommendation systems, and any future AI technologies adopted by ADP.

11.3 Guiding Principles

Whenever AI is used, ADP shall ensure that its deployment is guided by the following principles:

- lawfulness;
- human dignity;
- fairness;
- transparency;
- accountability;
- proportionality;
- privacy by design;
- security by design;
- non-discrimination;
- human oversight.

These principles apply throughout the lifecycle of every AI-supported activity.

11.4 Lawful Processing

The use of AI does not create an independent lawful basis for processing personal data.

Before any AI system is used, ADP shall ensure that:

- a lawful basis for processing has already been identified;
- individuals are informed where appropriate;
- processing remains compatible with the original purpose;
- AI processing complies with this Policy and applicable legislation.

The decision to introduce AI shall never bypass existing privacy requirements.

11.5 Human Oversight

Meaningful human oversight shall be maintained whenever AI processes personal data.

Accordingly:

- AI outputs shall be reviewed before being relied upon;
- significant decisions shall involve qualified human judgment;
- individuals may request human review where appropriate;
- AI recommendations shall not automatically determine organizational decisions.

Ultimate responsibility for decisions remains with authorized ADP personnel.

11.6 Transparency

Where appropriate, ADP shall be transparent regarding the use of AI.

Individuals should be informed when:

- AI assists in processing their personal data;
- AI contributes to communication or analysis;
- AI-generated outputs influence organizational services;
- automated systems are used in support of decision-making.

Transparency notices shall be clear, understandable, and proportionate to the level of risk.

11.7 Data Minimisation in AI Systems

Only the minimum amount of personal data necessary for the intended AI function shall be processed.

Before using personal data within AI systems, ADP shall consider whether:

- anonymised data would be sufficient;
- pseudonymised data could achieve the same objective;
- synthetic datasets may be used;
- aggregated statistics would provide an adequate alternative.

AI systems shall never receive unnecessary personal information.

11.8 Accuracy and Validation

AI-generated outputs may contain errors, omissions, or fabricated information ("hallucinations").

Accordingly:

- AI outputs shall be verified before operational use;
- factual information shall be independently confirmed where appropriate;
- important documents shall receive human review;
- AI-generated recommendations shall not be accepted without appropriate validation.

The level of review shall be proportionate to the potential impact of the decision.

11.9 Automated Decision-Making

As a general organizational rule, ADP shall not rely solely on automated decision-making where decisions may significantly affect individuals.

This includes decisions relating to:

- employment;
- volunteer selection;
- project participation;
- scholarship recommendations;
- educational assessment;
- disciplinary action;
- research participation;
- safeguarding measures.

Meaningful human intervention shall always be available.

11.10 High-Risk AI Activities

Before implementing AI systems involving elevated privacy or ethical risks, ADP shall conduct an assessment considering:

- the nature of the personal data;
- categories of individuals affected;
- possible discrimination;
- cybersecurity risks;
- accuracy limitations;
- transparency requirements;
- legal obligations;
- necessity and proportionality.

Where appropriate, a **Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)** and an **AI Risk Assessment** shall be completed before deployment.

11.11 Confidential Information

Personnel shall not disclose confidential or restricted information to external AI platforms unless:

- the platform has been formally approved by ADP;
- contractual safeguards are in place;
- privacy risks have been assessed;
- organizational authorization has been obtained.

The following information shall not be entered into public AI services without explicit authorization:

- confidential project documentation;
- personnel records;
- donor information;
- financial records;

- authentication credentials;
 - health information;
 - children's personal data;
 - safeguarding reports;
 - unpublished research datasets.
-

11.12 AI Procurement

Before adopting any AI solution, ADP shall evaluate:

- data protection practices;
- security controls;
- contractual terms;
- data retention policies;
- model transparency;
- vendor reputation;
- compliance with applicable legislation;
- international data transfer implications.

AI procurement shall follow ADP's Procurement Rules and Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy.

11.13 AI Training Data

Where ADP develops or customizes AI models, training datasets shall:

- be lawfully obtained;
- respect copyright and licensing obligations;
- minimize personal data;
- be anonymised where feasible;
- be reviewed for quality and bias;
- be securely stored.

Training datasets containing personal information shall receive enhanced protection.

11.14 Monitoring and Continuous Improvement

AI-supported processing activities shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued compliance with:

- this Policy;
- the Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
- applicable legislation;
- ethical principles;
- organizational objectives.

Reviews shall consider:

- accuracy;

- fairness;
- privacy impacts;
- cybersecurity;
- user feedback;
- technological developments.

Where unacceptable risks are identified, AI use shall be modified, suspended, or discontinued.

11.15 Organizational Commitment

ADP believes that Artificial Intelligence should enhance human capability rather than replace human responsibility.

Accordingly, every AI-assisted activity undertaken by ADP shall:

- respect human dignity;
- protect personal privacy;
- operate transparently;
- remain accountable to human oversight;
- minimize risks;
- support fairness and inclusion;
- comply with applicable legal and ethical standards.

Through this approach, ADP seeks to foster innovation while ensuring that technological progress never comes at the expense of individual rights, public trust, or organizational integrity.

12. Data Sharing and Disclosure

12.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that the sharing of personal data is sometimes necessary to fulfil contractual obligations, implement projects, comply with legal requirements, cooperate with partners, or deliver services effectively.

However, the disclosure of personal data also represents one of the highest privacy risks.

Accordingly, ADP shall ensure that personal data are shared only when:

- there is a clearly defined and legitimate purpose;
- an appropriate lawful basis exists;
- adequate technical and organizational safeguards have been implemented;
- recipients are authorized to receive the information;
- the rights and freedoms of Data Subjects remain protected.

Personal data shall never be disclosed merely for convenience.

12.2 General Principles

Whenever personal data are shared, ADP shall ensure that:

- the disclosure is lawful;
- only the minimum necessary information is shared;
- the recipient has a legitimate need to know;
- confidentiality is maintained;
- secure transmission methods are used;
- the disclosure is documented where appropriate.

All disclosures shall be proportionate to the intended purpose.

12.3 Internal Sharing

Personal data may be shared internally only where necessary for legitimate organizational activities.

Examples include:

- project implementation;
- financial administration;
- safeguarding;
- human resources;
- training management;
- research administration;
- IT support.

Internal access shall follow the **Principle of Least Privilege**, meaning personnel shall have access only to the information necessary to perform their duties.

12.4 Sharing with Project Partners

Many ADP activities are implemented in partnership with universities, municipalities, NGOs, public institutions, international organizations, and funding bodies.

Before sharing personal data with project partners, ADP shall ensure that:

- responsibilities are clearly defined;
- data protection obligations are documented;
- the lawful basis has been identified;
- only necessary information is shared;
- appropriate security measures are in place.

Where appropriate, a **Data Sharing Agreement (DSA)** or equivalent contractual arrangement shall be executed before data exchange begins.

12.5 Sharing with Service Providers (Processors)

ADP may engage third-party service providers to process personal data on its behalf.

Examples include:

- cloud hosting providers;
- email service providers;
- website hosting companies;
- learning management systems;
- accounting software providers;
- payroll services;
- survey platforms;
- collaboration platforms;
- cybersecurity providers.

Before engaging any processor, ADP shall:

- conduct appropriate due diligence;
- assess privacy and security practices;
- execute a written Data Processing Agreement (DPA);
- verify compliance with applicable legislation.

Processors shall process personal data only according to ADP's documented instructions.

12.6 Sharing with Public Authorities

Personal data may be disclosed to competent public authorities where required by law.

Examples include:

- courts;
- regulatory authorities;
- law enforcement agencies;
- tax authorities;
- employment authorities;
- supervisory authorities;
- public audit bodies.

Before disclosure, ADP shall verify:

- the legal authority of the request;
- the identity of the requesting authority;
- the scope of information requested;
- whether disclosure is legally required.

Only information specifically required shall be disclosed.

12.7 Sharing with Funding Organizations

Funding bodies frequently require limited personal data for:

- project verification;
- financial auditing;
- participant validation;

- reporting obligations;
- grant monitoring.

ADP shall ensure that:

- only required information is shared;
- reporting obligations are respected;
- sensitive information is minimized;
- confidentiality obligations remain applicable.

Where aggregated or anonymized data satisfy reporting requirements, identifiable personal data shall not be disclosed.

12.8 Research Collaboration

Research projects often involve collaboration with universities and research institutions.

Whenever research data are shared:

- anonymization shall be preferred;
- pseudonymization shall be used where anonymization is not feasible;
- research agreements shall define privacy responsibilities;
- publication shall avoid identifying individuals unless explicitly authorized.

Scientific openness shall never compromise participant privacy.

12.9 International Organizations

ADP may cooperate with:

- European Union institutions;
- United Nations agencies;
- Council of Europe bodies;
- international NGOs;
- development agencies;
- donor organizations.

Before sharing personal data internationally, ADP shall ensure that appropriate safeguards have been established in accordance with Chapter 13 of this Policy.

12.10 Sharing Children's Personal Data

Personal data relating to children shall receive enhanced protection.

Such information shall not be disclosed unless:

- disclosure is legally authorized;
- appropriate safeguarding measures exist;
- parental authorization has been obtained where required;
- disclosure supports the child's best interests.

Special caution shall be exercised when photographs or videos are involved.

12.11 Sharing Special Categories of Personal Data

Special Categories of Personal Data shall only be disclosed where:

- a lawful basis exists;
- disclosure is strictly necessary;
- enhanced security measures are applied;
- access is restricted to authorized individuals.

Transmission of sensitive personal information shall utilize appropriate encryption or equivalent protective measures whenever technically feasible.

12.12 Artificial Intelligence and Data Sharing

Personal data shall not be uploaded to external Artificial Intelligence platforms unless:

- organizational approval has been obtained;
- the AI service has undergone privacy and security assessment;
- contractual safeguards are established where appropriate;
- processing complies with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

Public AI platforms shall never be used for confidential organizational information without explicit authorization.

12.13 Secure Transmission

Whenever personal data are transmitted, ADP shall implement appropriate safeguards, including:

- encrypted communication channels;
- secure cloud services;
- password-protected files;
- secure file transfer mechanisms;
- recipient verification before transmission;
- secure courier services for physical records where necessary.

Personnel shall verify recipient identities before transmitting confidential information.

12.14 Prohibited Disclosures

The following disclosures are prohibited unless expressly authorized by law:

- disclosure for personal curiosity;
- disclosure to unauthorized individuals;
- disclosure through unsecured communication channels;
- publication of confidential information;
- sharing passwords or authentication credentials;

- disclosure exceeding the stated purpose;
- sharing personal data on social media without authorization;
- disclosure of children's personal data without appropriate safeguards.

Unauthorized disclosure may constitute a personal data breach and shall be investigated accordingly.

12.15 Documentation of Disclosures

Where appropriate, ADP shall maintain records of significant disclosures.

Disclosure records may include:

- date of disclosure;
- recipient;
- purpose;
- lawful basis;
- categories of personal data disclosed;
- method of transmission;
- authorizing individual.

These records support organizational accountability and regulatory compliance.

12.16 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that responsible information sharing is essential to effective collaboration while maintaining public trust.

Accordingly, every employee, volunteer, consultant, researcher, contractor, and partner shall ensure that personal data are disclosed only where:

- the disclosure is lawful;
- the purpose is legitimate;
- the recipient is authorized;
- appropriate safeguards are implemented;
- the dignity, privacy, and rights of the individual remain protected.

Through these commitments, ADP seeks to maintain a culture in which collaboration, transparency, and accountability coexist with the highest standards of privacy and information security.

13. International Data Transfers

13.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that many of its activities involve international cooperation with governmental institutions, universities, research organizations, non-governmental organizations, funding agencies, technology providers, and project partners located outside the Republic of North Macedonia.

Such cooperation may require the transfer of personal data across national borders.

The purpose of this chapter is to ensure that international transfers of personal data are conducted lawfully, securely, transparently, and with an equivalent level of protection to that required within ADP.

International cooperation shall never reduce the level of privacy protection afforded to Data Subjects.

13.2 General Principles

International transfers of personal data shall occur only where:

- there is a legitimate organizational purpose;
- a lawful basis for processing exists;
- appropriate legal safeguards have been established;
- adequate technical and organizational security measures are implemented;
- risks to Data Subjects have been assessed;
- the transfer complies with applicable legislation.

Cross-border transfers shall always follow the principle of **equivalent protection**.

13.3 Circumstances Requiring International Transfers

ADP may transfer personal data internationally for purposes including:

- Erasmus+ mobility programmes;
- Horizon Europe research projects;
- Interreg cooperation projects;
- IPA programmes;
- international conferences;
- academic exchanges;
- volunteer programmes;
- international donor reporting;
- collaborative research;
- cloud-based services;
- international training activities;
- international procurement;
- organizational communication.

Each transfer shall be assessed individually.

13.4 Transfers to Countries with Adequate Protection

Where personal data are transferred to jurisdictions recognized by applicable legislation as providing an adequate level of protection, transfers may proceed subject to ordinary organizational safeguards.

Prior to transfer, ADP shall verify that:

- the adequacy decision remains valid;
 - the recipient has a legitimate need to receive the information;
 - appropriate security measures are implemented.
-

13.5 Transfers Without an Adequacy Decision

Where personal data are transferred to countries that have not been recognized as providing an adequate level of protection, ADP shall implement appropriate safeguards before any transfer occurs.

Such safeguards may include:

- Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs);
- legally binding contractual agreements;
- approved codes of conduct;
- certification mechanisms;
- binding organizational arrangements where applicable;
- additional technical and organizational safeguards.

Transfers shall not proceed until appropriate protections have been established.

13.6 Transfer Impact Assessment (TIA)

Before transferring personal data to jurisdictions without an adequacy decision, ADP shall conduct a **Transfer Impact Assessment (TIA)**.

The assessment shall consider:

- applicable local legislation;
- government access risks;
- judicial protections;
- recipient security practices;
- technical safeguards;
- contractual protections;
- categories of personal data;
- likelihood and severity of potential harm.

The assessment shall be documented and periodically reviewed.

13.7 Cloud Service Providers

ADP may utilize international cloud services where appropriate.

Before using any cloud provider, ADP shall evaluate:

- geographical location of data centres;
- applicable jurisdiction;
- encryption capabilities;
- access controls;

- incident response procedures;
- subcontractor arrangements;
- contractual privacy commitments;
- regulatory compliance.

Cloud providers shall not receive unrestricted access to personal data.

13.8 International Research Collaboration

International research projects frequently require limited sharing of research data.

Whenever feasible:

- anonymized datasets shall be used;
- pseudonymized information shall be preferred;
- directly identifiable information shall remain within ADP unless transfer is essential;
- research partners shall sign appropriate confidentiality and data protection agreements.

Research openness shall never compromise participant privacy.

13.9 International Funding Organizations

Funding organizations may require access to limited personal information for:

- grant verification;
- participant validation;
- audit;
- monitoring;
- evaluation;
- reporting.

Only information necessary to fulfil contractual obligations shall be transferred.

Where aggregated or anonymized information satisfies reporting requirements, identifiable personal data shall not be transferred.

13.10 International Conferences and Events

Participation in international meetings may require limited disclosure of participant information.

Examples include:

- registration;
- travel arrangements;
- accommodation;
- certification;
- visa support;
- participant lists.

Only information required for the relevant activity shall be disclosed.

13.11 Children's Personal Data

International transfer of children's personal data requires enhanced safeguards.

Before such transfers occur, ADP shall ensure:

- a lawful basis exists;
- parental authorization has been obtained where required;
- safeguarding risks have been assessed;
- recipient organizations provide equivalent protection;
- unnecessary personal information is excluded.

The best interests of the child shall remain the primary consideration.

13.12 Artificial Intelligence Services

Many Artificial Intelligence services operate internationally.

Before personal data are processed using AI services hosted outside the applicable jurisdiction, ADP shall evaluate:

- where data are processed;
- whether prompts are retained;
- whether information is used for model training;
- available contractual safeguards;
- privacy controls;
- deletion mechanisms;
- cybersecurity practices.

Personnel shall not submit confidential or restricted personal data to external AI services unless expressly authorized.

13.13 Encryption and Secure Transfer

International transfers shall utilize appropriate technical safeguards.

Where appropriate, these include:

- end-to-end encryption;
- encrypted storage;
- secure VPN connections;
- password-protected files;
- secure authentication;
- integrity verification;
- secure file transfer platforms.

Passwords shall never be transmitted through the same communication channel as encrypted files.

13.14 Documentation

For accountability purposes, ADP shall maintain records of international transfers including:

- recipient organization;
- destination country;
- categories of personal data;
- lawful basis;
- purpose of transfer;
- applicable safeguards;
- transfer mechanism;
- responsible department;
- approval records where applicable.

These records shall form part of the organization's Records of Processing Activities (ROPA).

13.15 Suspension of Transfers

ADP reserves the right to suspend or terminate international transfers where:

- legal requirements can no longer be satisfied;
- contractual safeguards become inadequate;
- significant cybersecurity risks emerge;
- recipient organizations fail to comply with agreed obligations;
- supervisory authorities prohibit the transfer;
- unacceptable privacy risks are identified.

Protection of Data Subjects shall always take precedence over operational convenience.

13.16 Organizational Commitment

ADP believes that international cooperation and digital innovation should strengthen—not weaken—the protection of personal data.

Accordingly, every international transfer undertaken by the organization shall be based upon:

- lawfulness;
- necessity;
- transparency;
- accountability;
- proportionality;
- security;
- equivalent protection.

Through these commitments, ADP seeks to facilitate global cooperation while preserving the privacy, dignity, and fundamental rights of every individual whose personal data it processes.

14. Information Security Measures

14.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that the protection of personal data depends upon the implementation of appropriate technical and organizational security measures throughout the entire information lifecycle.

Information security is essential to preserving the confidentiality, integrity, availability, authenticity, and resilience of personal data processed by ADP.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish the minimum security requirements applicable to all organizational activities involving personal data.

These requirements shall be implemented in conjunction with ADP's **Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy**, which provides detailed operational and technical controls.

14.2 Information Security Objectives

The objectives of ADP's information security programme are to:

- protect personal data against unauthorized access;
- preserve data integrity;
- maintain availability of critical information;
- reduce cybersecurity risks;
- support organizational resilience;
- maintain stakeholder confidence;
- comply with legal and contractual obligations;
- support secure digital transformation.

Security controls shall be proportionate to the sensitivity of the information being protected.

14.3 Information Security Principles

Security measures implemented by ADP shall support:

- Confidentiality
- Integrity
- Availability
- Authenticity
- Accountability
- Resilience
- Least Privilege
- Need-to-Know
- Defense in Depth
- Zero Trust (where technically appropriate)

Security controls shall be continuously reviewed and improved.

14.4 Information Asset Classification

All information processed by ADP shall be classified according to its sensitivity.

The organization shall maintain a formal Information Classification Scheme consisting of:

Classification	Description	Examples
Public	Information approved for unrestricted public disclosure.	Published reports, public announcements, brochures, website content.
Internal	Operational information intended for internal organizational use.	Internal procedures, meeting agendas, project coordination documents.
Confidential	Information that could cause harm if disclosed without authorization.	Personnel records, donor information, contracts, financial documents, participant lists.
Restricted	Highly sensitive information requiring the strongest level of data protection.	Health data, safeguarding reports, children's personal authentication credentials, security incident investigations, encryption keys.

The classification assigned shall determine the minimum security controls applied.

14.5 Access Control

Access to personal data shall be granted strictly on the basis of operational necessity.

ADP shall apply the principles of:

- Least Privilege;
- Need-to-Know;
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC);
- Separation of Duties where appropriate.

User permissions shall be:

- approved;
- documented;
- periodically reviewed;
- removed promptly when no longer required.

Shared user accounts shall be avoided except where technically unavoidable and formally authorized.

14.6 Identity and Authentication

Every individual accessing ADP information systems shall be uniquely identifiable.

Authentication mechanisms shall include, where appropriate:

- unique user accounts;
- strong passwords;
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA);
- secure password recovery procedures;
- account lockout after repeated failed login attempts.

Generic or anonymous accounts shall not be used for processing personal data unless operationally justified.

14.7 Encryption

Encryption shall be used where appropriate to protect personal data during:

- storage;
- transmission;
- backup;
- portable device usage;
- cloud processing.

Encryption keys shall be protected separately from encrypted information.

Where encryption cannot reasonably be implemented, equivalent compensating controls shall be established.

14.8 Physical Security

Facilities containing personal data shall be protected through appropriate physical safeguards.

Examples include:

- controlled building access;
- locked offices;
- secure archives;
- visitor management;
- secure disposal containers;
- environmental protection measures.

Paper records containing personal data shall not be left unattended in publicly accessible areas.

14.9 Device Security

Organizational devices used to process personal data shall be protected through appropriate security measures.

These include:

- screen locking;
- operating system updates;

- anti-malware protection;
- device encryption where appropriate;
- secure configuration;
- automatic timeout;
- remote wipe capability for portable devices where feasible.

Users shall exercise particular care when using laptops, tablets, and smartphones outside ADP premises.

14.10 Remote Working

Personnel working remotely shall ensure that:

- organizational devices are protected;
- secure internet connections are used;
- confidential discussions cannot be overheard by unauthorized persons;
- documents are not left unattended;
- personal devices are used only where authorized;
- organizational information is protected from household members and visitors.

Remote work shall comply with ADP's Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy.

14.11 Cloud Security

Cloud services used by ADP shall be selected based on appropriate assessments of:

- privacy protections;
- cybersecurity controls;
- contractual commitments;
- availability;
- resilience;
- compliance with applicable legislation.

Only approved cloud platforms shall be used for storing organizational personal data.

14.12 Email and Electronic Communications

Electronic communications containing personal data shall be protected through appropriate safeguards.

Personnel shall:

- verify recipients before sending messages;
- avoid unnecessary distribution lists;
- encrypt sensitive attachments where appropriate;
- report suspected phishing attempts;
- avoid transmitting confidential information through unsecured channels.

Email remains one of the most common sources of privacy incidents and shall therefore receive particular attention.

14.13 Backup and Business Continuity

Personal data essential to organizational operations shall be backed up according to documented procedures.

Backup arrangements shall ensure:

- availability;
- integrity;
- recoverability;
- periodic testing;
- secure storage.

Backup copies shall receive protection equivalent to the original information.

14.14 Logging and Monitoring

Appropriate system logging shall be implemented to support:

- security monitoring;
- incident investigation;
- regulatory compliance;
- operational troubleshooting.

Access logs shall themselves be protected against unauthorized modification.

Monitoring activities shall remain proportionate and respect applicable privacy legislation.

14.15 Security Incident Reporting

Every employee, volunteer, consultant, contractor, and partner shall immediately report any suspected information security incident involving personal data.

Examples include:

- unauthorized access;
- malware infection;
- phishing attacks;
- accidental disclosure;
- lost devices;
- stolen documents;
- ransomware;
- suspicious system activity.

Prompt reporting enables rapid containment and minimizes potential harm.

Detailed incident management procedures are described in Chapter 18 – Personal Data Breach Management and the Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy.

14.16 Third-Party Security

Before granting third parties access to personal data, ADP shall verify that they maintain appropriate security controls.

Assessments may include:

- contractual review;
- security questionnaires;
- certifications;
- audit reports;
- privacy documentation;
- incident response capabilities.

Third-party security shall be monitored throughout the duration of the relationship.

14.17 Security Awareness

Technology alone cannot ensure effective information security.

Accordingly, ADP shall maintain an ongoing programme of security awareness covering topics including:

- password protection;
- phishing awareness;
- secure remote working;
- document handling;
- mobile device security;
- ransomware;
- social engineering;
- AI-related privacy risks.

Security awareness shall form part of mandatory organizational training.

14.18 Continuous Improvement

Information security measures shall be reviewed periodically considering:

- technological developments;
- organizational changes;
- audit findings;
- cybersecurity incidents;
- legal developments;
- emerging threats;
- lessons learned.

Security controls shall evolve continuously to address changing risks.

14.19 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that information security is fundamental to protecting personal data and maintaining public confidence.

Accordingly, every individual acting on behalf of the organization shares responsibility for safeguarding information assets through responsible behavior, compliance with approved procedures, and prompt reporting of security concerns.

By integrating technical safeguards, organizational governance, cybersecurity awareness, and continuous improvement, ADP seeks to maintain a secure environment in which personal data remain protected against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, loss, or destruction throughout their lifecycle.

15. Data Retention and Disposal

15.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that personal data shall not be retained indefinitely.

Personal data shall be retained only for as long as necessary to fulfil the purposes for which they were collected, to comply with applicable legal and contractual obligations, to support legitimate organizational activities, and to protect the rights of both the organization and Data Subjects.

Once the applicable retention period has expired, personal data shall be securely deleted, anonymized, or destroyed using appropriate methods.

Proper retention and disposal practices reduce privacy risks, improve information governance, and support regulatory compliance.

15.2 Retention Principles

All retention activities shall comply with the following principles:

- lawfulness;
- purpose limitation;
- storage limitation;
- accountability;
- proportionality;
- confidentiality;
- secure disposal.

Personal data shall never be retained merely because storage is inexpensive or technically possible.

15.3 Determining Retention Periods

Retention periods shall be determined by considering:

- applicable legislation;
- contractual obligations;
- funding requirements;
- audit obligations;
- financial regulations;
- employment legislation;
- research requirements;
- safeguarding obligations;
- litigation risks;
- operational necessity.

Retention decisions shall be documented and reviewed periodically.

15.4 Retention Schedule

ADP shall maintain a formal **Personal Data Retention Schedule**, identifying for each category of personal data:

- category of records;
- purpose of processing;
- lawful basis;
- minimum retention period;
- maximum retention period where appropriate;
- legal references;
- responsible department;
- disposal method.

The Retention Schedule forms **Appendix A** of this Policy and shall be reviewed at least annually.

15.5 Categories of Records

The Retention Schedule shall include, where applicable:

- membership records;
- employee records;
- volunteer records;
- recruitment documentation;
- donor records;
- accounting records;
- procurement documentation;
- project documentation;
- participant records;
- research data;
- safeguarding documentation;

- website logs;
- security logs;
- training records;
- contracts;
- photographs and media;
- consent records;
- Data Subject Rights requests;
- personal data breach documentation.

Each category shall have a documented retention period.

15.6 Legal Hold

Where ADP becomes aware of:

- pending litigation;
- anticipated legal proceedings;
- regulatory investigations;
- law enforcement requests;
- governmental inquiries;
- contractual disputes;
- internal investigations;

scheduled disposal of relevant personal data shall immediately be suspended.

Such information shall be preserved until authorized legal or regulatory personnel confirm that disposal may resume.

15.7 Research Data Retention

Research data frequently require longer retention periods to support:

- scientific verification;
- reproducibility;
- publication requirements;
- research integrity;
- funding obligations;
- academic review.

Whenever possible:

- anonymized research datasets shall be retained instead of identifiable information;
- identifiers shall be removed at the earliest practical opportunity;
- access shall remain restricted.

Research data retention shall comply with ADP's **Research Integrity & Open Science Policy**.

15.8 Financial and Accounting Records

Financial documentation containing personal data shall be retained for the periods required by applicable:

- tax legislation;
- accounting regulations;
- grant agreements;
- audit requirements;
- donor obligations.

After expiration of mandatory retention periods, records shall be securely destroyed unless another lawful basis for continued retention exists.

15.9 Human Resources Records

Personnel records shall be retained only for the periods required by:

- employment legislation;
- pension obligations;
- occupational health and safety requirements;
- contractual obligations;
- legal claims.

Former employee information shall not be retained indefinitely.

15.10 Children's Personal Data

Personal data relating to children shall receive particular consideration during retention decisions.

Retention shall be limited to what is necessary for:

- safeguarding;
- educational programmes;
- legal obligations;
- project reporting;
- parental communication.

Where continued identification is unnecessary, children's information shall be anonymized or securely destroyed.

15.11 Artificial Intelligence Training Data

Where AI systems are developed or customized by ADP, datasets containing personal data shall not be retained longer than necessary.

Where feasible:

- anonymized datasets shall be preferred;
- synthetic data shall be considered;
- obsolete datasets shall be securely deleted;
- retraining datasets shall undergo periodic review.

Historic AI datasets shall not be retained indefinitely.

15.12 Archived Records

Certain records may be archived where required for:

- historical purposes;
- scientific research;
- statistical analysis;
- institutional memory;
- legal preservation.

Archived records shall:

- receive enhanced protection;
- have restricted access;
- be reviewed periodically;
- remain subject to applicable privacy safeguards.

Archiving shall not become a substitute for proper disposal.

15.13 Secure Disposal Principles

When personal data are no longer required, disposal shall ensure that information cannot reasonably be reconstructed, recovered, or misused.

Disposal methods shall be proportionate to:

- data sensitivity;
 - storage medium;
 - organizational risk;
 - legal obligations.
-

15.14 Secure Disposal of Paper Records

Paper records containing personal data shall be destroyed through methods such as:

- cross-cut shredding;
- secure confidential waste services;
- certified destruction providers.

Discarding confidential records in ordinary waste containers is strictly prohibited.

15.15 Secure Disposal of Electronic Records

Electronic information shall be securely erased using methods appropriate to the storage technology.

Examples include:

- secure overwriting;

- cryptographic erasure;
- secure deletion tools;
- certified data destruction software.

Simple deletion or formatting of storage devices shall not normally be considered sufficient for confidential information.

15.16 Disposal of Physical Media

Before disposal, reuse, or recycling, storage media including:

- hard drives;
- SSDs;
- USB devices;
- memory cards;
- backup tapes;
- mobile devices;

shall undergo secure sanitization or physical destruction where appropriate.

Media disposal shall comply with recognized information security standards.

15.17 Certificates of Destruction

Where confidential information is destroyed by external providers, ADP should obtain, where appropriate:

- Certificates of Destruction;
- disposal reports;
- destruction logs;
- service confirmations.

These records support accountability and audit readiness.

15.18 Documentation

ADP shall maintain records of significant disposal activities where appropriate.

Documentation may include:

- date of disposal;
- categories of records;
- disposal method;
- responsible individual;
- service provider (if applicable);
- authorization.

Disposal records shall be retained in accordance with organizational recordkeeping requirements.

15.19 Periodic Review

At least annually, ADP shall review retained personal data to identify:

- obsolete information;
- duplicate records;
- expired retention periods;
- unnecessary archives;
- outdated backups.

Where information no longer serves a legitimate purpose, secure disposal shall be initiated without undue delay.

15.20 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that responsible retention and secure disposal are fundamental components of effective privacy governance.

Accordingly, every employee, volunteer, consultant, contractor, and partner shall ensure that personal data are retained only for legitimate purposes and securely disposed of once those purposes have been fulfilled.

Through disciplined records management, documented retention schedules, secure destruction procedures, and periodic review, ADP seeks to minimize privacy risks, reduce unnecessary data accumulation, strengthen regulatory compliance, and promote responsible stewardship of personal information throughout its lifecycle.

16. Data Subject Rights

16.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to respecting and facilitating the rights of every individual whose personal data it processes.

The protection of personal data extends beyond secure processing and includes ensuring that individuals remain able to understand, access, correct, control, and where appropriate, request the deletion or restriction of their personal information.

ADP shall establish efficient, transparent, and accessible procedures enabling Data Subjects to exercise their rights without unnecessary delay.

The exercise of these rights shall be free of charge except where requests are manifestly unfounded, excessive, or repetitive, as permitted by applicable legislation.

16.2 General Principles

When handling requests from Data Subjects, ADP shall ensure that:

- individuals are treated fairly and respectfully;
- requests are handled without discrimination;
- responses are timely;
- identities are verified before disclosure of personal information;
- communications are clear and understandable;
- legal deadlines are respected;
- decisions are documented.

Every request shall be considered individually.

16.3 Information About Rights

ADP shall ensure that individuals are informed of their privacy rights through:

- Privacy Notices;
- website information;
- consent forms;
- project documentation;
- registration materials;
- contractual documents where appropriate.

Privacy information shall be written in plain and understandable language.

16.4 Right of Access

Individuals have the right to request confirmation as to whether ADP processes their personal data.

Where applicable, ADP shall provide access to:

- categories of personal data processed;
- purposes of processing;
- lawful basis;
- recipients or categories of recipients;
- retention periods;
- sources of the data where applicable;
- information regarding international transfers;
- available rights;
- complaint mechanisms.

Access requests shall not adversely affect the rights of other individuals.

16.5 Right to Rectification

Individuals have the right to request correction of inaccurate or incomplete personal data.

Where appropriate, ADP shall:

- correct factual inaccuracies;
- update outdated information;

- complete incomplete records;
- notify relevant recipients where required by law.

The organization may request reasonable evidence before making corrections.

16.6 Right to Erasure ("Right to be Forgotten")

Individuals may request deletion of their personal data where:

- processing is no longer necessary;
- consent has been withdrawn;
- there is no overriding lawful basis for continued processing;
- processing has been unlawful;
- applicable legislation requires deletion.

The right to erasure is not absolute.

Deletion may be refused where retention remains necessary for:

- legal obligations;
- public interest;
- scientific research;
- statistical purposes;
- legal claims;
- safeguarding responsibilities.

Reasons for refusing deletion shall be communicated to the requester.

16.7 Right to Restriction of Processing

Individuals may request temporary restriction of processing where:

- accuracy is contested;
- processing is unlawful but deletion is opposed;
- ADP no longer requires the data but the individual requires them for legal claims;
- an objection to processing is under consideration.

During restriction, personal data shall generally not be processed except where permitted by applicable law.

16.8 Right to Data Portability

Where applicable, individuals may request a copy of personal data they have provided to ADP in a structured, commonly used, and machine-readable format.

Where technically feasible and legally appropriate, ADP may transfer the information directly to another controller at the individual's request.

This right applies only where processing is based upon:

- consent; or

- contractual necessity;

and where processing is carried out by automated means.

16.9 Right to Object

Individuals may object to processing based upon:

- legitimate interests;
- public interest;
- direct marketing where applicable.

Upon receiving an objection, ADP shall assess whether compelling legitimate grounds exist for continuing the processing.

Unless such grounds exist, processing shall cease.

Direct marketing objections shall be respected without unnecessary delay.

16.10 Rights Related to Automated Decision-Making

Individuals have the right not to be subject solely to automated decision-making where such decisions produce legal or similarly significant effects.

Where AI-supported decision-making is used, ADP shall ensure:

- meaningful human involvement;
- transparency regarding AI use;
- opportunity for review;
- possibility of contesting decisions.

This chapter shall be interpreted consistently with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

16.11 Withdrawal of Consent

Where processing relies upon consent, individuals may withdraw that consent at any time.

Withdrawal shall:

- be as easy as providing consent;
- not affect the lawfulness of processing undertaken before withdrawal;
- be implemented without undue delay.

Personnel shall not discourage individuals from exercising this right.

16.12 Right to Lodge a Complaint

Individuals who believe that their personal data have been processed unlawfully may:

- contact ADP directly;

- submit a complaint to the competent supervisory authority;
- pursue available judicial remedies where applicable.

ADP shall cooperate fully with supervisory authorities during investigations.

16.13 Identity Verification

Before responding to any request involving personal data, ADP shall verify the identity of the requester using methods proportionate to the sensitivity of the information requested.

Where reasonable doubt exists, additional verification may be requested.

ADP shall not disclose personal information to unauthorized persons.

16.14 Authorized Representatives

Requests submitted through authorized representatives shall be accepted where appropriate documentation demonstrates that the representative is legally authorized to act on behalf of the Data Subject.

Additional verification may be requested where necessary.

16.15 Timeframes

ADP shall respond to Data Subject requests without undue delay and, where applicable legislation requires, within the prescribed statutory timeframe.

Where requests are particularly complex or numerous, extensions permitted by law may be applied.

Individuals shall be informed of:

- any extension;
 - reasons for delay;
 - expected response date.
-

16.16 Refusal of Requests

ADP may decline requests where permitted by applicable legislation.

Examples include requests that are:

- manifestly unfounded;
- repetitive;
- excessive;
- incompatible with legal obligations;
- prejudicial to the rights of others.

Where a request is refused, ADP shall provide:

- reasons for refusal;

- available appeal mechanisms;
 - information regarding supervisory authorities where appropriate.
-

16.17 Documentation

For accountability purposes, ADP shall maintain records of Data Subject Rights requests including:

- request reference number;
- date received;
- identity verification;
- type of request;
- actions taken;
- response date;
- outcome;
- responsible department.

Documentation shall be retained in accordance with the Personal Data Retention Schedule.

16.18 Accessibility

ADP shall make reasonable efforts to ensure that individuals can exercise their rights through accessible communication channels.

Requests may be submitted, where appropriate, through:

- email;
- written correspondence;
- online forms;
- organizational offices;
- other approved communication channels.

Reasonable accommodations shall be provided for individuals with disabilities where required.

16.19 Staff Responsibilities

Every employee, volunteer, consultant, and contractor shall:

- recognize potential Data Subject Rights requests;
- forward requests promptly to the responsible personnel;
- maintain confidentiality;
- avoid providing unauthorized responses;
- cooperate during investigations.

Only authorized personnel may formally respond to Data Subject Rights requests.

16.20 Organizational Commitment

ADP considers the protection of Data Subject Rights to be a cornerstone of responsible data governance.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to ensuring that every request is handled fairly, transparently, securely, and without unnecessary delay.

By respecting individuals' rights to access, correct, control, and, where appropriate, erase or transfer their personal data, ADP reinforces public trust, strengthens organizational accountability, and demonstrates its commitment to privacy, human dignity, and the responsible use of information in all areas of its activities.

17. Consent Management

17.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that consent is an important lawful basis for processing personal data in many of its activities, including educational programmes, research projects, events, communications, digital services, and media publications.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a consistent framework for obtaining, documenting, managing, reviewing, and withdrawing consent in accordance with applicable data protection legislation and recognized best practices.

Consent shall always respect the autonomy, dignity, and freedom of choice of the individual.

17.2 General Principles

Whenever consent is relied upon as the lawful basis for processing personal data, it shall be:

- freely given;
- specific;
- informed;
- unambiguous;
- clearly documented;
- capable of being withdrawn at any time.

Silence, inactivity, or pre-selected options shall not normally constitute valid consent.

17.3 When Consent is Required

Consent may be required where processing activities involve, for example:

- participation in research studies;
- publication of photographs or videos;
- newsletters and marketing communications;
- optional surveys;
- educational recordings;
- use of testimonials;

- collection of certain categories of sensitive personal data where permitted by law;
- cookies and similar technologies where legally required.

Where another lawful basis is more appropriate, ADP shall not request consent unnecessarily.

17.4 Information Provided Before Consent

Before requesting consent, ADP shall provide individuals with clear and understandable information regarding:

- the identity of ADP as the data controller;
- the purpose of processing;
- the categories of personal data involved;
- the lawful basis for processing;
- the intended recipients, where applicable;
- any international data transfers;
- the expected retention period;
- the individual's rights;
- how consent may be withdrawn.

Information shall be presented in plain language appropriate to the intended audience.

17.5 Obtaining Consent

Consent may be obtained through various methods, including:

- signed consent forms;
- electronic consent forms;
- online registration systems;
- secure digital signatures;
- clearly documented verbal consent where legally appropriate;
- other verifiable mechanisms.

Consent records shall be capable of demonstrating that valid consent was obtained.

17.6 Explicit Consent

Where explicit consent is required, particularly for the processing of Special Categories of Personal Data, ADP shall ensure that the individual performs a clear affirmative action demonstrating agreement.

Examples include:

- signing a dedicated consent statement;
- selecting an unchecked opt-in box;
- providing a qualified electronic signature;
- submitting a separate written declaration.

Explicit consent shall never be inferred.

17.7 Consent for Children

Where consent relates to the personal data of children, ADP shall implement additional safeguards.

Where required by applicable legislation:

- parental or legal guardian consent shall be obtained;
- reasonable efforts shall be made to verify the authority of the consenting adult;
- information provided shall be understandable to both the child and the parent or guardian.

The best interests of the child shall always take precedence.

17.8 Separate Consent for Different Purposes

Consent shall be granular.

Individuals shall be able to choose independently whether they consent to different processing activities.

For example, separate consent options may be provided for:

- participation in a project;
- publication of photographs;
- receiving newsletters;
- participation in research;
- future contact regarding similar activities.

Bundled consent covering unrelated purposes shall be avoided.

17.9 Withdrawal of Consent

Individuals may withdraw consent at any time.

Withdrawal shall:

- be free of charge;
- be simple and accessible;
- not require unnecessary formalities;
- not adversely affect the individual.

Withdrawal shall not affect the lawfulness of processing carried out before consent was withdrawn.

Upon withdrawal, ADP shall cease the relevant processing unless another lawful basis applies.

17.10 Recording Consent

ADP shall maintain sufficient records demonstrating that valid consent has been obtained.

Consent records may include:

- identity of the individual;
- date and time consent was obtained;
- method of consent;
- version of the consent statement;
- purposes covered;
- responsible organizational unit;
- date of withdrawal where applicable.

Consent documentation shall be retained in accordance with the Personal Data Retention Schedule.

17.11 Consent Register

ADP shall maintain a centralized **Consent Register** where appropriate.

The register may include:

- unique consent reference number;
- name or identifier of the Data Subject;
- processing activity;
- lawful basis;
- date obtained;
- expiry date where applicable;
- withdrawal status;
- reviewing department.

The Consent Register is provided in **Appendix G** of this Policy.

17.12 Renewal of Consent

Consent shall be reviewed periodically.

Renewal may be required where:

- processing purposes change;
- significant time has elapsed;
- legislation changes;
- processing becomes substantially different;
- the original consent is no longer sufficiently specific.

Outdated consent shall not be relied upon indefinitely.

17.13 Consent in Research

Research participants shall receive sufficient information to make an informed decision regarding participation.

Where appropriate, consent documentation shall explain:

- research objectives;
- procedures;

- potential risks;
- expected benefits;
- confidentiality arrangements;
- publication practices;
- withdrawal procedures.

Withdrawal from research shall be respected to the extent permitted by scientific integrity and applicable legal obligations.

17.14 Consent for Photography, Video, and Media

ADP frequently documents educational, cultural, scientific, and community activities through photographs, audio recordings, and video recordings.

Where consent is required, individuals shall be informed regarding:

- the purpose of recording;
- intended publication channels;
- expected duration of use;
- withdrawal procedures;
- any international publication.

Special care shall be exercised when children or vulnerable individuals are involved.

17.15 Electronic Consent Systems

Where consent is obtained electronically, ADP shall ensure that systems:

- accurately record consent;
- maintain audit trails;
- prevent unauthorized modification;
- protect confidentiality;
- support withdrawal requests;
- retain appropriate metadata.

Electronic records shall be capable of demonstrating compliance during audits.

17.16 Refusal to Consent

Individuals who decline to provide consent shall not be subjected to unfair treatment where the requested processing is genuinely optional.

ADP shall ensure that refusal of optional consent does not result in unnecessary disadvantage or discrimination.

Where processing is essential for service delivery and relies on another lawful basis, this shall be clearly explained.

17.17 Monitoring and Review

Consent management practices shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued compliance with:

- applicable legislation;
- regulatory guidance;
- organizational procedures;
- technological developments;
- audit findings.

Improvements shall be implemented where weaknesses are identified.

17.18 Staff Responsibilities

Employees, volunteers, consultants, researchers, and contractors involved in obtaining consent shall:

- understand applicable consent requirements;
- provide accurate information;
- avoid coercion or misleading statements;
- document consent appropriately;
- promptly communicate withdrawal requests to responsible personnel.

Only authorized personnel may modify official consent records.

17.19 Organizational Commitment

ADP considers meaningful consent to be an expression of individual autonomy and an essential component of trustworthy data governance.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to ensuring that consent is requested only where appropriate, obtained through transparent and respectful processes, accurately documented, and honored throughout its lifecycle.

By maintaining robust consent management procedures, ADP strengthens individual trust, supports regulatory compliance, and reinforces its commitment to ethical, transparent, and responsible processing of personal data.

18. Personal Data Breach Management

18.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that despite appropriate technical and organizational safeguards, personal data breaches may occur due to human error, technical failures, cyberattacks, natural disasters, or malicious activities.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a structured and coordinated approach for identifying, reporting, assessing, containing, investigating, documenting, and responding to personal data breaches while minimizing risks to individuals and the organization.

Rapid and transparent response is essential to protecting Data Subjects, maintaining public confidence, and ensuring compliance with applicable legal obligations.

18.2 Definition of a Personal Data Breach

For the purposes of this Policy, a **Personal Data Breach** means any security incident leading to the accidental or unlawful:

- destruction;
- loss;
- alteration;
- unauthorized disclosure of;
- unauthorized access to;

personal data processed by ADP.

A breach may involve electronic records, paper records, verbal disclosures, photographs, audio recordings, video recordings, cloud services, portable devices, or any other medium containing personal data.

18.3 Examples of Personal Data Breaches

Examples include, but are not limited to:

- sending personal information to the wrong recipient;
- loss or theft of laptops, USB drives, or mobile devices;
- ransomware attacks;
- malware infections;
- unauthorized access to databases;
- accidental publication of confidential documents;
- disclosure of children's personal information;
- compromised passwords or user accounts;
- unauthorized use of AI platforms involving confidential data;
- physical theft of paper records;
- unauthorized viewing of personnel files.

Not every cybersecurity incident constitutes a personal data breach, but every suspected breach shall be assessed.

18.4 Reporting Obligations

Every employee, volunteer, consultant, contractor, researcher, intern, and partner acting on behalf of ADP shall report any suspected or confirmed personal data breach immediately upon discovery.

No individual shall attempt to conceal, ignore, or independently resolve a suspected breach without informing the designated responsible personnel.

Prompt reporting is essential to reducing harm.

18.5 Initial Response

Upon becoming aware of a suspected breach, ADP shall take immediate action to:

- contain the incident;
- prevent further unauthorized access;
- preserve evidence;
- secure affected systems;
- identify affected information;
- notify appropriate internal personnel.

Immediate containment shall take priority over determining responsibility.

18.6 Breach Response Team

ADP shall designate an appropriate Breach Response Team, which may include:

- Executive Director;
- Data Protection Officer (where appointed);
- Information Security Officer or IT Administrator;
- Legal Advisor;
- Communications Officer;
- Project Manager(s), where relevant;
- other specialists as required.

The composition of the team shall reflect the nature and severity of the incident.

18.7 Initial Assessment

Following notification, ADP shall conduct an initial assessment considering:

- what happened;
- when the incident occurred;
- how it was detected;
- categories of personal data involved;
- number of affected individuals;
- sensitivity of the information;
- whether data were encrypted;
- likelihood of misuse;
- potential impact on individuals.

This assessment shall determine the urgency of subsequent actions.

18.8 Risk Assessment

Each breach shall be evaluated according to the level of risk posed to Data Subjects.

The assessment shall consider:

- identity theft;
- financial fraud;
- reputational harm;
- discrimination;
- psychological harm;
- physical safety;
- safeguarding concerns;
- unauthorized profiling;
- confidentiality breaches;
- long-term consequences.

Risk assessments shall be documented.

18.9 Notification to the Supervisory Authority

Where required by applicable legislation, ADP shall notify the competent supervisory authority without undue delay after becoming aware of a reportable personal data breach.

The notification shall include, where available:

- description of the breach;
- categories of personal data affected;
- approximate number of individuals concerned;
- likely consequences;
- measures already taken;
- planned mitigation actions;
- contact details for further information.

Where complete information is not immediately available, supplementary information may be provided as it becomes available.

18.10 Communication with Data Subjects

Where a breach is likely to result in a high risk to the rights and freedoms of individuals, ADP shall communicate with affected Data Subjects without undue delay.

Communications shall be:

- clear;
- concise;
- transparent;
- understandable.

The notification should explain:

- what happened;
 - what information was involved;
 - possible consequences;
 - actions already taken by ADP;
 - recommended protective measures for the individual;
 - contact information for assistance.
-

18.11 Investigation

Every significant breach shall be investigated to determine:

- root causes;
- contributing factors;
- organizational weaknesses;
- technical failures;
- procedural deficiencies;
- human factors;
- lessons learned.

Investigations shall focus on organizational improvement rather than assigning blame, except where misconduct or deliberate violations are identified.

18.12 Corrective and Preventive Actions

Following investigation, ADP shall implement appropriate corrective and preventive measures, which may include:

- software updates;
- security enhancements;
- policy revisions;
- additional staff training;
- revised procedures;
- improved access controls;
- enhanced monitoring;
- contractual improvements.

Corrective actions shall be tracked until completion.

18.13 Documentation

Every personal data breach, regardless of whether notification is required, shall be documented.

Records shall include:

- incident reference number;
- date discovered;
- reporting individual;
- description of the incident;

- affected systems;
- categories of personal data;
- assessment findings;
- notifications made;
- corrective actions;
- closure date.

Documentation supports accountability and regulatory compliance.

18.14 Breach Register

ADP shall maintain a centralized **Personal Data Breach Register**.

The register shall facilitate:

- trend analysis;
- audit preparation;
- organizational learning;
- regulatory reporting;
- continuous improvement.

The structure of the register is provided in **Appendix E – Personal Data Breach Report Form** and may be supplemented by an internal incident log.

18.15 Confidentiality During Investigations

Information relating to ongoing breach investigations shall be disclosed only to individuals with a legitimate need to know.

Personnel involved in investigations shall maintain strict confidentiality.

Premature public disclosure shall be avoided unless required by law or approved by authorized management.

18.16 Cooperation with Authorities

Where appropriate, ADP shall cooperate fully with:

- supervisory authorities;
- law enforcement agencies;
- funding organizations;
- contractual partners;
- cybersecurity experts;
- external auditors.

Cooperation shall remain consistent with legal obligations and the protection of affected individuals.

18.17 Training and Exercises

ADP shall periodically provide training and practical exercises covering:

- breach identification;
- reporting procedures;
- phishing response;
- ransomware scenarios;
- accidental disclosure;
- communication protocols;
- incident documentation.

Simulation exercises should be conducted periodically to improve organizational preparedness.

18.18 Continuous Improvement

Lessons learned from incidents, near misses, audits, and cybersecurity assessments shall be incorporated into the continuous improvement of ADP's privacy and information security programme.

Policies, procedures, technical controls, and staff awareness shall be updated whenever improvements are identified.

18.19 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that timely and effective management of personal data breaches is fundamental to protecting individuals, maintaining organizational integrity, and fulfilling legal responsibilities.

Accordingly, every person acting on behalf of ADP shares responsibility for identifying, reporting, and responding to personal data breaches in a prompt, transparent, and professional manner.

Through effective incident response, continuous learning, and proactive risk reduction, ADP seeks to minimize harm, strengthen resilience, and maintain the confidence of its members, partners, beneficiaries, donors, and the wider public.

19. Privacy by Design and by Default

19.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to embedding privacy and data protection into the design, development, implementation, operation, and continuous improvement of all organizational activities.

Privacy shall not be treated as an optional feature or an afterthought.

Instead, appropriate privacy safeguards shall be incorporated from the earliest stages of planning and maintained throughout the entire lifecycle of every project, service, system, process, and technology.

This proactive approach supports legal compliance, strengthens public trust, reduces organizational risk, and promotes responsible digital innovation.

19.2 Principles

Privacy by Design requires that privacy considerations be integrated proactively into organizational decision-making.

Privacy by Default requires that systems automatically provide the highest practical level of privacy protection without requiring action from individuals.

Together these principles ensure that:

- privacy is proactive rather than reactive;
 - personal data collection is minimized;
 - security is integrated from the beginning;
 - transparency is maintained;
 - accountability is documented;
 - individuals retain control over their information.
-

19.3 Scope

These requirements apply to:

- digital services;
- websites;
- mobile applications;
- research projects;
- educational platforms;
- Artificial Intelligence systems;
- cloud services;
- databases;
- software development;
- procurement activities;
- administrative processes;
- new organizational initiatives.

Every significant organizational change shall consider privacy implications before implementation.

19.4 Project Planning

Privacy considerations shall be incorporated during project planning.

Project documentation should include:

- processing objectives;
- categories of personal data;
- lawful basis;
- privacy risks;
- security measures;
- retention requirements;
- data sharing arrangements;
- accountability responsibilities.

Privacy planning shall begin before personal data are collected.

19.5 Data Minimisation by Design

Projects shall be designed to collect only personal data that are genuinely necessary.

Project teams shall consider whether objectives can be achieved using:

- anonymized information;
- pseudonymized information;
- aggregated statistics;
- synthetic datasets;
- non-personal information.

Where less intrusive alternatives exist, they shall be preferred.

19.6 Default Privacy Settings

Systems developed or implemented by ADP shall provide privacy-friendly default settings whenever technically feasible.

Examples include:

- minimum data collection;
- disabled public profiles by default;
- limited visibility of personal information;
- restricted sharing options;
- optional marketing communications;
- disabled location tracking unless required;
- shortest appropriate retention settings.

Individuals should not be required to modify settings in order to obtain reasonable privacy protection.

19.7 Software Development

Software developed by or for ADP shall incorporate privacy throughout the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC).

Development teams should consider:

- secure coding practices;
- access controls;
- encryption;
- authentication;
- audit logging;
- vulnerability testing;
- privacy testing;
- secure deployment.

Privacy requirements shall be documented alongside functional requirements.

19.8 Website and Mobile Applications

Digital platforms shall be designed to:

- minimize personal data collection;
- present clear Privacy Notices;
- support user consent where applicable;
- protect user sessions;
- use secure communications;
- provide accessible privacy controls;
- support the exercise of Data Subject Rights.

Privacy functionality shall be reviewed whenever significant changes are introduced.

19.9 Artificial Intelligence Systems

Artificial Intelligence solutions implemented by ADP shall incorporate privacy protections from the earliest stages of development and deployment.

AI projects shall consider:

- lawful basis for processing;
- data minimisation;
- fairness;
- explainability;
- transparency;
- human oversight;
- bias mitigation;
- security;
- accountability.

AI shall never be designed to circumvent privacy protections.

19.10 Procurement and Vendor Selection

Privacy shall form part of procurement decision-making.

Before selecting suppliers processing personal data, ADP shall evaluate:

- privacy governance;
- security practices;
- legal compliance;
- certifications where applicable;
- contractual safeguards;
- incident response capabilities;
- international transfer implications.

Privacy considerations shall influence procurement decisions alongside financial and technical criteria.

19.11 Research Activities

Research projects involving personal data shall integrate privacy throughout the research lifecycle.

Researchers shall consider:

- ethical approval where required;
- participant information;
- informed consent;
- anonymization;
- secure storage;
- publication risks;
- data sharing;
- long-term retention.

Research design shall seek to minimize risks to participants.

19.12 Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIAs)

Where processing is likely to present a high risk to individuals, ADP shall conduct a **Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)** before processing begins.

A DPIA should evaluate:

- nature of processing;
- necessity;
- proportionality;
- risks;
- mitigation measures;
- residual risks;
- implementation responsibilities.

The DPIA template is provided in **Appendix F** of this Policy.

19.13 Testing and Development Environments

Personal data shall not normally be used within software development or testing environments.

Where testing requires realistic datasets:

- anonymized information shall be preferred;
- pseudonymization shall be considered;
- access shall be restricted;
- datasets shall be securely deleted following testing.

Production databases shall not routinely be copied into development environments.

19.14 Change Management

Whenever significant changes are introduced to systems or organizational processes, privacy impacts shall be reviewed before implementation.

Examples include:

- new technologies;
- system upgrades;
- organizational restructuring;
- mergers;
- new project activities;
- cloud migrations;
- AI deployment.

Where risks increase significantly, a new DPIA may be required.

19.15 Documentation

ADP shall maintain appropriate documentation demonstrating how Privacy by Design has been implemented.

Documentation may include:

- DPIAs;
- project privacy assessments;
- design decisions;
- risk assessments;
- technical documentation;
- security reviews;
- testing reports.

These records support accountability and continuous improvement.

19.16 Monitoring and Review

Privacy controls shall be reviewed periodically to determine whether:

- objectives remain valid;
- risks have changed;
- legislation has evolved;
- technologies have changed;
- additional safeguards are required.

Continuous improvement shall form part of every privacy programme.

19.17 Staff Responsibilities

Project managers, researchers, developers, IT personnel, procurement staff, and organizational leaders shall ensure that privacy considerations are integrated into planning, implementation, and operational decision-making.

Every individual involved in the development or acquisition of systems processing personal data shares responsibility for implementing Privacy by Design principles.

19.18 Organizational Commitment

ADP believes that effective privacy protection begins long before personal data are collected.

Accordingly, privacy shall be embedded into the culture, governance, technologies, services, and decision-making processes of the organization.

By adopting Privacy by Design and Privacy by Default as foundational organizational principles, ADP aims to develop innovative digital solutions that are secure, transparent, accountable, and respectful of the rights and freedoms of every individual.

20. Website Privacy, Cookies, and Digital Services

20.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to protecting the privacy of individuals who access its websites, digital platforms, online services, mobile applications, and other electronic communication channels.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish the principles governing the collection, use, storage, protection, and disclosure of personal data processed through ADP's digital services while ensuring transparency, user control, and compliance with applicable privacy legislation.

20.2 Scope

This chapter applies to all ADP-operated digital services, including:

- official websites;
- project websites;
- mobile applications;
- online registration systems;
- learning management systems;
- digital collaboration platforms;
- online surveys;
- donation platforms;
- newsletters;
- web-based research tools;
- AI-assisted online services.

Third-party websites not controlled by ADP are outside the scope of this Policy, although links to such services may be provided.

20.3 Privacy Notice

Every ADP website or digital platform shall provide an accessible Privacy Notice explaining:

- the identity of the data controller;
- categories of personal data collected;
- purposes of processing;
- lawful bases for processing;
- recipients of personal data;
- international data transfers, where applicable;
- retention periods;
- Data Subject Rights;
- contact details for privacy-related inquiries.

The Privacy Notice shall be written in clear, concise, and user-friendly language.

20.4 Information Collected Automatically

When individuals access ADP's digital services, certain technical information may be collected automatically to ensure the secure and efficient operation of the service.

This information may include:

- IP address;
- browser type and version;
- operating system;
- device type;
- referring website;
- pages visited;
- date and time of access;
- session identifiers;
- language preferences;
- diagnostic information.

Automatic collection shall be limited to what is necessary for security, functionality, and legitimate operational purposes.

20.5 Contact Forms

Where users submit information through contact forms, ADP shall collect only the personal data necessary to respond to the inquiry.

Information collected may include:

- name;
- email address;
- organization;
- subject of inquiry;
- message content.

Contact form data shall not be used for unrelated purposes without an appropriate lawful basis.

20.6 Newsletter Subscriptions

Individuals subscribing to newsletters shall receive information regarding:

- the purpose of communications;
- subscription frequency;
- methods for unsubscribing;
- privacy protections.

Every newsletter shall provide a simple mechanism allowing recipients to withdraw their subscription at any time.

20.7 Online Registration Systems

Where online registration is used for projects, conferences, training programmes, or events, ADP shall ensure that:

- only necessary personal data are collected;
 - secure transmission is used;
 - mandatory and optional fields are clearly identified;
 - participants receive privacy information before submitting their information.
-

20.8 Cookies

ADP websites may use cookies and similar technologies to improve functionality, security, and user experience.

Cookies shall be categorized as follows:

Essential Cookies

These cookies are necessary for the operation of the website and cannot normally be disabled.

Examples include:

- authentication;
 - security;
 - session management;
 - accessibility settings.
-

Functional Cookies

Functional cookies enhance user experience by remembering preferences such as:

- language selection;
- accessibility preferences;
- regional settings;

- interface customization.
-

Analytics Cookies

Analytics cookies help ADP understand how visitors interact with its digital services.

Analytics should, where feasible:

- minimize personal data collection;
 - anonymize IP addresses where technically possible;
 - avoid unnecessary tracking.
-

Marketing Cookies

Marketing cookies shall only be used where:

- legally permitted;
- appropriate consent has been obtained.

Users shall remain free to reject marketing cookies without losing access to essential website functionality.

20.9 Cookie Consent

Where consent is required, ADP shall provide an appropriate Cookie Consent mechanism allowing users to:

- accept all cookies;
- reject non-essential cookies;
- customize preferences;
- change preferences at any time.

Consent records shall be maintained where required by applicable legislation.

20.10 Third-Party Services

ADP websites may integrate third-party services such as:

- interactive maps;
- video hosting platforms;
- online meeting services;
- social media content;
- payment gateways;
- document-sharing platforms.

Before enabling such services, ADP shall assess their privacy implications and implement appropriate safeguards.

20.11 Embedded Content

Embedded content originating from third-party websites may collect information independently from ADP.

Examples include:

- videos;
- interactive presentations;
- maps;
- external publications;
- social media feeds.

Where appropriate, users shall be informed before such content is loaded.

20.12 Web Analytics

ADP may use web analytics tools to evaluate website performance and improve digital services.

Analytics shall be implemented in a privacy-conscious manner by:

- limiting unnecessary identifiers;
- retaining data only as long as necessary;
- restricting access to analytics data;
- regularly reviewing analytics configurations.

Where feasible, privacy-friendly analytics solutions shall be preferred.

20.13 AI-Powered Digital Services

Where AI-powered assistants, chatbots, or automated support systems are deployed, ADP shall ensure that:

- users are informed that AI is being used;
- conversations are processed lawfully;
- confidential information is protected;
- AI-generated responses remain subject to appropriate human oversight where necessary;
- interactions are handled in accordance with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

Users should avoid submitting highly sensitive personal information through public AI interfaces unless expressly instructed that appropriate safeguards are in place.

20.14 Server Logs

Web servers may generate technical logs necessary for:

- cybersecurity;
- incident investigation;
- troubleshooting;

- fraud prevention;
- system administration.

Server logs shall be retained only for legitimate operational purposes and protected against unauthorized access.

20.15 Security of Digital Services

ADP shall implement appropriate safeguards to protect digital platforms, including:

- HTTPS encryption;
- secure authentication;
- regular security updates;
- vulnerability management;
- malware protection;
- access controls;
- backup procedures;
- monitoring and logging.

Security measures shall be proportionate to the nature of the services provided.

20.16 Accessibility

Digital services shall, wherever reasonably practicable, be designed to support accessibility for all users.

ADP shall strive to ensure that websites and digital platforms are:

- understandable;
- navigable;
- compatible with assistive technologies;
- available to users with disabilities.

Accessibility improvements shall be incorporated into the continuous development of digital services.

20.17 Children's Online Privacy

Digital services intended for children or likely to be accessed by children shall incorporate enhanced privacy protections.

Where required:

- parental authorization shall be obtained;
- profiling shall be avoided;
- unnecessary tracking technologies shall not be used;
- marketing directed at children shall be prohibited.

The best interests of the child shall remain the primary consideration.

20.18 External Links

ADP websites may contain links to third-party websites for informational purposes.

ADP is not responsible for the privacy practices, security measures, or content of external websites.

Users are encouraged to review the privacy policies of third-party services before providing personal information.

20.19 Monitoring and Review

Digital privacy practices shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued compliance with:

- applicable legislation;
- technological developments;
- cybersecurity requirements;
- accessibility standards;
- organizational objectives.

Necessary improvements shall be implemented without undue delay.

20.20 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that trust in digital services depends upon transparency, security, accessibility, and responsible stewardship of personal information.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to designing and operating websites, mobile applications, and digital platforms that respect user privacy, provide meaningful control over personal data, and incorporate modern security and privacy safeguards from the outset.

Through continuous improvement, responsible innovation, and adherence to recognized international standards, ADP seeks to deliver digital services that are secure, inclusive, and worthy of the confidence placed in them by members, partners, beneficiaries, researchers, donors, and the wider public.

21. Monitoring, Auditing and Compliance

21.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to maintaining an effective, accountable, and continuously improving privacy management system. Compliance with this Data Protection & Privacy Policy shall not be regarded as a one-time activity but as an ongoing organizational responsibility.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish the framework for monitoring, auditing, reviewing, and continually improving ADP's data protection practices to ensure sustained compliance with applicable legislation, contractual obligations, international standards, and organizational policies.

21.2 Scope

This chapter applies to all organizational units, projects, programmes, digital platforms, employees, volunteers, consultants, researchers, contractors, and partner organizations involved in the processing of personal data on behalf of ADP.

Monitoring and auditing activities shall encompass both manual and automated processing operations, regardless of the medium or technology used.

21.3 Objectives

The objectives of ADP's monitoring and compliance programme are to:

- verify compliance with this Policy;
 - evaluate the effectiveness of privacy controls;
 - identify non-conformities and areas for improvement;
 - reduce privacy and cybersecurity risks;
 - demonstrate accountability to stakeholders;
 - support legal and regulatory compliance;
 - promote a culture of continuous improvement.
-

21.4 Compliance Responsibilities

The Board of Directors, Executive Director, managers, project leaders, and all personnel share responsibility for ensuring compliance with this Policy.

Specific responsibilities include:

- implementing approved procedures;
- monitoring compliance within their areas of responsibility;
- cooperating during audits;
- correcting identified deficiencies;
- reporting significant compliance issues to senior management.

Compliance is a shared organizational responsibility.

21.5 Internal Monitoring

ADP shall conduct regular monitoring activities to evaluate the effectiveness of its privacy programme.

Monitoring activities may include:

- review of processing activities;
- verification of lawful bases;
- review of retention practices;
- access control reviews;
- consent management reviews;
- breach register reviews;

- Data Subject Rights request monitoring;
- review of third-party processors;
- technical security monitoring.

Monitoring shall be proportionate to the level of privacy risk.

21.6 Internal Audits

Periodic internal audits shall be conducted to assess compliance with:

- this Policy;
- applicable legislation;
- contractual obligations;
- organizational procedures;
- information security requirements;
- Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
- other relevant organizational policies.

Audits shall be planned using a risk-based approach.

21.7 External Audits

Where appropriate, ADP may participate in external audits conducted by:

- funding organizations;
- supervisory authorities;
- certification bodies;
- external auditors;
- project partners;
- independent assessors.

ADP shall cooperate fully with legitimate audit activities while protecting confidential information and the rights of Data Subjects.

21.8 Audit Planning

Audit programmes shall consider factors including:

- organizational risks;
- previous audit findings;
- significant processing activities;
- legislative changes;
- new technologies;
- Artificial Intelligence deployments;
- cybersecurity incidents;
- major organizational changes.

Higher-risk activities shall receive greater audit attention.

21.9 Audit Methodology

Audits may include:

- document review;
- interviews;
- observation of processes;
- sampling of records;
- system inspections;
- technical testing;
- compliance verification.

Audit methods shall be objective, evidence-based, and proportionate.

21.10 Compliance Indicators

ADP may establish Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) to measure the effectiveness of its privacy programme.

Examples include:

- number of Data Subject Rights requests;
- response times;
- privacy incidents;
- personal data breaches;
- staff training completion rates;
- audit findings;
- overdue corrective actions;
- processor review status;
- completion of DPIAs.

Indicators shall be reviewed periodically by management.

21.11 Non-Conformities

Where monitoring or audits identify non-conformities, ADP shall:

- document the finding;
- assess associated risks;
- determine root causes;
- assign responsibility;
- establish corrective actions;
- define implementation deadlines;
- verify completion.

Significant non-conformities shall be reported to senior management.

21.12 Corrective and Preventive Actions

Corrective actions shall address identified deficiencies.

Preventive actions shall seek to reduce the likelihood of future non-conformities.

Actions may include:

- policy revisions;
- procedural improvements;
- technical enhancements;
- additional staff training;
- contractual amendments;
- organizational restructuring.

Corrective actions shall remain open until verified as effective.

21.13 Management Review

Senior management shall periodically review the effectiveness of the organization's privacy management system.

Management reviews should consider:

- audit results;
- compliance reports;
- privacy incidents;
- breach statistics;
- legal developments;
- stakeholder feedback;
- technological changes;
- resource requirements;
- opportunities for improvement.

Management review supports strategic decision-making and organizational accountability.

21.14 Regulatory Compliance

ADP shall monitor developments in:

- data protection legislation;
- privacy regulations;
- cybersecurity requirements;
- Artificial Intelligence governance;
- international standards;
- funding requirements.

Where legislative or regulatory changes affect organizational processing activities, this Policy and related procedures shall be updated accordingly.

21.15 Documentation and Records

Monitoring and audit activities shall be documented appropriately.

Records may include:

- audit plans;
- audit reports;
- monitoring reports;
- compliance checklists;
- management review minutes;
- corrective action logs;
- follow-up reports;
- improvement plans.

Documentation shall be retained in accordance with the Personal Data Retention Schedule.

21.16 Continuous Improvement

ADP is committed to continually improving its privacy management programme.

Improvement opportunities may arise from:

- audits;
- incidents;
- complaints;
- technological innovation;
- staff suggestions;
- external assessments;
- lessons learned;
- benchmarking against recognized standards.

Continuous improvement shall be integrated into normal organizational operations.

21.17 Cooperation and Accountability

All personnel shall cooperate fully with legitimate monitoring, audit, and compliance activities.

Failure to cooperate without reasonable justification may constitute a breach of organizational responsibilities and may result in appropriate corrective or disciplinary measures.

21.18 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that effective monitoring, independent auditing, and continuous compliance are fundamental to maintaining public trust and protecting the rights of individuals.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to regularly evaluating its privacy management system, identifying opportunities for improvement, addressing deficiencies without delay, and fostering a culture of accountability, transparency, and continuous learning.

Through systematic monitoring, evidence-based auditing, and proactive compliance management, ADP seeks to ensure that its data protection practices remain effective, resilient, and aligned with evolving legal, technological, and organizational requirements.

22. Training and Awareness

22.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that people are the cornerstone of effective data protection and privacy governance. While technical and organizational safeguards are essential, the success of any privacy programme ultimately depends on the knowledge, awareness, competence, and responsible behaviour of those who process personal data.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a comprehensive training and awareness framework that ensures all individuals acting on behalf of ADP understand their privacy responsibilities, comply with applicable legal and organizational requirements, and contribute to a culture of privacy, security, and accountability.

Privacy awareness shall be regarded as a continuous organizational responsibility rather than a one-time training activity.

22.2 Scope

This chapter applies to all individuals acting on behalf of ADP, including:

- members of the Board of Directors;
- Executive Director;
- employees;
- volunteers;
- researchers;
- project managers;
- consultants;
- interns;
- contractors;
- temporary personnel;
- partner organizations processing personal data on behalf of ADP, where appropriate.

Training requirements shall be proportionate to each individual's role and level of responsibility.

22.3 Objectives

The objectives of ADP's privacy training and awareness programme are to:

- promote a culture of privacy and accountability;
- ensure understanding of applicable data protection legislation;
- explain organizational policies and procedures;

- reduce human error and privacy risks;
 - improve incident identification and reporting;
 - strengthen cybersecurity awareness;
 - support ethical processing of personal data;
 - ensure consistent implementation of privacy controls across the organization.
-

22.4 Training Principles

Privacy training provided by ADP shall be:

- relevant to organizational responsibilities;
- role-based;
- practical;
- understandable;
- regularly updated;
- accessible to all personnel;
- documented and measurable.

Training shall be reviewed periodically to reflect changes in legislation, technology, organizational practices, and emerging risks.

22.5 Induction Training

Every new employee, volunteer, consultant, intern, or contractor who will process personal data shall receive privacy training as part of the onboarding process before or shortly after being granted access to personal data.

Induction training shall introduce:

- ADP's privacy principles;
 - confidentiality obligations;
 - acceptable use of organizational information;
 - reporting procedures;
 - information security basics;
 - responsibilities under this Policy.
-

22.6 Role-Based Training

Additional training shall be provided to personnel whose responsibilities involve higher levels of privacy risk.

Role-specific training may be provided to:

- senior management;
- project managers;
- researchers;
- human resources personnel;
- finance personnel;

- IT administrators;
- communications staff;
- safeguarding officers;
- procurement personnel;
- Artificial Intelligence project teams.

Training content shall reflect the specific processing activities undertaken by each role.

22.7 Mandatory Training Topics

Privacy training may include, as appropriate:

- data protection principles;
 - lawful bases for processing;
 - Data Subject Rights;
 - confidentiality obligations;
 - consent management;
 - records management;
 - information classification;
 - secure handling of personal data;
 - cybersecurity awareness;
 - phishing and social engineering;
 - password security;
 - remote working;
 - secure use of cloud services;
 - Artificial Intelligence and privacy;
 - children's personal data;
 - safeguarding obligations;
 - incident reporting;
 - personal data breach management.
-

22.8 Awareness Activities

ADP shall promote ongoing privacy awareness through activities such as:

- awareness campaigns;
- newsletters;
- guidance documents;
- posters;
- internal announcements;
- webinars;
- workshops;
- seminars;
- awareness events;
- cybersecurity awareness campaigns.

Awareness initiatives should encourage continuous engagement rather than reliance solely on formal training.

22.9 Artificial Intelligence Awareness

Given ADP's focus on digital innovation, personnel using Artificial Intelligence tools shall receive additional guidance covering:

- responsible AI use;
- protection of confidential information;
- verification of AI-generated outputs;
- bias and fairness;
- privacy risks associated with AI services;
- secure use of external AI platforms;
- human oversight requirements.

Training shall be aligned with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

22.10 Information Security Awareness

Privacy awareness shall be integrated with information security education.

Personnel shall receive guidance regarding:

- secure authentication;
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA);
- encryption;
- secure email practices;
- ransomware prevention;
- safe internet usage;
- secure handling of portable devices;
- reporting cybersecurity incidents.

Privacy and cybersecurity shall be presented as complementary organizational responsibilities.

22.11 Training Frequency

Privacy training shall be provided:

- during induction;
- periodically thereafter;
- whenever significant legal or organizational changes occur;
- following major privacy or cybersecurity incidents where lessons learned should be shared;
- before deployment of significant new technologies where appropriate.

Refresher training shall reinforce existing knowledge and address emerging risks.

22.12 Training Records

ADP shall maintain records demonstrating completion of privacy training.

Training records may include:

- participant name;
- role;
- training title;
- training date;
- training provider;
- attendance status;
- assessment results where applicable.

Training records shall be retained in accordance with the Personal Data Retention Schedule.

22.13 Evaluation of Effectiveness

The effectiveness of privacy training shall be evaluated periodically through methods such as:

- knowledge assessments;
- practical exercises;
- phishing simulations;
- staff feedback;
- audit findings;
- incident analysis;
- observation of organizational practices.

Evaluation results shall be used to improve future training programmes.

22.14 Responsibilities

Managers shall ensure that personnel under their supervision complete required privacy training.

Individuals participating in training are responsible for:

- actively engaging in learning activities;
- applying acquired knowledge in daily work;
- seeking clarification where necessary;
- reporting identified privacy risks;
- complying with organizational policies and procedures.

Training does not replace individual responsibility for lawful and ethical conduct.

22.15 Continuous Improvement

The privacy training programme shall be reviewed regularly considering:

- legislative developments;
- technological advances;
- audit findings;
- incident trends;
- organizational growth;

- emerging privacy risks;
- feedback from participants.

Training materials shall be updated to reflect evolving best practices and organizational needs.

22.16 Organizational Commitment

ADP believes that effective privacy protection begins with informed and responsible people.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to providing continuous education, practical guidance, and meaningful awareness initiatives that enable all personnel to understand their responsibilities and contribute to the protection of personal data.

By investing in knowledge, fostering ethical behaviour, and promoting a culture of continuous learning, ADP strengthens its privacy governance framework, enhances organizational resilience, and reinforces the trust placed in it by members, partners, beneficiaries, donors, and the wider community.

23. Violations and Disciplinary Measures

23.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that effective data protection requires not only appropriate policies, procedures, and technical safeguards, but also individual accountability.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a fair, transparent, and proportionate framework for addressing violations of this Data Protection & Privacy Policy and related organizational requirements.

ADP is committed to responding consistently to non-compliance while promoting a culture of learning, responsibility, and continuous improvement.

Disciplinary measures shall be applied fairly, objectively, and in accordance with applicable legislation, employment obligations, contractual commitments, and the principles of natural justice.

23.2 Scope

This chapter applies to all individuals acting on behalf of ADP, including:

- members of the Board of Directors;
- Executive Director;
- employees;
- volunteers;
- researchers;
- consultants;
- interns;

- contractors;
- temporary personnel;
- partner organizations processing personal data on behalf of ADP, where contractually applicable.

All individuals are expected to comply with this Policy regardless of their role or employment status.

23.3 General Principles

Violations of this Policy shall be managed according to the following principles:

- fairness;
- proportionality;
- consistency;
- accountability;
- confidentiality;
- due process;
- non-discrimination;
- respect for individual rights.

Disciplinary action shall be proportionate to the nature, severity, intent, frequency, and consequences of the violation.

23.4 Examples of Policy Violations

Examples of conduct that may constitute a violation include, but are not limited to:

- unauthorized access to personal data;
- unauthorized disclosure of confidential information;
- processing personal data without a lawful basis;
- failure to protect passwords or authentication credentials;
- failure to report a suspected personal data breach;
- misuse of organizational information systems;
- unauthorized use of Artificial Intelligence platforms involving confidential data;
- unauthorized copying or removal of personal data;
- excessive collection of personal data;
- retention of personal data beyond approved retention periods;
- destruction of records contrary to organizational procedures;
- failure to comply with Data Subject Rights procedures;
- deliberate circumvention of security controls;
- unauthorized sharing of personal data with third parties;
- repeated failure to complete mandatory privacy training.

This list is illustrative and not exhaustive.

23.5 Categories of Violations

Violations may be categorized according to their severity.

Minor Violations

Examples may include:

- isolated procedural errors;
- unintentional administrative mistakes;
- delayed completion of required documentation;
- minor failures to follow approved procedures without resulting harm.

Minor violations should normally be addressed through guidance, coaching, or additional training.

Moderate Violations

Examples may include:

- repeated procedural failures;
- negligent handling of personal data;
- failure to comply with documented privacy procedures;
- unauthorized disclosure with limited impact;
- failure to report security concerns promptly.

Moderate violations may require formal corrective action and disciplinary measures.

Serious Violations

Examples include:

- intentional misuse of personal data;
- deliberate unauthorized disclosure;
- fraudulent activity;
- malicious access to confidential information;
- destruction or alteration of records;
- concealment of personal data breaches;
- intentional violation of legal obligations;
- actions resulting in significant harm to individuals or ADP.

Serious violations may result in termination of employment or contractual relationships and, where appropriate, referral to competent authorities.

23.6 Reporting Violations

Every individual acting on behalf of ADP has a responsibility to report suspected violations of this Policy.

Reports may be submitted through approved organizational reporting channels.

Individuals making reports in good faith shall not be subjected to retaliation.

False or malicious allegations made knowingly may themselves constitute a disciplinary matter.

23.7 Investigation Process

Reported violations shall be investigated promptly, objectively, and confidentially.

Investigations may include:

- review of documentation;
- interviews;
- examination of system logs;
- review of access records;
- technical analysis;
- consultation with legal or technical specialists.

Investigations shall seek to establish facts impartially while respecting the rights of all parties involved.

23.8 Rights of Individuals Subject to Investigation

Individuals who are the subject of an investigation shall, where appropriate:

- be informed of the allegations;
- have an opportunity to respond;
- be treated fairly and respectfully;
- have their confidentiality protected;
- receive decisions based on objective evidence.

No disciplinary action shall be taken solely on the basis of unverified allegations.

23.9 Disciplinary Measures

Depending upon the circumstances, disciplinary measures may include:

- verbal guidance;
- written warning;
- mandatory retraining;
- increased supervision;
- temporary restriction of system access;
- reassignment of responsibilities;
- suspension, where permitted by applicable law;
- termination of employment or contractual engagement;
- recovery of damages where legally justified;
- referral to competent regulatory or law enforcement authorities.

The chosen measure shall reflect the seriousness of the violation and applicable legal requirements.

23.10 Corrective Actions

In addition to disciplinary measures, ADP shall implement appropriate corrective actions to address underlying causes.

Corrective actions may include:

- policy revisions;
- procedural improvements;
- enhanced technical safeguards;
- additional staff training;
- improved supervision;
- risk assessments;
- security enhancements.

Corrective actions shall seek to prevent recurrence rather than merely respond to individual incidents.

23.11 Cooperation with Authorities

Where violations involve suspected unlawful activity or regulatory obligations, ADP may cooperate with:

- supervisory authorities;
- law enforcement agencies;
- judicial authorities;
- funding organizations;
- external auditors.

Such cooperation shall be conducted in accordance with applicable legal obligations and organizational procedures.

23.12 Documentation

All significant violations and related disciplinary actions shall be documented appropriately.

Documentation may include:

- incident reports;
- investigation records;
- evidence reviewed;
- decisions reached;
- disciplinary measures applied;
- corrective actions;
- follow-up activities.

Records shall be maintained securely and retained in accordance with the Personal Data Retention Schedule.

23.13 Appeals

Where applicable under employment contracts, organizational procedures, or national legislation, individuals subject to disciplinary action shall have the right to request a review or appeal of the decision.

Appeals shall be considered fairly, impartially, and without undue delay.

23.14 Lessons Learned

Following significant violations, ADP shall evaluate:

- contributing factors;
- organizational weaknesses;
- policy effectiveness;
- training needs;
- technical improvements;
- opportunities for strengthening privacy governance.

Lessons learned shall be incorporated into the organization's continuous improvement programme.

23.15 Protection Against Retaliation

ADP encourages the prompt reporting of genuine concerns regarding privacy, information security, or unlawful processing of personal data.

No individual who reports a concern in good faith, participates in an investigation, or cooperates with authorized authorities shall suffer retaliation, discrimination, intimidation, or other adverse treatment as a result of such actions.

Retaliation against individuals acting in good faith shall itself constitute a serious violation of this Policy.

23.16 Organizational Commitment

ADP believes that accountability is an essential component of responsible data governance.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to addressing violations of this Policy in a manner that is fair, transparent, consistent, and proportionate, while respecting the rights of all individuals involved.

Through effective investigation, appropriate disciplinary action, meaningful corrective measures, and a commitment to organizational learning, ADP seeks not only to address instances of non-compliance but also to strengthen its culture of integrity, professionalism, privacy, and continuous improvement.

24. Review and Continuous Improvement

24.1 Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that effective data protection and privacy management require continuous evaluation, adaptation, and improvement in response to evolving legal, technological, organizational, and societal developments.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish a structured framework for the periodic review, evaluation, and continual enhancement of ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Management System, ensuring that it remains effective, relevant, and aligned with international best practices.

Continuous improvement is a fundamental principle of responsible organizational governance and an essential component of ADP's commitment to accountability and excellence.

24.2 Scope

This chapter applies to all components of ADP's privacy management framework, including:

- this Data Protection & Privacy Policy;
- supporting procedures;
- operational practices;
- information systems;
- digital services;
- research activities;
- Artificial Intelligence applications;
- information security controls;
- organizational governance arrangements;
- training and awareness programmes.

Continuous improvement shall apply to both strategic and operational levels of the organization.

24.3 Guiding Principles

Review and improvement activities shall be based upon the principles of:

- accountability;
- transparency;
- evidence-based decision-making;
- risk-based thinking;
- continual learning;
- proportionality;
- stakeholder engagement;
- organizational resilience.

Improvements shall seek not only to correct deficiencies but also to strengthen organizational capability and future readiness.

24.4 Periodic Policy Review

This Policy shall be formally reviewed at least once every two (2) years, or more frequently where necessary.

Earlier reviews may be initiated in response to:

- legislative or regulatory changes;
- significant organizational restructuring;

- new technologies or Artificial Intelligence systems;
- major privacy or cybersecurity incidents;
- audit findings;
- supervisory authority recommendations;
- changes in funding or contractual requirements;
- significant changes in organizational activities.

Reviews shall determine whether revisions to this Policy or related procedures are required.

24.5 Sources of Improvement

Opportunities for improvement may be identified through:

- internal monitoring;
- internal and external audits;
- management reviews;
- personal data breach investigations;
- complaints and feedback;
- Data Subject Rights requests;
- staff suggestions;
- lessons learned from projects;
- risk assessments;
- technological developments;
- benchmarking against recognized international standards.

ADP encourages proactive identification of improvement opportunities rather than relying solely on corrective actions following incidents.

24.6 Performance Evaluation

The effectiveness of ADP's privacy management system shall be evaluated using appropriate qualitative and quantitative measures.

Performance evaluation may include:

- achievement of compliance objectives;
- completion of training programmes;
- audit results;
- implementation of corrective actions;
- incident trends;
- response times to Data Subject requests;
- effectiveness of privacy controls;
- stakeholder satisfaction.

Performance indicators shall support informed management decision-making.

24.7 Corrective and Preventive Improvement

Where deficiencies or weaknesses are identified, ADP shall implement corrective and preventive actions designed to:

- eliminate root causes;
- reduce future risks;
- strengthen governance;
- improve operational efficiency;
- enhance regulatory compliance;
- increase organizational resilience.

The effectiveness of implemented actions shall be verified following completion.

24.8 Innovation and Emerging Technologies

As an organization dedicated to digital innovation, ADP shall regularly assess the privacy implications of emerging technologies, including:

- Artificial Intelligence;
- machine learning;
- cloud computing;
- Internet of Things (IoT);
- blockchain technologies;
- advanced analytics;
- digital identity systems;
- future digital technologies relevant to ADP's mission.

Innovation shall be encouraged while ensuring that privacy, security, ethics, and human rights remain integral to technological development.

24.9 Regulatory and Standards Monitoring

ADP shall monitor developments relating to:

- data protection legislation;
- privacy regulations;
- cybersecurity legislation;
- Artificial Intelligence governance;
- international standards;
- funding requirements;
- guidance issued by supervisory authorities;
- recognized best practices.

Where relevant developments are identified, organizational policies and procedures shall be updated accordingly.

24.10 Stakeholder Feedback

ADP values feedback from:

- members;
- employees;
- volunteers;
- beneficiaries;
- researchers;
- donors;
- project partners;
- supervisory authorities;
- members of the public.

Constructive feedback shall be considered during policy reviews and organizational improvement initiatives.

24.11 Documentation

All significant review and improvement activities shall be appropriately documented.

Documentation may include:

- policy review reports;
- management review records;
- audit reports;
- improvement plans;
- corrective action registers;
- updated procedures;
- approval records;
- implementation reports.

Documentation shall demonstrate organizational accountability and support future reviews.

24.12 Responsibilities

The Board of Directors shall provide strategic oversight of the organization's privacy governance framework.

Senior management shall ensure that:

- periodic reviews are conducted;
- necessary resources are available;
- improvements are implemented;
- organizational priorities remain aligned with this Policy.

Managers shall monitor implementation within their respective areas of responsibility.

All personnel are encouraged to contribute suggestions that strengthen privacy protection and organizational effectiveness.

24.13 Policy Approval and Version Control

This Policy shall be subject to formal approval by the Board of Directors or another duly authorized governing body of ADP.

The organization shall maintain documented version control, including:

- policy version number;
- approval date;
- effective date;
- summary of revisions;
- approving authority;
- scheduled review date.

Only the current approved version shall be considered authoritative.

24.14 Integration with Other Organizational Policies

This Policy shall be implemented in conjunction with ADP's broader governance framework, including but not limited to:

- Code of Ethics;
- Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy;
- Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy;
- Safeguarding & Protection Policy;
- Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy;
- Risk Management Policy;
- Research Integrity & Open Science Policy;
- Human Resources policies;
- Procurement Rules;
- Business Continuity and Incident Response procedures.

Together, these documents form an integrated governance system supporting responsible, ethical, and secure organizational operations.

24.15 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that privacy governance is an evolving discipline requiring continuous attention, responsible leadership, and organizational learning.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to regularly reviewing its policies, evaluating the effectiveness of its controls, embracing innovation responsibly, and adapting proactively to changing legal, technological, and societal expectations.

Through systematic review, evidence-based improvement, stakeholder engagement, and a culture of continuous learning, ADP seeks to maintain a privacy management system that is resilient, transparent, accountable, and aligned with the highest international standards of data protection and responsible digital governance.

End of Policy

This Policy shall enter into force upon its approval by the Board of Directors of the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX and shall remain effective until amended or replaced.

Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule

A.1 Purpose

This Personal Data Retention Schedule establishes the standard retention periods for personal data processed by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX. It provides a consistent framework for determining how long personal data should be retained, the legal or operational justification for retention, and the approved method for secure disposal.

This Schedule supports compliance with:

- General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)
- Applicable national legislation
- Funding organization requirements
- Contractual obligations
- Financial and tax legislation
- Research ethics requirements
- Organizational operational needs

Retention periods represent the maximum period for which records should normally be kept unless a longer period is required by law, contractual obligation, litigation, investigation, audit, or another legitimate reason.

A.2 General Retention Principles

ADP shall retain personal data only for as long as necessary to fulfil the purposes for which it was collected.

When determining retention periods, ADP shall consider:

- legal obligations;
- contractual requirements;
- statutory limitation periods;
- research requirements;
- financial reporting obligations;
- funding programme requirements;
- safeguarding responsibilities;
- operational necessity;
- public interest considerations.

Once the applicable retention period expires, personal data shall be securely deleted, anonymized, or destroyed unless another lawful basis for continued retention exists.

A.3 Retention Schedule

Record Category	Examples	Retention Period	Legal / Business Disposal	
			Justification	Method
Membership	Member	7 years after membership	Organizational	Secure deletion

Record Category	Examples	Retention Period	Legal / Business Justification	Disposal Method
Records	applications, membership status	ends	governance	/ shredding
Board of Directors Records	Board member information	10 years after mandate ends	Governance and legal accountability	Secure deletion
Volunteer Records	Volunteer agreements, assignments	5 years after engagement ends	Organizational administration	Secure deletion
Employee Personnel Files	Employment contracts, evaluations	7 years after employment ends (or longer if required by law)	Employment legislation	Secure destruction
Recruitment Records (Unsuccessful Applicants)	CVs, applications	12 months unless consent for longer retention is obtained	Recruitment administration	Secure deletion
Successful Recruitment Files	Hiring documentation	Incorporated into personnel file	into Employment records	As personnel file
Payroll Records	Salary records	Minimum period required under applicable tax and employment legislation (normally 7–10 years)	Financial legislation	Secure destruction
Attendance Records	Attendance sheets	3 years	Administrative purposes	Secure deletion
Training Records	Certificates, attendance lists	5 years	Competency records	Secure deletion
Privacy Training Records	GDPR training	Duration of engagement + 5 years	Compliance evidence	Secure deletion
Data Subject Rights Requests	Access, rectification requests	5 years after closure	GDPR accountability	Secure deletion
Consent Records	Signed consent forms	Duration of processing + 5 years	GDPR Article 7 accountability	Secure deletion
Personal Data Breach Records	Incident reports	Minimum 6 years after closure	GDPR compliance	Secure deletion

Record Category	Examples	Retention Period	Legal / Business Justification	Disposal Method
DPIA Documentation	Data Protection Impact Assessments	Life of processing activity + 6 years	GDPR accountability	Secure deletion
ROPA Register	Processing activities	Maintain continuously; archive previous versions for 6 years	GDPR Article 30	Secure archive
Contracts Processors	with Data Processing Agreements	Contract duration + 7 years	Contractual obligations	Secure destruction
Supplier Records	Procurement documentation	7 years	Financial accountability	Secure destruction
Financial Records	Invoices, accounting documents	Minimum period required under applicable financial and tax legislation (commonly 7–10 years)	Legal obligation	Secure destruction
Grant Documentation	EU-funded project records	As required by grant agreement (typically 5–10 years after project closure)	Funding compliance	Secure destruction
Audit Documentation	Internal and external audit reports	7 years	Governance	Secure archive
Complaints	Privacy complaints	5 years after resolution	Accountability	Secure deletion
Website Contact Forms	General inquiries	Up to 24 months unless ongoing communication requires longer retention	Customer service	Secure deletion
Newsletter Subscribers	Email addresses	Until unsubscribe or withdrawal of consent	Consent management	Secure deletion
Website Analytics	Aggregated analytics	According to configured retention period, normally not exceeding 26 months unless anonymized	Website improvement	Automatic deletion
Server Logs	Security logs	Normally 6–12 months unless required for investigations	Cybersecurity	Secure deletion
CCTV Recordings (if Security		Normally 30–90 days unless required for	Security for	Automatic

Record Category	Examples	Retention Period	Legal / Business Justification	Disposal Method
applicable)	recordings	investigation		overwrite
Event Registration Data	Conference registrations	2 years after event unless project requirements specify otherwise	Event administration	Secure deletion
Conference Attendance Lists	Participant records	5 years	Project reporting	Secure deletion
Research Participant Data	Research projects	According to approved research protocol and ethics requirements (commonly 5–15 years)	Scientific integrity	Secure anonymization or destruction
Research Forms	Consent Participant consent	Retained together with research documentation	Research ethics	Secure archive
Safeguarding Records	Child protection cases	According to safeguarding legislation and organizational safeguarding policy; typically until the individual reaches adulthood plus applicable legal period	Safeguarding	Restricted archive
Children's Personal Data	Personal Educational activities	Only as long as necessary for programme administration	Child protection	Secure deletion
AI Datasets	Training AI development data	Until training purpose completed unless anonymized for legitimate long-term use	AI governance	Secure anonymization
AI Processing Logs	AI system operation	Normally 2 years unless longer retention is justified	Accountability	Secure deletion
Cloud Copies	Backup Backup archives	According to approved backup schedule	Disaster recovery	Automatic secure overwrite
Email Communications	Routine correspondence	According to business relevance; generally 3–7 years	Operational needs	Secure deletion
Legal Case Files	Litigation records	Until conclusion of Legal		Secure archive

Record Category	Examples	Retention Period	Legal / Business Justification	Disposal Method
		proceedings applicable period	plus obligations limitation	
Insurance Records	Claims documentation	According to insurance and legal requirements	Legal compliance	Secure destruction
Visitor Logs	Reception records	Normally 12 months	Physical security	Secure destruction

A.4 Exceptions

Retention periods may be extended where necessary due to:

- ongoing litigation;
- regulatory investigations;
- audits;
- insurance claims;
- law enforcement requests;
- contractual disputes;
- safeguarding investigations;
- legal hold requirements.

During such periods, disposal activities shall be suspended until authorization for disposal is granted.

A.5 Secure Disposal Requirements

Upon expiry of the applicable retention period, personal data shall be disposed of using methods appropriate to the storage medium.

Examples include:

Paper Records

- cross-cut shredding;
- certified confidential waste destruction;
- secure incineration where appropriate.

Electronic Records

- secure deletion;
- cryptographic erasure;
- overwriting of storage media;
- destruction of storage devices where necessary.

Portable Media

- physical destruction;

- certified secure disposal;
- degaussing where appropriate.

Disposal shall ensure that personal data cannot reasonably be reconstructed or recovered.

A.6 Review of the Retention Schedule

This Retention Schedule shall be reviewed:

- at least every two years;
 - whenever legislation changes;
 - following significant organizational changes;
 - after major audits;
 - following significant privacy incidents;
 - when introducing new categories of processing activities.
-

A.7 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that appropriate retention and secure disposal of personal data are fundamental components of responsible data governance.

By retaining information only for as long as necessary and ensuring its secure disposal when no longer required, ADP minimizes privacy risks, supports legal compliance, protects individual rights, and demonstrates accountability in accordance with internationally recognized data protection principles.

Appendix B – Record of Processing Activities (ROPA Register)

B.1 Purpose

This Record of Processing Activities (ROPA) is maintained by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX in accordance with Article 30 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

The purpose of this Register is to document all personal data processing activities carried out by ADP, demonstrate accountability, facilitate privacy governance, support regulatory compliance, and provide evidence during audits or inspections.

The Register shall be maintained as a living document and updated whenever significant changes occur in processing activities.

B.2 Scope

This Register applies to all processing activities performed by ADP, including activities conducted:

- by employees;

- by volunteers;
- by project teams;
- by researchers;
- by consultants;
- by contractors;
- by processors acting on behalf of ADP.

Both electronic and paper-based processing activities shall be included.

B.3 Instructions for Completing the Register

Each processing activity shall be recorded separately.

Where similar activities share identical characteristics, they may be grouped together where appropriate.

The Register shall be reviewed periodically to ensure accuracy and completeness.

B.4 Record of Processing Activities Register

Refer ence No.	Proce ssing Activi ty	Depart ment / Projec t	Data Contr oller	Purpo se of Proce ssing	Categ ories of Data Subje cts	Categ ories of Perso nal Data	La wful Basis	Spec ial Cate gory Data	Recip ients	Interna tional Transfe r	Reten tion Period	Secur ity Meas ures	DPIA Requ ired	Proc essor Involved	No tations
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B.5 Example Entry – Membership Administration

Field	Example
Reference No.	ROPA-001
Processing Activity	Membership Administration
Department	Administration
Purpose	Managing membership applications and records
Data Subjects	Members
Personal Data	Name, address, phone number, email, membership number
Lawful Basis	Contract / Legitimate Interests
Special Category Data	No
Recipients	Authorized administrative staff

Field	Example
International Transfers	None
Retention	7 years after membership ends
Security Measures	Role-based access control, encrypted storage
DPIA Required	No
Processor	Membership management software provider
Notes	Annual review

B.6 Example Entry – Human Resources

Field	Example
Reference No.	ROPA-002
Processing Activity	Human Resources Management
Department	Human Resources
Purpose	Employment administration
Data Subjects	Employees
Personal Data	Name, identification details, payroll data, contact information
Lawful Basis	Employment Contract, Legal Obligation
Special Category Data	Limited health information where required
Recipients	HR personnel, payroll provider
International Transfers	None
Retention	According to Appendix A
Security Measures	Encryption, restricted access
DPIA Required	No
Processor	Payroll service provider
Notes	Annual review

B.7 Example Entry – Research Projects

Field	Example
Reference No.	ROPA-003
Processing Activity	Research Participant Management
Department	Research
Purpose	Conducting scientific research
Data Subjects	Research participants
Personal Data	Demographic information, survey responses, research identifiers
Lawful Basis	Consent / Public Interest / Scientific Research
Special Category Data	Possible
Recipients	Research team
International Transfers	Only where approved
Retention	According to research protocol
Security Measures	Pseudonymisation, encrypted storage
DPIA Required	Usually Yes
Processor	Research platform provider
Notes	Ethics Committee approval required

B.8 Example Entry – Event Registration

Field	Example
Reference No.	ROPA-004
Processing Activity	Event Registration
Department	Events
Purpose	Organizing conferences and training programmes
Data Subjects	Participants
Personal Data	Name, organization, email, dietary requirements
Lawful Basis	Contract / Consent
Special Category Data	Dietary or accessibility requirements where voluntarily provided

Field	Example
Recipients	Event organizers
International Transfers	None
Retention	2 years
Security Measures	Secure registration platform
DPIA Required	Normally No
Processor	Event registration software
Notes	Attendance reporting

B.9 Mandatory Information for Each Processing Activity

Every processing activity should, where applicable, document:

- processing reference number;
 - processing owner;
 - business purpose;
 - categories of data subjects;
 - categories of personal data;
 - categories of recipients;
 - lawful basis;
 - special category data;
 - international transfers;
 - technical safeguards;
 - organizational safeguards;
 - retention period;
 - disposal method;
 - processor involvement;
 - applicable contracts;
 - DPIA status;
 - review date.
-

B.10 Review Responsibilities

Each department or project manager shall review processing activities within their area of responsibility at least annually.

Changes requiring updates include:

- introduction of new projects;
- new digital platforms;
- Artificial Intelligence systems;
- new categories of personal data;

- new processors;
 - international data transfers;
 - legislative changes;
 - changes in retention periods.
-

B.11 Version Control

Each update of the Register shall include:

Version Date Author Approved By Summary of Changes

Previous versions shall be archived in accordance with ADP's Records Management procedures.

B.12 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that maintaining an accurate and up-to-date Record of Processing Activities is a cornerstone of privacy accountability and effective data governance.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to documenting all relevant processing activities in a transparent, accurate, and systematic manner. The Register shall serve not only as a compliance requirement under the GDPR but also as a practical management tool for identifying risks, supporting privacy impact assessments, improving operational oversight, and demonstrating responsible stewardship of personal data.

Through regular review and continuous maintenance of this Register, ADP strengthens its commitment to transparency, accountability, and compliance with internationally recognized data protection standards.

Appendix C – Personal Data Classification Matrix

C.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Personal Data Classification Matrix is to establish a consistent framework for identifying, classifying, handling, storing, transmitting, sharing, and disposing of personal data and other information assets processed by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX.

Appropriate classification enables ADP to apply security measures proportionate to the sensitivity, confidentiality, integrity, and availability requirements of each category of information.

This Classification Matrix supports:

- GDPR accountability;
- Information Security Management;
- Privacy Management;
- Risk Management;
- Business Continuity;

- Artificial Intelligence governance;
 - Secure information sharing.
-

C.2 Scope

This Classification Matrix applies to:

- all personal data;
 - research data;
 - employee information;
 - volunteer information;
 - member information;
 - financial records;
 - project documentation;
 - contractual documentation;
 - digital systems;
 - paper records;
 - cloud services;
 - backup media;
 - Artificial Intelligence training datasets;
 - any other information processed by ADP.
-

C.3 Classification Principles

Information shall be classified according to:

- sensitivity;
- confidentiality;
- legal obligations;
- potential harm from unauthorized disclosure;
- business value;
- operational importance;
- regulatory requirements.

The highest applicable classification shall always prevail.

C.4 Classification Levels

ADP adopts four primary information classification levels.

Level 1 – Public

Description

Information approved for unrestricted public disclosure.

Unauthorized disclosure causes no harm.

Examples

- published reports;
- public website content;
- newsletters;
- brochures;
- public event announcements;
- press releases;
- approved promotional materials;
- publicly available research outputs.

Access

Unrestricted.

Storage

No special restrictions.

Transmission

Standard communication methods.

Encryption

Not required unless combined with higher-classified information.

Disposal

Normal disposal procedures.

Level 2 – Internal

Description

Information intended only for internal organizational use.

Unauthorized disclosure may cause minor operational inconvenience but is unlikely to cause significant harm.

Examples

- internal procedures;
- meeting agendas;
- project planning documents;
- internal correspondence;
- staff directories;
- draft reports;
- operational manuals;
- training materials.

Access

Authorized personnel only.

Storage

Organizational systems.

Transmission

Organizational email or approved collaboration platforms.

Encryption

Recommended during transmission.

Disposal

Secure deletion or confidential disposal.

Level 3 – Confidential

Description

Information requiring a high level of protection.

Unauthorized disclosure could result in legal, financial, operational, or reputational damage.

Examples

- personnel files;
- payroll information;
- membership records;
- contracts;
- financial records;
- supplier information;
- project proposals;
- grant documentation;
- personal data;
- procurement evaluations;
- audit reports;
- internal investigations.

Access

Need-to-know basis.

Storage

Encrypted organizational systems.

Transmission

Encrypted communication channels.

Encryption

Required.

Printing

Limited.

Disposal

Certified secure destruction.

Level 4 – Restricted

Description

Highly sensitive information requiring the highest level of protection.

Unauthorized disclosure may result in severe legal consequences, regulatory sanctions, significant financial loss, harm to individuals, or serious reputational damage.

Examples

- special category personal data;
- medical information;
- biometric data;
- safeguarding records;
- child protection files;
- criminal background checks;
- authentication credentials;
- cryptographic keys;
- system administrator passwords;
- AI training datasets containing identifiable information;
- personal data breach investigation files;
- ongoing legal investigations.

Access

Strictly limited to specifically authorized individuals.

Storage

Encrypted systems with enhanced access controls.

Transmission

Strong encryption only.

Multi-Factor Authentication

Mandatory.

Printing

Strongly discouraged.

Disposal

Certified secure destruction with documented evidence.

C.5 Classification Matrix

Classification	Examples	Access	Encryption	External Sharing	Disposal
Public	Website, brochures	Everyone	Optional	Permitted	Standard
Internal	Procedures, drafts	Staff	Recommended	Limited	Secure deletion
Confidential	Contracts, HR, finance	Need-to-know	Required	Authorized only	Secure destruction
Restricted	Medical, child protection, credentials	Explicit authorization	Mandatory	Exceptional circumstances only	Certified destruction

C.6 Handling Requirements

Personnel shall handle information according to its classification.

This includes:

- storage;
- copying;
- printing;
- scanning;
- emailing;
- sharing;
- archiving;
- disposal.

Information shall never be downgraded without appropriate authorization.

C.7 Labelling

Where appropriate, documents should include classification labels such as:

PUBLIC

INTERNAL

CONFIDENTIAL

RESTRICTED

Electronic documents should contain the classification within metadata or document headers where practicable.

C.8 Access Control

Access shall be granted according to:

- business need;
- least privilege principle;

- role-based access control;
- contractual responsibilities;
- confidentiality obligations.

Access rights shall be reviewed periodically.

C.9 Storage Requirements

Information shall be stored using security measures appropriate to its classification.

Examples include:

Classification Storage Requirement

Public Standard organizational storage

Internal Organizational network or approved cloud

Confidential Encrypted storage with restricted access

Restricted Encrypted storage with enhanced monitoring and MFA

C.10 Email and Electronic Transmission

Before transmitting information electronically, personnel shall verify:

- recipient identity;
- correct email address;
- classification level;
- encryption requirements;
- necessity of sharing.

Restricted information shall never be transmitted through unsecured communication channels.

C.11 Artificial Intelligence Systems

Personnel shall not upload Confidential or Restricted information into external Artificial Intelligence services unless:

- explicitly authorized;
- appropriate contractual safeguards exist;
- data protection requirements are satisfied;
- the processing complies with ADP's Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy.

Where possible, anonymized or pseudonymized information should be used for AI-assisted processing.

C.12 Third-Party Sharing

Before sharing Confidential or Restricted information with external organizations, ADP shall ensure:

- lawful basis;
 - confidentiality agreements;
 - Data Processing Agreements where applicable;
 - secure transmission;
 - recipient authorization;
 - minimum necessary disclosure.
-

C.13 Incident Reporting

Any suspected:

- unauthorized disclosure;
- misclassification;
- accidental sharing;
- loss of classified information;
- unauthorized access;
- security weakness;

shall be reported immediately using ADP's Personal Data Breach Management procedures.

C.14 Periodic Review

Classification decisions shall be reviewed:

- during annual audits;
- following major organizational changes;
- after significant incidents;
- when introducing new technologies;
- when processing activities change.

Information shall be reclassified where necessary.

C.15 Responsibilities

All personnel are responsible for:

- correctly identifying information classifications;
- applying appropriate security measures;
- protecting classified information;
- reporting suspected misuse;
- complying with organizational procedures.

Managers shall ensure appropriate classification within their operational areas.

C.16 Organizational Commitment

ADP recognizes that effective information classification is fundamental to protecting personal data, maintaining organizational resilience, and preserving the trust of members, beneficiaries, partners, donors, researchers, and the wider public.

Accordingly, the organization is committed to applying consistent and risk-based information classification practices throughout the information lifecycle. By ensuring that security controls are proportionate to the sensitivity of the information being processed, ADP strengthens its privacy governance framework, supports regulatory compliance, reduces organizational risk, and promotes the responsible management of information assets in accordance with internationally recognized standards and best practices.

Appendix D – Data Subject Rights Request Form

D.1 Purpose

This form enables individuals ("Data Subjects") to exercise their rights under applicable data protection legislation, including the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX will process requests fairly, transparently, and within the applicable statutory timeframes.

Completion of this form assists ADP in identifying the request, verifying the identity of the requester where necessary, and responding efficiently.

D.2 Applicant Information

Field	Information
Full Name	
Organization (if applicable)	
Postal Address	
City	
Country	
Telephone Number	
Email Address	
Preferred Method of Communication	☐ Email ☐ Telephone ☐ Postal Mail

D.3 Identity Verification

To protect personal data, ADP may require reasonable proof of identity before processing a request.

Please indicate the identity document provided.

Document Type	Provided
---------------	----------

Passport	☐
----------	--------------------------

National Identity Card	☐
------------------------	--------------------------

Driving Licence	☐
-----------------	--------------------------

Employee / Student ID	☐
-----------------------	--------------------------

Other	_____
-------	-------

Reference Number (Optional):

Note: Copies of identity documents shall be used solely for identity verification purposes and shall be securely deleted once verification has been completed, unless retention is required by law.

D.4 Capacity of the Applicant

Please indicate your relationship to the Data Subject.

☐ I am the Data Subject.

☐ I am acting on behalf of the Data Subject.

☐ Parent or Legal Guardian

☐ Authorized Representative

☐ Legal Counsel

☐ Other:

If acting on behalf of another individual, appropriate authorization or legal documentation must be provided.

D.5 Type of Request

Please select the right(s) you wish to exercise.

☐ Right of Access (Article 15 GDPR)

☐ Right to Rectification (Article 16 GDPR)

☐ Right to Erasure ("Right to be Forgotten") (Article 17 GDPR)

☐ Right to Restrict Processing (Article 18 GDPR)

- ☐ Right to Data Portability (Article 20 GDPR)
 - ☐ Right to Object to Processing (Article 21 GDPR)
 - ☐ Withdrawal of Consent
 - ☐ Rights relating to Automated Decision-Making and Profiling (Article 22 GDPR)
 - ☐ Complaint regarding Personal Data Processing
 - ☐ Other Privacy Request
-

D.6 Description of the Request

Please describe your request as clearly as possible.

Include any relevant dates, departments, projects, events, or communications that may help us locate the relevant information.

Request Details

D.7 Personal Data Concerned

Please indicate the categories of personal data involved.

- ☐ Name
- ☐ Contact Information
- ☐ Membership Information
- ☐ Employment Information
- ☐ Volunteer Information
- ☐ Financial Information
- ☐ Research Data
- ☐ Event Registration Information
- ☐ Website Information

- ☐ Newsletter Subscription
 - ☐ Photographs
 - ☐ Video Recordings
 - ☐ Children's Data
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Other
-
-

D.8 Preferred Response Format

Where applicable, please indicate how you would prefer to receive the response.

- ☐ Electronic Copy (PDF)
 - ☐ Secure Email
 - ☐ Printed Copy
 - ☐ Inspection of Records
 - ☐ Other
-
-

D.9 Supporting Information

Please list any documents attached to support your request.

Document	Attached
-----------------	-----------------

Identity Verification	☐
-----------------------	--------------------------

Authorization Document	☐
------------------------	--------------------------

Court Order (if applicable)	☐
-----------------------------	--------------------------

Previous Correspondence	☐
-------------------------	--------------------------

Other	
-------	-------

D.10 Applicant Declaration

I declare that the information provided in this request is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge.

I understand that ADP may request additional information where necessary to verify my identity or clarify my request before processing it.

I acknowledge that knowingly providing false or misleading information may delay or prevent the processing of this request.

Applicant Signature:

Name:

Date:

____ / ____ / _____

D.11 For Official Use Only

Field	Information
--------------	--------------------

Request Reference Number

Date Received

Received By

Identity Verified ☐ Yes ☐ No

Verification Method

Request Type

Department Responsible

Due Date for Response

Extension Applied ☐ Yes ☐ No

Extension Reason

Date Response Sent

Request Closed ☐ Yes ☐ No

D.12 Internal Assessment

Assessment Item	Completed
------------------------	------------------

Assessment Item	Completed
-----------------	-----------

Identity verified	☐
-------------------	--------------------------

Lawful basis reviewed	☐
-----------------------	--------------------------

Relevant records identified	☐
-----------------------------	--------------------------

Third parties consulted (if applicable)	☐
---	--------------------------

Legal review required	☐
-----------------------	--------------------------

Information redacted where necessary	☐
--------------------------------------	--------------------------

Response approved	☐
-------------------	--------------------------

D.13 Outcome of Request

☐ Access Granted

☐ Access Partially Granted

☐ Request Refused

☐ Data Corrected

☐ Data Deleted

☐ Processing Restricted

☐ Data Portability Completed

☐ Consent Withdrawn

☐ Objection Accepted

☐ Objection Rejected

☐ Other

Reason for Decision:

D.14 Notes

D.15 Privacy Notice

Personal data collected through this form will be processed solely for the purpose of handling and responding to your Data Subject Rights request in accordance with applicable data protection legislation.

The information provided will be accessed only by authorized personnel involved in processing your request and will be retained in accordance with ADP's **Personal Data Retention Schedule (Appendix A)**.

D.16 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to respecting and facilitating the rights of all Data Subjects. Every request submitted under this form shall be handled fairly, transparently, without undue delay, and in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), applicable national legislation, and ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy.

Where a request cannot be fulfilled in whole or in part, ADP will provide the applicant with a clear explanation of the reasons for its decision, together with information about any available rights to seek review or lodge a complaint with the competent supervisory authority.

Appendix E – Personal Data Breach Report Form

E.1 Purpose

This Personal Data Breach Report Form is used by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX to record, assess, investigate, manage, and document actual or suspected personal data breaches in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), applicable national legislation, and ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy.

Completion of this form does not automatically determine that a reportable breach has occurred. Rather, it serves as the official organizational record supporting breach assessment, regulatory compliance, corrective actions, and continuous improvement.

E.2 Incident Identification

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Breach Reference Number	
-------------------------	--

Date Report Submitted	
-----------------------	--

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Time Report Submitted

Reported By

Position / Role

Department / Project

Contact Details

E.3 Initial Detection

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Date Incident Discovered

Time Incident Discovered

Person Discovering
Incident

Method of Detection ☐ Staff Report ☐ System Alert ☐ Customer Complaint ☐ Audit ☐ Third
Party ☐ Other

Location of Incident

E.4 Description of the Incident

Provide a clear description of the incident.

Include:

- what happened;
 - when it occurred;
 - how it was discovered;
 - systems involved;
 - suspected cause.
-

Incident Description

E.5 Type of Personal Data Breach

Select all that apply.

- | | | |
|---|-----------------|--------|
| ☐ | Confidentiality | Breach |
| (Unauthorized disclosure or access) | | |
| ☐ | Integrity | Breach |
| (Unauthorized alteration) | | |
| ☐ | Availability | Breach |
| (Loss or destruction of data) | | |
| ☐ Combined Breach | | |
| ☐ Suspected Breach | | |
-

E.6 Categories of Personal Data Involved

- ☐ Names
 - ☐ Contact Information
 - ☐ Identification Numbers
 - ☐ Financial Information
 - ☐ Employment Records
 - ☐ Membership Records
 - ☐ Volunteer Records
 - ☐ Research Data
 - ☐ Children's Personal Data
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Photographs
 - ☐ Video Recordings
 - ☐ Login Credentials
 - ☐ AI Training Data
 - ☐ Other
-

E.7 Categories of Data Subjects Affected

- ☐ Members
 - ☐ Employees
 - ☐ Volunteers
 - ☐ Applicants
 - ☐ Research Participants
 - ☐ Event Participants
 - ☐ Children
 - ☐ Contractors
 - ☐ Donors
 - ☐ Website Users
 - ☐ Other
-
-

E.8 Estimated Number of Individuals Affected

Category	Number
----------	--------

Confirmed	
-----------	--

Estimated	
-----------	--

Unknown	
---------	--

E.9 Estimated Number of Records Affected

Category	Number
----------	--------

Confirmed	
-----------	--

Estimated	
-----------	--

Unknown	
---------	--

E.10 Cause of the Incident

Select all applicable.

- ☐ Human Error
 - ☐ Lost Device
 - ☐ Stolen Device
 - ☐ Phishing Attack
 - ☐ Malware
 - ☐ Ransomware
 - ☐ Unauthorized Access
 - ☐ System Misconfiguration
 - ☐ Technical Failure
 - ☐ Third-Party Failure
 - ☐ Artificial Intelligence Processing Error
 - ☐ Paper Record Loss
 - ☐ Physical Security Failure
 - ☐ Unknown
 - ☐ Other
-
-

E.11 Immediate Containment Actions

Describe actions taken immediately after discovery.

Examples:

- account disabled;
 - passwords changed;
 - system isolated;
 - access revoked;
 - backup restored;
 - affected equipment secured.
-

Containment Measures

E.12 Risk Assessment

Is there a risk to the rights and freedoms of individuals?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Under Assessment

If yes, describe the potential risks.

- ☐ Identity Theft
- ☐ Financial Loss
- ☐ Discrimination
- ☐ Reputational Damage
- ☐ Loss of Confidentiality
- ☐ Emotional Distress
- ☐ Physical Harm
- ☐ Fraud
- ☐ Other

Risk Assessment Notes

E.13 Notification to Supervisory Authority

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Notification Required	☐ Yes ☐ No
-----------------------	--

Supervisory Authority

Date Notified

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Time Notified

Reference Number

Notification within 72 Hours ☐ Yes ☐ No

If No, Explain Delay

E.14 Notification to Data Subjects

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Notification Required ☐ Yes ☐ No

Date Notification Sent

Communication Method

Number of Individuals Notified

Summary of Information Provided

E.15 External Parties Involved

Select all applicable.

☐ Data Processor

☐ Cloud Service Provider

☐ IT Service Provider

☐ Law Enforcement

☐ Insurance Provider

☐ Funding Organization

☐ External Legal Counsel

☐ Cybersecurity Consultant

☐ Other

E.16 Investigation Findings

Root Cause

Contributing Factors

Evidence Collected

E.17 Corrective Actions

Select all applicable.

- ☐ Password Reset
 - ☐ Access Rights Review
 - ☐ Encryption Implemented
 - ☐ Security Patch Installed
 - ☐ Policy Updated
 - ☐ Staff Retraining
 - ☐ Vendor Review
 - ☐ DPIA Updated
 - ☐ Additional Monitoring
 - ☐ Backup Improvements
 - ☐ Artificial Intelligence Controls Updated
 - ☐ Other
-
-

Implementation Details

E.18 Preventive Actions

Describe measures implemented to prevent recurrence.

E.19 Lessons Learned

Identify organizational improvements arising from this incident.

E.20 Incident Closure

Field	Information
--------------	--------------------

Investigation Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
-------------------------	--

Corrective Actions Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
------------------------------	--

Preventive Actions Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
------------------------------	--

Management Review Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
-----------------------------	--

Incident Officially Closed	☐ Yes ☐ No
----------------------------	--

Closure Date

E.21 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
-------------	-------------	------------------	-------------

Incident Investigator			
-----------------------	--	--	--

Information Security Representative			
-------------------------------------	--	--	--

Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)			
---	--	--	--

Executive Director			
--------------------	--	--	--

E.22 Confidentiality Classification

Classification Level

- ☐ Public
- ☐ Internal
- ☐ Confidential
- ☐ Restricted

Access to this report shall be limited to individuals with a legitimate business need and appropriate authorization.

E.23 Related Documents

Where applicable, reference the following:

- Data Protection Impact Assessment (Appendix F)
 - Risk Assessment
 - Incident Log
 - Security Logs
 - Audit Report
 - Corrective Action Register
 - Data Subject Notifications
 - Supervisory Authority Correspondence
 - Evidence Files
 - Lessons Learned Report
-

E.24 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to responding to personal data breaches promptly, transparently, and effectively. Every reported incident shall be assessed objectively, investigated thoroughly, documented comprehensively, and resolved through appropriate corrective and preventive actions.

This report supports ADP's commitment to accountability, continuous improvement, and compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), while helping to protect the rights and freedoms of individuals and strengthen the organization's overall privacy and information security governance.

Appendix F – Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) Template

F.1 Purpose

This Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) Template is designed to assist the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX in identifying, assessing, and mitigating privacy risks associated with processing activities that are likely to result in a high risk to the rights and freedoms of natural persons.

The DPIA process supports compliance with Article 35 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), promotes Privacy by Design and Privacy by Default principles, and strengthens responsible decision-making throughout the lifecycle of processing activities.

F.2 Project Information

Field	Information
-------	-------------

DPIA Reference Number	
-----------------------	--

Project / Processing Activity	
-------------------------------	--

Department / Project Team	
---------------------------	--

Project Manager	
-----------------	--

DPIA Prepared By	
------------------	--

Date of Assessment	
--------------------	--

Planned Processing Start Date	
-------------------------------	--

DPIA Version	
--------------	--

F.3 Description of the Processing Activity

Provide a concise description of the proposed processing activity.

Include:

- purpose of processing;
 - background;
 - systems involved;
 - technology used;
 - operational context.
-

Processing Description

F.4 Objectives of Processing

Describe the business, research, educational, or operational objectives.

F.5 Lawful Basis for Processing

Select the applicable lawful basis.

- ☐ Consent
- ☐ Contract
- ☐ Legal Obligation
- ☐ Vital Interests
- ☐ Public Task
- ☐ Legitimate Interests

Provide additional explanation where necessary.

F.6 Categories of Data Subjects

Select all applicable.

- ☐ Members
- ☐ Employees
- ☐ Volunteers
- ☐ Applicants
- ☐ Contractors

- ☐ Researchers
 - ☐ Research Participants
 - ☐ Children
 - ☐ Donors
 - ☐ Event Participants
 - ☐ Website Users
 - ☐ Other
-
-

F.7 Categories of Personal Data

Select all applicable.

- ☐ Identification Information
 - ☐ Contact Information
 - ☐ Employment Information
 - ☐ Financial Information
 - ☐ Membership Records
 - ☐ Educational Records
 - ☐ Research Data
 - ☐ Location Data
 - ☐ Online Identifiers
 - ☐ Images
 - ☐ Audio Recordings
 - ☐ Video Recordings
 - ☐ Children's Personal Data
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Criminal Offence Data
 - ☐ AI Training Data
 - ☐ Other
-

F.8 Processing Operations

Indicate the activities involved.

- ☐ Collection
- ☐ Recording
- ☐ Organization
- ☐ Structuring
- ☐ Storage
- ☐ Adaptation
- ☐ Retrieval
- ☐ Consultation
- ☐ Use
- ☐ Disclosure
- ☐ Sharing
- ☐ International Transfer
- ☐ Combination
- ☐ Pseudonymisation
- ☐ Anonymisation
- ☐ Archiving
- ☐ Deletion
- ☐ Destruction

F.9 Technology Used

Describe the technologies supporting the processing activity.

Examples include:

- cloud platforms;
- databases;
- Artificial Intelligence;
- mobile applications;
- websites;

- research software;
- learning management systems;
- analytics platforms.

Technology Description

F.10 Data Flow Overview

Briefly describe how personal data flows through the processing activity.

Include:

- collection;
- storage;
- access;
- sharing;
- retention;
- disposal.

Data Flow Description

F.11 Third Parties

Will personal data be shared with external organizations?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, identify:

- processors;
- partners;
- funding organizations;

- cloud providers;
 - research collaborators.
-
-

F.12 International Data Transfers

Will personal data leave the country or the European Economic Area (EEA)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, specify:

- destination country;
 - safeguard used;
 - transfer mechanism.
-
-

F.13 Necessity Assessment

Explain why processing is necessary.

F.14 Proportionality Assessment

Explain why the processing is proportionate to the intended purpose.

Consider:

- data minimisation;
 - transparency;
 - fairness;
 - limited retention;
 - accountability.
-
-
-

F.15 Privacy Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood (Low/Medium/High)	Impact (Low/Medium/High)	Overall Risk
Unauthorized Access			
Data Loss			
Accidental Disclosure			
Human Error			
Cyberattack			
AI Bias / Inaccurate Processing			
Excessive Data Collection			
Identity Theft			
Re-identification			
Other			

F.16 Existing Controls

Describe existing technical and organizational measures.

Examples:

- encryption;
- MFA;
- access control;
- staff training;
- confidentiality agreements;
- pseudonymisation;
- backups;
- logging.

F.17 Additional Mitigation Measures

Identify additional controls required before processing begins.

- ☐ Encryption
- ☐ Additional Authentication
- ☐ Privacy Notice Update
- ☐ DPIA Review
- ☐ Data Minimisation
- ☐ Pseudonymisation
- ☐ Anonymisation
- ☐ Staff Training
- ☐ Processor Contract
- ☐ AI Human Oversight
- ☐ Additional Monitoring
- ☐ Other

Implementation Notes

F.18 Artificial Intelligence Assessment

Will Artificial Intelligence be used?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, complete the following.

AI System

Purpose

Human Oversight

☐ Yes

☐ No

Automated Decision-Making

☐ Yes

☐ No

Bias Assessment Completed

☐ Yes

☐ No

Transparency Measures Implemented

☐ Yes

☐ No

Reference to Responsible AI Policy

☐ Yes

☐ No

F.19 Consultation

Were relevant stakeholders consulted?

☐ Data Protection Representative

☐ Information Security Representative

☐ Legal Advisor

☐ Project Manager

☐ Researchers

☐ Data Subjects

☐ Ethics Committee

☐ External Experts

☐ Other

F.20 Residual Risk Assessment

After implementation of mitigation measures, assess the remaining risk.

Residual Risk Rating

Low ☐

Medium ☐

Residual Risk Rating

High ☐

Provide justification.

F.21 Decision

- ☐ Processing Approved
- ☐ Processing Approved with Conditions
- ☐ Processing Deferred Pending Improvements
- ☐ Processing Not Approved

Reason

F.22 Review Schedule

Review Item	Date
-------------	------

Initial Review

Annual Review

Major Change Review

Project Closure Review

F.23 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
------	------	-----------	------

Project Manager

Information Security Representative

Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)

Executive Director

F.24 Related Documents

Reference, where applicable:

- Record of Processing Activities (Appendix B)
 - Personal Data Retention Schedule (Appendix A)
 - Risk Assessment
 - Information Security Risk Assessment
 - Vendor Risk Assessment
 - AI Risk Assessment
 - Research Ethics Approval
 - Data Processing Agreement
 - Information Asset Register
 - Personal Data Breach Register
-

F.25 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to integrating privacy considerations into the design, development, implementation, and operation of all projects, systems, and processing activities. By conducting Data Protection Impact Assessments where appropriate, ADP proactively identifies and mitigates privacy risks, supports informed decision-making, and demonstrates accountability under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

This DPIA Template forms an integral part of ADP's Privacy by Design framework and contributes to the organization's commitment to responsible innovation, ethical data processing, and the protection of the rights and freedoms of all individuals whose personal data it processes.

Appendix G – Consent Register

G.1 Purpose

The Consent Register is maintained by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX to document, manage, monitor, and demonstrate valid consent obtained from Data Subjects for the processing of personal data where consent constitutes the lawful basis for processing.

The Register supports compliance with Article 7 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) by providing evidence that consent was:

- freely given;
- specific;

- informed;
- unambiguous;
- properly documented;
- capable of being withdrawn at any time.

This Register also facilitates periodic review, consent renewal, and accountability.

G.2 Scope

This Register applies whenever ADP relies on consent as the lawful basis for processing personal data, including but not limited to:

- membership activities;
- newsletters;
- research participation;
- educational programmes;
- conferences and events;
- photography and video recording;
- publication of personal information;
- marketing communications;
- website cookies where consent is required;
- Artificial Intelligence research projects;
- processing of special category personal data.

Where another lawful basis applies (such as contract or legal obligation), consent shall not be unnecessarily requested or recorded.

G.3 Instructions

A separate record shall be maintained for each consent obtained.

Where multiple processing purposes are involved, separate consent options should be recorded wherever practicable.

Consent records shall be updated whenever:

- consent is renewed;
- consent is modified;
- consent is withdrawn;
- the processing purpose changes;

- additional processing activities are introduced.

G.4 Consent Register

Consent ID	Data Subject	Processing Purpose	Lawful Basis	Consent Obtained	Method	Consent Status	Expiry / Review Date	Withdrawal Date	Responsible Department	Notes
------------	--------------	--------------------	--------------	------------------	--------	----------------	----------------------	-----------------	------------------------	-------

G.5 Example Register Entry

Field	Example
Consent ID	CONS-2026-001
Data Subject	John Smith
Processing Purpose	Newsletter Subscription
Lawful Basis	Consent
Date Consent Obtained	15 March 2026
Method	Online Registration Form
Consent Status	Active
Review Date	15 March 2028
Withdrawal Date	—
Department	Communications
Notes	Double opt-in completed

G.6 Required Information

Each consent record should include, where applicable:

- Consent Reference Number;
- full name of the Data Subject;
- unique identifier where appropriate;
- processing purpose;
- categories of personal data involved;

- date and time consent was obtained;
 - method of obtaining consent;
 - version of the privacy notice presented;
 - version of the consent statement;
 - person or system obtaining consent;
 - lawful basis;
 - review date;
 - withdrawal status;
 - date of withdrawal where applicable;
 - remarks.
-

G.7 Methods of Obtaining Consent

Consent may be obtained through methods such as:

- signed paper forms;
- electronic forms;
- online registration systems;
- secure digital signatures;
- double opt-in email confirmation;
- research participation forms;
- event registration systems;
- mobile applications;
- recorded verbal consent where legally appropriate.

The method used shall be documented.

G.8 Categories of Consent

Examples of processing activities requiring consent may include:

- ☐ Newsletter Subscription
- ☐ Event Participation
- ☐ Photography
- ☐ Video Recording
- ☐ Publication of Images

- ☐ Research Participation
 - ☐ Scientific Research
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Marketing Communications
 - ☐ Cookies
 - ☐ Artificial Intelligence Research
 - ☐ Educational Activities
 - ☐ Child Participation
 - ☐ Other
-
-

G.9 Consent Status

Each consent shall be assigned one of the following statuses:

Status	Description
Active	Valid consent currently in force
Pending	Awaiting confirmation
Renewed	Consent renewed after review
Withdrawn	Consent withdrawn by the Data Subject
Expired	Consent no longer valid
Superseded	Replaced by updated consent
Invalid	Consent determined not to meet legal requirements

G.10 Withdrawal of Consent

Where consent is withdrawn:

- processing based solely on consent shall cease without undue delay;
- the withdrawal shall be recorded in the Register;
- the date of withdrawal shall be documented;
- relevant departments shall be notified where necessary;
- any continued processing shall rely on another valid lawful basis, where applicable.

Withdrawal of consent shall not affect the lawfulness of processing carried out before the withdrawal.

G.11 Consent Renewal

Consent should be reviewed periodically to ensure that it remains valid and appropriate.

Renewal may be required where:

- processing purposes change;
- significant new processing activities are introduced;
- privacy notices are substantially revised;
- long periods have elapsed since consent was obtained;
- legal requirements change.

The renewed consent shall replace the previous record while maintaining an audit trail.

G.12 Children's Consent

Where processing involves children and consent is the lawful basis:

- parental or legal guardian authorization shall be obtained where required by applicable law;
 - the identity and authority of the parent or guardian shall be verified where appropriate;
 - the method of obtaining consent shall be documented;
 - enhanced safeguards shall apply to the processing.
-

G.13 Special Category Personal Data

Where explicit consent is required for processing special category personal data, the Register should additionally record:

- the specific category of personal data;
 - the legal basis for requiring explicit consent;
 - the wording of the explicit consent statement;
 - any additional safeguards implemented.
-

G.14 Electronic Consent Records

Where consent is obtained electronically, ADP should retain, where technically feasible:

- date and time stamp;
- IP address or device identifier, where appropriate and lawful;

- consent version presented;
- privacy notice version;
- confirmation method;
- electronic audit log.

Electronic records shall be protected against unauthorized alteration.

G.15 Monitoring and Review

The Consent Register shall be reviewed periodically to verify:

- validity of existing consent;
- expired records;
- withdrawn consent;
- duplicate records;
- processing activities requiring renewed consent;
- consistency with the Record of Processing Activities (Appendix B).

Identified inconsistencies shall be corrected without undue delay.

G.16 Access and Confidentiality

Access to the Consent Register shall be limited to authorized personnel with a legitimate business need.

The Register shall be classified as **Confidential** in accordance with ADP's **Personal Data Classification Matrix (Appendix C)** and protected by appropriate technical and organizational security measures.

G.17 Version Control and Audit Trail

Any modification to the Consent Register shall maintain an audit trail documenting:

- date of change;
- person making the change;
- nature of the amendment;
- reason for the amendment;
- previous value, where technically feasible.

The integrity of consent records shall be preserved throughout their retention period.

G.18 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that valid consent is a cornerstone of lawful and transparent personal data processing where consent serves as the legal basis under the GDPR. Accordingly, ADP is committed to obtaining consent in a manner that is freely given, specific, informed, and unambiguous, while maintaining accurate and auditable records that demonstrate compliance.

Through the systematic maintenance of this Consent Register, ADP reinforces its commitment to accountability, transparency, and respect for the choices of Data Subjects, ensuring that consent remains meaningful, verifiable, and capable of being withdrawn at any time without disadvantage to the individual.

Appendix H – Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist

Appendix H – Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist

H.1 Purpose

This Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist is designed to assist the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX in evaluating whether a third-party processor or service provider provides appropriate technical, organizational, legal, and security safeguards before processing personal data on behalf of ADP.

The assessment supports compliance with:

- Article 28 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR);
- applicable national data protection legislation;
- ISO/IEC 27001;
- ISO/IEC 27701;
- ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy;
- ADP's Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy.

The checklist shall be completed before engaging any processor that will have access to personal data.

H.2 Processor Information

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Assessment Reference Number	
-----------------------------	--

Name of Processor	
-------------------	--

Company Registration Number	
-----------------------------	--

Field	Information
-------	-------------

Country of Registration	
-------------------------	--

Business Address	
------------------	--

Website	
---------	--

Contact Person	
----------------	--

Email Address	
---------------	--

Telephone	
-----------	--

Service Provided	
------------------	--

Date of Assessment	
--------------------	--

Assessor	
----------	--

H.3 Description of Processing

Briefly describe the services to be provided.

Include:

- purpose;
- systems involved;
- categories of personal data;
- expected duration.

Description

H.4 Personal Data Processed

Select all applicable.

☐ Identification Information

☐ Contact Information

☐ Financial Information

- ☐ Employment Data
 - ☐ Membership Data
 - ☐ Research Data
 - ☐ Children's Personal Data
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Images
 - ☐ Audio
 - ☐ Video
 - ☐ AI Training Data
 - ☐ Other
-
-

H.5 Categories of Data Subjects

- ☐ Members
 - ☐ Employees
 - ☐ Volunteers
 - ☐ Applicants
 - ☐ Contractors
 - ☐ Donors
 - ☐ Research Participants
 - ☐ Children
 - ☐ Website Users
 - ☐ Event Participants
 - ☐ Other
-
-

H.6 Processor Due Diligence Checklist

Assessment Question	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
Has the processor provided a Privacy Policy?	☐	☐	☐	

Assessment Question	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
Has the processor signed or agreed to sign a Data Processing Agreement (DPA)?	☐	☐	☐	
Does the processor process data only on documented instructions?	☐	☐	☐	
Has the processor identified a privacy contact or DPO (where applicable)?	☐	☐	☐	
Are confidentiality obligations imposed on personnel?	☐	☐	☐	
Does the processor maintain documented security policies?	☐	☐	☐	
Does the processor maintain a personal data breach procedure?	☐	☐	☐	
Does the processor maintain records of processing activities where required?	☐	☐	☐	

H.7 Information Security Assessment

Security Control	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
Encryption in transit	☐	☐	☐	
Encryption at rest	☐	☐	☐	
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)	☐	☐	☐	
Role-Based Access Control	☐	☐	☐	
Security Monitoring	☐	☐	☐	
Backup Procedures	☐	☐	☐	
Vulnerability Management	☐	☐	☐	
Patch Management	☐	☐	☐	
Physical Security Controls	☐	☐	☐	
Incident Response Process	☐	☐	☐	

H.8 Privacy Compliance Assessment

Requirement	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
GDPR compliance declared	☐	☐	☐	
Data Subject Rights supported	☐	☐	☐	

Requirement	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
Data minimisation applied	☐	☐	☐	
Purpose limitation applied	☐	☐	☐	
Retention periods defined	☐	☐	☐	
Secure deletion procedures exist	☐	☐	☐	
Privacy by Design implemented	☐	☐	☐	
Data Protection Impact Assessments supported where required	☐	☐	☐	

H.9 International Data Transfers

Does the processor transfer personal data outside the European Economic Area (EEA)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If **Yes**, complete the following.

Field	Information
Destination Country	
Adequacy Decision Available	☐ Yes ☐ No
Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) Used	☐ Yes ☐ No
Transfer Impact Assessment Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
Additional Safeguards Implemented	

H.10 Sub-Processors

Does the processor use sub-processors?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes:

Item	Information
List of Sub-Processors Obtained	☐

Item	Information
------	-------------

Approval Required by ADP	☐
--------------------------	--------------------------

Security Assessment Completed	☐
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International Transfers Reviewed	☐
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H.11 Artificial Intelligence Services

Will the processor use Artificial Intelligence when processing ADP data?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes:

Assessment Item	Yes No Comments	
AI processing disclosed	☐	☐
Human oversight available	☐	☐
AI outputs reviewed	☐	☐
Training on ADP data prohibited unless authorized	☐	☐
AI governance documentation available	☐	☐
AI bias controls documented	☐	☐

H.12 Certifications and Independent Assurance

Indicate whether the processor holds any of the following certifications or independent assurance reports.

Certification / Assurance	Yes No Expiry / Notes	
ISO/IEC 27001	☐	☐
ISO/IEC 27701	☐	☐
SOC 2 Type II	☐	☐
Cyber Essentials (or equivalent)	☐	☐
ISO 22301	☐	☐

Certification / Assurance	Yes	No	Expiry / Notes
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Independent Security Audit	☐	☐	
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Other	☐	☐	
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H.13 Risk Assessment

Risk Area	Low	Medium	High	Comments
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Privacy Risk	☐	☐	☐	
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Information Security Risk	☐	☐	☐	
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Regulatory Risk	☐	☐	☐	
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Operational Risk	☐	☐	☐	
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AI Risk	☐	☐	☐	
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Overall Risk Rating	☐	☐	☐	
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H.14 Recommended Actions

Select any actions required before engagement.

☐ Sign Data Processing Agreement (DPA)

☐ Complete DPIA

☐ Implement additional security controls

☐ Restrict processing activities

☐ Require encryption

☐ Require Multi-Factor Authentication

☐ Obtain legal review

☐ Conduct follow-up assessment

☐ Request additional documentation

☐ Reject processor

☐ Other

Implementation Notes

H.15 Final Assessment

Decision	Selected
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Approved	☐
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Approved with Conditions	☐
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Deferred Pending Improvements	☐
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Not Approved	☐
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Assessment Summary

H.16 Review Schedule

Review Activity	Date
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Initial Approval	
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Annual Review	
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Contract Renewal Review	
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Following Major Security Incident	
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Following Material Service Change	
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H.17 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
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Project / Department Manager			
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Information Security Representative			
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Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)			
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Executive Director			
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H.18 Supporting Documentation

The following documents should be obtained and retained where applicable:

- Privacy Policy
- Data Processing Agreement (DPA)
- Security Policy
- Information Security Certifications
- Independent Audit Reports
- Sub-Processor List
- Business Continuity Plan
- Incident Response Policy
- Penetration Test Summary (where available)
- Data Retention Policy
- AI Governance Documentation (if applicable)
- Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs), where applicable

H.19 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that the protection of personal data extends beyond its own operations to all third parties acting on its behalf. Accordingly, ADP is committed to selecting processors that demonstrate appropriate technical, organizational, legal, and ethical safeguards, consistent with the requirements of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and internationally recognized information security standards.

This Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist forms an integral part of ADP's vendor due diligence process and supports informed decision-making, ongoing supplier oversight, risk-based governance, and accountability throughout the lifecycle of third-party processing relationships.

Appendix I – International Data Transfer Assessment

I.1 Purpose

This International Data Transfer Assessment (IDTA) is used by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX to assess whether an international transfer of personal data provides an adequate level of protection for the rights and freedoms of Data Subjects.

The assessment supports compliance with:

- Chapter V of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR);
- Articles 44–49 GDPR;
- European Data Protection Board (EDPB) Recommendations;
- Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs), where applicable;
- applicable national legislation;
- ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy.

This assessment shall be completed before any international transfer of personal data takes place.

I.2 Transfer Identification

Field	Information
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Assessment Reference Number	
-----------------------------	--

Date of Assessment	
--------------------	--

Assessment Prepared By	
------------------------	--

Department / Project	
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Related Project	
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Planned Transfer Date	
-----------------------	--

Review Date	
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I.3 Exporter Information

Field	Information
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Data Exporter	Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX
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Country	North Macedonia
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Address	
---------	--

Contact Person	
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Email	
-------	--

I.4 Importer Information

Field	Information
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Field	Information
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Organization Name

Country

Address

Website

Contact Person

Email

Type of Organization ☐ Processor ☐ Controller ☐ Joint Controller

I.5 Description of the Transfer

Describe the purpose of the international transfer.

Include:

- business purpose;
- research activity;
- cloud service;
- funding programme;
- technical support;
- Artificial Intelligence service;
- educational collaboration.

Transfer Description

I.6 Categories of Data Subjects

Select all applicable.

☐ Members

☐ Employees

☐ Volunteers

- ☐ Applicants
 - ☐ Contractors
 - ☐ Research Participants
 - ☐ Children
 - ☐ Donors
 - ☐ Event Participants
 - ☐ Website Users
 - ☐ Other
-
-

I.7 Categories of Personal Data

- ☐ Identification Information
 - ☐ Contact Information
 - ☐ Employment Information
 - ☐ Membership Records
 - ☐ Financial Information
 - ☐ Research Data
 - ☐ Educational Records
 - ☐ Online Identifiers
 - ☐ Images
 - ☐ Audio Recordings
 - ☐ Video Recordings
 - ☐ Children's Personal Data
 - ☐ Special Category Personal Data
 - ☐ Criminal Offence Data
 - ☐ AI Training Data
 - ☐ Other
-
-

I.8 Purpose of Transfer

Select the primary purpose.

- ☐ Cloud Hosting
 - ☐ Research Collaboration
 - ☐ Funding Administration
 - ☐ IT Support
 - ☐ Software as a Service (SaaS)
 - ☐ Human Resources
 - ☐ Accounting
 - ☐ Learning Management System
 - ☐ Artificial Intelligence Processing
 - ☐ Event Management
 - ☐ Other
-
-

I.9 Destination Country Assessment

Assessment Item	Information
Destination Country	
European Commission Adequacy Decision Available ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Adequacy Decision Reference	
National Data Protection Law Reviewed	☐ Yes ☐ No
Supervisory Authority Identified	☐ Yes ☐ No

I.10 Transfer Mechanism

Select the applicable transfer mechanism.

- ☐ European Commission Adequacy Decision
- ☐ Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs)
- ☐ Binding Corporate Rules (BCRs)
- ☐ Approved Code of Conduct

- ☐ Approved Certification Mechanism
- ☐ Explicit Consent
- ☐ Contract Performance
- ☐ Important Reasons of Public Interest
- ☐ Legal Claims
- ☐ Vital Interests
- ☐ Other Article 49 Derogation

Specify:

I.11 Third-Party Processor Assessment

Has the recipient previously been assessed using ADP's **Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist (Appendix H)**?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Reference Number

I.12 Security Measures

Identify applicable safeguards.

- ☐ Encryption in Transit
- ☐ Encryption at Rest
- ☐ Multi-Factor Authentication
- ☐ Access Control
- ☐ Pseudonymisation
- ☐ Anonymisation
- ☐ Secure Backup
- ☐ Security Monitoring
- ☐ Logging
- ☐ Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

☐ Incident Response Procedures

☐ Business Continuity Measures

☐ Other

I.13 Transfer Impact Assessment

Evaluate whether the destination country may adversely affect the effectiveness of the transfer safeguards.

Assessment Question	Yes	No	Comments
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Adequate legal protections exist	☐	☐	
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Government access appears proportionate	☐	☐	
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Effective judicial remedies exist	☐	☐	
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Independent supervisory authority exists	☐	☐	
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Recipient can comply with SCC obligations	☐	☐	
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No conflicting legislation identified	☐	☐	
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I.14 Artificial Intelligence Processing

Will transferred personal data be processed by an Artificial Intelligence system?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes:

Assessment Item	Yes	No	Comments
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AI processing disclosed to ADP	☐	☐	
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Human oversight implemented	☐	☐	
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Data used for model training prohibited unless authorized	☐	☐	
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Appropriate contractual safeguards exist	☐	☐	
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AI Risk Assessment completed	☐	☐	
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Responsible AI Policy applies	☐	☐	
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I.15 Risk Assessment

Risk Area	Low	Medium	High	Comments
Privacy Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Confidentiality Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Regulatory Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Cybersecurity Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Human Rights Risk	☐	☐	☐	
AI Governance Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Overall Transfer Risk	☐	☐	☐	

I.16 Additional Safeguards

Select all safeguards implemented.

- ☐ End-to-End Encryption
 - ☐ Customer-Controlled Encryption Keys
 - ☐ Pseudonymisation Before Transfer
 - ☐ Data Minimisation
 - ☐ Split Processing
 - ☐ Contractual Restrictions
 - ☐ Additional Audit Rights
 - ☐ Continuous Monitoring
 - ☐ Annual Review
 - ☐ Technical Access Restrictions
 - ☐ Other
-

Implementation Notes

I.17 Decision

Decision	Selected
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Transfer Approved	☐
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Transfer Approved with Conditions	☐
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Deferred Pending Additional Safeguards	☐
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Transfer Not Approved	☐
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Reason

I.18 Review Schedule

International transfers shall be reviewed:

- annually;
- before contract renewal;
- following significant legislative changes;
- after major cybersecurity incidents;
- when the destination country's legal framework materially changes;
- when the nature or scope of the transfer changes.

Review Activity	Date
-----------------	------

Initial Approval	
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Annual Review	
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Extraordinary Review	
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I.19 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
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Project Manager			
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Information Security Representative			
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Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)			
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Role	Name	Signature	Date
Executive Director			

I.20 Supporting Documentation

Where applicable, attach or reference the following:

- Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs)
 - Data Processing Agreement (DPA)
 - Third-Party Processor Assessment (Appendix H)
 - Data Protection Impact Assessment (Appendix F)
 - Record of Processing Activities (Appendix B)
 - Risk Assessment Report
 - AI Risk Assessment (if applicable)
 - Information Security Assessment
 - Privacy Notice
 - Relevant contractual provisions
 - European Commission Adequacy Decision (if applicable)
-

I.21 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to ensuring that personal data transferred internationally receives a level of protection that is essentially equivalent to that guaranteed under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). International transfers shall only take place where appropriate legal, technical, and organizational safeguards have been implemented and documented.

By conducting this International Data Transfer Assessment prior to transferring personal data across borders, ADP demonstrates its commitment to accountability, risk-based decision-making, transparency, and the protection of the rights and freedoms of Data Subjects. This assessment forms an integral part of ADP's global privacy governance framework and supports responsible international cooperation in research, education, digital innovation, and organizational operations.

Appendix J – Information Asset Register

J.1 Purpose

The Information Asset Register is maintained by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX to identify, document, classify, and manage the information assets that support the organization's activities.

The Register provides a structured inventory of information assets, enabling ADP to:

- protect information appropriately;
- support privacy and information security governance;
- facilitate risk assessments;
- identify asset ownership;
- support business continuity planning;
- demonstrate accountability during audits;
- comply with applicable legal and regulatory requirements.

The Register shall be maintained as a living document and updated whenever significant organizational or technological changes occur.

J.2 Scope

This Register applies to all information assets owned, managed, processed, or controlled by ADP, including:

- electronic information;
- paper records;
- databases;
- cloud services;
- research datasets;
- websites;
- software applications;
- mobile applications;
- digital platforms;
- backup systems;
- Artificial Intelligence systems;
- hardware storing organizational information;
- removable storage media.

J.3 Instructions

Each significant information asset shall be recorded separately.

Information assets should be grouped logically where appropriate while ensuring sufficient detail for risk management and audit purposes.

Each asset shall have a clearly identified owner responsible for its management and protection.

J.4 Information Asset Register

Asset ID	Information Asset	Asset Owner	Department / Project	Asset Type	Information Classification	Storage Location	Primary Purpose	Contains Personal Data	Contains Special Category Data	Criticality	Backup Available	Retention Schedule	Notes
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J.5 Example Register Entries

Field	Example
Asset ID	IA-001
Information Asset	Membership Database
Asset Owner	Executive Director
Department	Administration
Asset Type	Database
Classification	Confidential
Storage Location	Microsoft 365 Cloud
Purpose	Membership Management
Personal Data	Yes
Special Category Data	No
Criticality	High
Backup	Daily
Retention	Appendix A
Notes	Encrypted

Field	Example
Asset ID	IA-002
Information Asset	Human Resources Records
Asset Owner	HR Manager
Department	Human Resources
Asset Type	Electronic & Paper
Classification	Restricted
Storage Location	Secure HR System
Purpose	Employment Administration
Personal Data	Yes
Special Category Data	Yes
Criticality	High
Backup	Daily
Retention	Appendix A
Notes	Role-based access

Field	Example
Asset ID	IA-003
Information Asset	ADP Website
Asset Owner	IT Administrator
Department	Communications
Asset Type	Website
Classification	Internal / Public
Storage Location	Cloud Hosting
Purpose	Public Information
Personal Data	Limited
Special Category Data	No

Field	Example
Criticality	Medium
Backup	Daily
Retention	Operational
Notes	HTTPS Enabled

J.6 Information Asset Categories

Typical information assets may include:

Administrative Assets

- Membership database
 - Volunteer database
 - Board documentation
 - Organizational policies
 - Internal procedures
-

Human Resources Assets

- Personnel files
 - Payroll records
 - Training records
 - Recruitment documentation
-

Financial Assets

- Accounting system
 - Banking records
 - Procurement documentation
 - Grant management files
 - Audit reports
-

Research Assets

- Research datasets

- Survey databases
 - Ethics approvals
 - Research documentation
 - Statistical analysis files
-

Digital Assets

- Websites
 - Mobile applications
 - Cloud storage
 - Learning Management Systems
 - Collaboration platforms
 - Email systems
-

Artificial Intelligence Assets

- AI models
 - AI configuration files
 - AI processing logs
 - AI training datasets
 - Prompt libraries
 - Model evaluation reports
-

Security Assets

- Backup systems
 - Authentication servers
 - Firewall configurations
 - Security monitoring logs
 - Encryption keys (recorded by reference only, never the key material itself)
 - Incident response documentation
-

J.7 Asset Ownership

Each information asset shall have an assigned Asset Owner responsible for:

- ensuring appropriate classification;
- authorizing access;
- approving retention periods;
- supporting risk assessments;
- maintaining asset accuracy;
- reporting significant changes;
- ensuring appropriate disposal.

Ownership does not necessarily imply technical administration but reflects accountability for the information asset.

J.8 Information Classification

Each information asset shall be classified according to **Appendix C – Personal Data Classification Matrix** using one of the following classifications:

- Public
- Internal
- Confidential
- Restricted

Where uncertainty exists, the higher classification level shall be applied until formally reviewed.

J.9 Asset Criticality

Each asset should be assigned a criticality level.

Criticality Description

Low Limited operational impact if unavailable

Medium Moderate operational disruption

High Significant operational impact requiring prompt recovery

Critical Essential for organizational continuity, legal compliance, or protection of individuals

Criticality ratings shall support business continuity planning and disaster recovery priorities.

J.10 Security Controls

For each asset, appropriate security controls should be identified and documented, including:

- access controls;

- encryption;
- authentication mechanisms;
- logging and monitoring;
- backup arrangements;
- disaster recovery procedures;
- vulnerability management;
- antivirus protection;
- physical security measures;
- data loss prevention controls.

Security measures shall be proportionate to the asset's classification and criticality.

J.11 Storage Locations

Storage locations should be recorded, including where applicable:

- on-premises servers;
- cloud service providers;
- Microsoft 365;
- Google Workspace;
- SharePoint;
- OneDrive;
- network-attached storage;
- encrypted portable media;
- paper archives;
- secure off-site storage.

Storage locations shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued compliance with organizational requirements.

J.12 Business Continuity

For each critical information asset, the Register should identify:

- backup frequency;
- recovery priority;
- recovery location;

- responsible recovery personnel;
- dependency on external providers.

Critical assets shall be included within ADP's Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery planning.

J.13 Periodic Review

The Information Asset Register shall be reviewed:

- at least annually;
- before major technology deployments;
- following mergers or organizational restructuring;
- after significant security incidents;
- when introducing new processing activities;
- following implementation of new Artificial Intelligence systems;
- prior to major external audits.

Assets no longer required shall be removed from active inventories following secure disposal procedures.

J.14 Version Control

Updates to the Register shall include:

Version Date Updated By Summary of Changes Approved By

Previous versions shall be retained in accordance with ADP's Records Management procedures.

J.15 Related Documents

This Register should be maintained in conjunction with:

- Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule
- Appendix B – Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)
- Appendix C – Personal Data Classification Matrix
- Appendix F – Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)
- Appendix H – Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist
- Appendix I – International Data Transfer Assessment
- Information Security Risk Register
- Business Continuity Plan

- Incident Response Plan
-

J.16 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that effective governance of information assets is fundamental to privacy protection, information security, operational resilience, and organizational accountability.

Accordingly, ADP is committed to maintaining a comprehensive, accurate, and regularly updated Information Asset Register that identifies the information resources essential to its mission. By assigning clear ownership, applying appropriate classification, documenting security controls, and supporting risk-based management throughout the information lifecycle, ADP strengthens its ability to protect personal data, comply with legal and contractual obligations, and ensure the secure and responsible use of information assets in support of its educational, research, and digital innovation activities.

Appendix K – Privacy Incident Response Workflow

Appendix K – Privacy Incident Response Workflow

K.1 Purpose

The Privacy Incident Response Workflow establishes a structured and repeatable process for identifying, reporting, assessing, containing, investigating, responding to, and recovering from privacy incidents involving personal data processed by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX.

The workflow supports compliance with:

- Articles 33 and 34 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR);
- applicable national data protection legislation;
- ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy;
- ADP's Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy;
- ADP's Incident Management procedures.

The objective is to minimize harm, protect Data Subjects, ensure timely regulatory compliance, and strengthen organizational resilience through continuous improvement.

K.2 Scope

This workflow applies to all actual, suspected, or potential privacy incidents involving personal data processed by ADP, including incidents affecting:

- employees;

- members;
 - volunteers;
 - contractors;
 - research participants;
 - donors;
 - website users;
 - event participants;
 - children and vulnerable persons;
 - third-party processors acting on behalf of ADP.
-

K.3 Definition of a Privacy Incident

A privacy incident is any event that results in, or has the potential to result in:

- unauthorized access to personal data;
- accidental or unlawful disclosure;
- loss of confidentiality;
- destruction of personal data;
- alteration of personal data;
- loss of availability;
- unauthorized processing;
- failure to comply with applicable privacy requirements.

Not every privacy incident constitutes a reportable personal data breach; however, all incidents shall be documented and assessed.

K.4 Privacy Incident Response Workflow

Step 1 – Detection and Identification

The individual discovering a suspected privacy incident shall:

- stop any unsafe activity where possible;
- preserve available evidence;
- avoid deleting logs or records;
- immediately report the incident through the established reporting channel.

Typical sources of detection include:

- employee reports;
 - automated security monitoring;
 - third-party notifications;
 - customer complaints;
 - audit findings;
 - system alerts.
-

Step 2 – Initial Reporting

The incident shall be reported immediately to the designated Privacy Responsible Person, Information Security Representative, or other authorized contact.

The initial report should include, where known:

- date and time of discovery;
- person reporting;
- systems affected;
- description of the incident;
- immediate actions taken.

Where appropriate, the **Personal Data Breach Report Form (Appendix E)** shall be initiated.

Step 3 – Incident Registration

Each reported incident shall be assigned:

- a unique incident reference number;
- date and time of registration;
- responsible coordinator;
- initial priority level;
- preliminary classification.

The incident shall be entered into the Privacy Incident Register.

Step 4 – Initial Assessment

An initial assessment shall determine:

- whether personal data is involved;
- the categories of personal data affected;

- the categories of Data Subjects involved;
 - whether special category personal data is affected;
 - whether children or vulnerable persons are involved;
 - whether the incident is ongoing;
 - whether immediate containment is required.
-

Step 5 – Containment

Appropriate containment measures should be implemented as quickly as possible.

Examples include:

- disabling compromised accounts;
- resetting credentials;
- isolating affected systems;
- suspending data transfers;
- blocking unauthorized access;
- recovering backups;
- notifying relevant internal teams.

Containment activities should be documented.

Step 6 – Investigation

The investigation should determine:

- root cause;
- timeline;
- affected systems;
- number of records affected;
- number of individuals affected;
- data categories involved;
- whether malicious activity occurred;
- whether third parties were involved.

Evidence shall be preserved throughout the investigation.

Step 7 – Risk Assessment

A documented assessment shall evaluate:

- likelihood of harm;
- severity of harm;
- confidentiality impact;
- integrity impact;
- availability impact;
- financial consequences;
- reputational consequences;
- legal consequences;
- impact on vulnerable individuals.

Residual risk shall also be considered after containment.

Step 8 – Regulatory Notification

Where required under Article 33 GDPR, ADP shall notify the competent supervisory authority without undue delay and, where feasible, within **72 hours** after becoming aware of a personal data breach, unless the breach is unlikely to result in a risk to the rights and freedoms of natural persons.

The notification should include:

- nature of the breach;
- categories of personal data;
- approximate number of individuals affected;
- likely consequences;
- mitigation measures taken or proposed;
- contact details for further information.

Where complete information is not immediately available, supplementary information shall be provided as it becomes available.

Step 9 – Communication with Data Subjects

Where the breach is likely to result in a high risk to the rights and freedoms of natural persons, affected Data Subjects shall be informed without undue delay unless an exemption under applicable law applies.

Communications should:

- use clear and plain language;
- explain the nature of the incident;

- describe potential consequences;
 - provide practical recommendations where appropriate;
 - identify ADP contact information;
 - explain measures already taken.
-

Step 10 – Recovery

Recovery activities may include:

- restoring services;
- recovering data;
- validating system integrity;
- removing malicious software;
- strengthening authentication;
- verifying backups;
- monitoring for recurring issues;
- resuming normal operations.

Recovery shall only occur after risks have been appropriately addressed.

Step 11 – Corrective and Preventive Actions

Following recovery, ADP shall identify measures to reduce the likelihood of recurrence.

Examples include:

- policy updates;
- staff training;
- technical improvements;
- enhanced monitoring;
- revised procedures;
- contractual amendments;
- processor reviews;
- additional security controls.

Actions shall be assigned to responsible persons with target completion dates.

Step 12 – Closure and Lessons Learned

An incident shall only be closed when:

- investigation is complete;
- corrective actions have been identified;
- required notifications have been completed;
- documentation has been finalized;
- management approval has been obtained.

A post-incident review should identify lessons learned and opportunities for continuous improvement.

K.5 Incident Priority Matrix

Priority	Description	Expected Response
Critical	Major breach affecting large volumes of personal data or special category data	Immediate response and executive escalation
High	Significant privacy impact requiring urgent containment	Response initiated without delay
Medium	Limited privacy impact with manageable risk	Prompt investigation and mitigation
Low	Minor incident with minimal or no privacy impact	Standard handling and documentation

K.6 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Personnel	Immediately report suspected privacy incidents and preserve evidence
Line Managers	Ensure prompt escalation and support containment efforts
Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)	Coordinate privacy assessment, regulatory notifications, and communication
Information Security Representative	Lead technical investigation and containment activities
Executive Director	Approve significant decisions, allocate resources, and oversee organizational response
Third-Party Processors	Notify ADP of relevant incidents without undue delay and cooperate in investigations

K.7 Documentation Requirements

The following records shall be maintained where applicable:

- Personal Data Breach Report Form (Appendix E);
- Incident investigation records;
- Risk assessments;
- Evidence logs;
- Regulatory correspondence;
- Communications with Data Subjects;
- Corrective action plans;
- Lessons learned reports;
- Closure approvals.

All documentation shall be retained in accordance with **Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule**.

K.8 Testing and Review

ADP should periodically test its Privacy Incident Response Workflow through:

- tabletop exercises;
- incident simulations;
- cybersecurity drills;
- processor notification exercises;
- lessons-learned workshops.

The workflow shall be reviewed:

- at least annually;
 - following any significant privacy incident;
 - after major legislative or regulatory changes;
 - after substantial organizational or technological changes.
-

K.9 Workflow Summary

Phase	Key Activities	Primary Responsibility
Detect	Identify and report suspected incident	All Personnel

Phase	Key Activities	Primary Responsibility
Report	Notify designated contacts and initiate reporting	Discovering Individual / Line Manager
Register	Assign incident reference and log details	Privacy Responsible Person
Assess	Determine scope, impact, and urgency	Privacy & Information Security Representatives
Contain	Limit exposure and prevent further harm	Information Security Representative
Investigate	Identify root cause and affected data	Investigation Team
Evaluate Risk	Assess risks to Data Subjects and compliance obligations	Privacy Responsible Person
Notify	Inform supervisory authority and/or Data Subjects where required	Privacy Responsible Person / Executive Director
Recover	Restore secure operations and validate systems	Information Security Representative
Improve	Implement corrective actions and update controls	Relevant Departments
Close	Approve closure, document lessons learned, and retain records	Executive Director

K.10 Related Documents

This workflow should be implemented in conjunction with:

- Data Protection & Privacy Policy
- Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy
- Appendix E – Personal Data Breach Report Form
- Appendix F – Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)
- Appendix H – Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist
- Appendix I – International Data Transfer Assessment
- Business Continuity Plan
- Disaster Recovery Plan
- Incident Response Plan
- Information Security Risk Register

K.11 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to responding to privacy incidents in a timely, transparent, and accountable manner. By maintaining a structured Privacy Incident Response Workflow, ADP ensures that incidents are managed consistently, risks to Data Subjects are minimized, legal and regulatory obligations are fulfilled, and organizational learning is embedded into future practices. This workflow supports ADP's broader commitment to safeguarding personal data, maintaining stakeholder trust, and fostering a culture of continuous improvement in privacy and information security governance.

Appendix L – Privacy Training Checklist

L.1 Purpose

The Privacy Training Checklist is maintained by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX to plan, document, monitor, and verify privacy and data protection training provided to employees, volunteers, board members, contractors, interns, and other individuals who process personal data on behalf of ADP.

The checklist supports compliance with:

- Article 39 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR);
- applicable national data protection legislation;
- ISO/IEC 27001;
- ISO/IEC 27701;
- ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy;
- ADP's Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy.

The objective is to ensure that all personnel understand their privacy responsibilities and are competent to process personal data securely and lawfully.

L.2 Scope

This checklist applies to all individuals who, as part of their role or engagement with ADP, have access to or process personal data, including:

- employees;
- volunteers;
- interns;
- consultants;
- contractors;
- board members;

- project staff;
- researchers;
- temporary personnel;
- third-party personnel where contractually required.

L.3 Training Record

Field	Information
Training Reference Number	
Participant Name	
Position / Role	
Department / Project	
Trainer	
Training Date	
Training Type	☐ Initial ☐ Refresher ☐ Specialized
Delivery Method	☐ In-person ☐ Online ☐ Hybrid ☐ Self-paced
Duration	
Certificate Issued	☐ Yes ☐ No

L.4 Core Privacy Training Topics

Indicate whether each topic has been completed.

Training Topic	Completed	Date	Comments
Introduction to Data Protection	☐		
GDPR Principles	☐		
Lawful Bases for Processing	☐		
Data Subject Rights	☐		
Confidentiality Obligations	☐		
Secure Handling of Personal Data	☐		

Training Topic	Completed	Date	Comments
Information Classification	☐		
Password and Authentication Practices	☐		
Phishing and Social Engineering Awareness	☐		
Personal Data Breach Reporting	☐		
Data Retention Requirements	☐		
Secure Disposal of Information	☐		
Third-Party Data Sharing	☐		
International Data Transfers	☐		
Privacy by Design and by Default	☐		

L.5 Specialized Training Modules

Complete where relevant to the participant's role.

Module	Applicable	Completed	Comments
Human Resources Privacy	☐	☐	
Research Data Protection	☐	☐	
Children's Personal Data	☐	☐	
Special Category Personal Data	☐	☐	
Financial Information Handling	☐	☐	
Website and Cookie Management	☐	☐	
Cloud Services Security	☐	☐	
Vendor and Processor Management	☐	☐	
Incident Response Procedures	☐	☐	
Artificial Intelligence Governance	☐	☐	
Cybersecurity Awareness	☐	☐	
Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery	☐	☐	

L.6 Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies

Where personnel use or oversee Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems, the following topics should be covered.

AI Training Topic	Completed	Comments
Responsible AI Principles	☐	
Human Oversight Requirements	☐	
AI Bias and Fairness	☐	
Transparency and Explainability	☐	
AI Risk Management	☐	
Protection of Personal Data in AI Systems	☐	
Restrictions on AI Training with Personal Data	☐	
Compliance with ADP Responsible AI Policy	☐	

L.7 Practical Exercises

Indicate practical activities completed during training.

- ☐ Privacy Incident Simulation
 - ☐ Data Breach Reporting Exercise
 - ☐ Phishing Awareness Exercise
 - ☐ Password Management Exercise
 - ☐ Secure File Handling Exercise
 - ☐ Data Classification Exercise
 - ☐ Role-Based Access Review
 - ☐ AI Risk Scenario Exercise
 - ☐ Tabletop Incident Response Exercise
 - ☐ Other
-
-

L.8 Knowledge Assessment

Assessment Item	Result
Quiz Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
Practical Assessment Completed	☐ Yes ☐ No
Minimum Passing Score Achieved	☐ Yes ☐ No
Certificate Issued	☐ Yes ☐ No
Additional Training Required	☐ Yes ☐ No

Assessment Notes

L.9 Participant Declaration

I acknowledge that I have completed the privacy training identified in this record. I understand my responsibilities regarding the lawful, secure, and confidential processing of personal data and agree to comply with ADP's applicable policies and procedures.

Participant Name Signature Date

L.10 Trainer Verification

I confirm that the participant successfully attended the training identified in this record and that the training covered the applicable privacy and data protection requirements relevant to the participant's role.

Trainer Name Signature Date

L.11 Annual Privacy Training Checklist

The following activities should be completed each year.

Activity	Completed	Date	Comments
Annual Privacy Refresher Training	☐		
GDPR Update Session	☐		
Cybersecurity Awareness Training	☐		
Policy Updates Communicated	☐		

Activity	Completed	Date	Comments
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AI Governance Update (if applicable)	☐		
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Incident Response Exercise	☐		
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Third-Party Risk Awareness	☐		
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Records Retention Refresher	☐		
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L.12 Training Effectiveness Review

Training effectiveness should be evaluated through one or more of the following methods:

- participant feedback surveys;
- knowledge assessments;
- practical exercises and simulations;
- observation of workplace practices;
- audit findings;
- incident trend analysis;
- management reviews.

Where deficiencies are identified, corrective actions and additional training shall be provided.

L.13 Training Records Retention

Training records shall be:

- maintained securely;
- protected against unauthorized access or alteration;
- retained in accordance with **Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule**;
- available for internal audits and external compliance reviews where appropriate.

Personal data contained within training records shall be processed in accordance with ADP's Data Protection & Privacy Policy.

L.14 Related Documents

This checklist should be used together with:

- Data Protection & Privacy Policy
- Information Security & Cybersecurity Policy

- Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy
- Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule
- Appendix B – Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)
- Appendix E – Personal Data Breach Report Form
- Appendix K – Privacy Incident Response Workflow
- Information Security Awareness Programme
- Staff Code of Conduct
- Safeguarding & Protection Policy (where applicable)

L.15 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX recognizes that effective privacy protection depends not only on policies and technical safeguards but also on the knowledge, awareness, and competence of the people who process personal data. ADP is therefore committed to providing regular, role-appropriate, and practical privacy training that promotes accountability, ethical conduct, and continuous improvement.

By maintaining this Privacy Training Checklist, ADP demonstrates its commitment to ensuring that all personnel understand their responsibilities, remain informed of evolving legal and technological developments, and contribute to a culture of privacy, information security, and responsible data governance throughout the organization.

Appendix M – GDPR Compliance Self-Assessment Checklist

M.1 Purpose

This GDPR Compliance Self-Assessment Checklist provides the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX with a structured framework for evaluating its compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), applicable national legislation, and internal privacy governance requirements.

The checklist supports:

- continuous compliance monitoring;
- internal audits;
- management reviews;
- risk management;
- corrective action planning;

- organizational accountability.

Completion of this checklist does not replace independent legal advice or regulatory audits but serves as an internal governance tool.

M.2 Scope

This checklist applies to all organizational activities involving the processing of personal data, including:

- governance and accountability;
 - operational processing;
 - research activities;
 - human resources;
 - fundraising;
 - information technology;
 - websites and digital services;
 - Artificial Intelligence systems;
 - third-party processors;
 - international data transfers.
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M.3 Assessment Information

Field	Information
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Assessment Reference Number	
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Assessment Date	
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Assessment Period	
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Department / Project	
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Assessor	
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Next Scheduled Review	
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M.4 Rating Scale

Use the following rating scale for each assessment item.

Rating	Description
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Rating	Description
✓ Compliant	Requirement fully implemented and evidenced
● Partially Compliant	Requirement implemented but improvements required
✗ Not Compliant	Requirement not implemented
N/A	Not applicable

M.5 Governance and Accountability

Assessment Item	✓ ● ✗ N/A Comments
Data Protection & Privacy Policy approved	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Privacy responsibilities assigned	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Management commitment demonstrated	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Privacy governance reviewed annually	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Records of Processing Activities (ROPA) maintained	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Policies communicated to personnel	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

M.6 Lawfulness, Fairness and Transparency

Assessment Item	✓ ● ✗ N/A Comments
Lawful basis identified for all processing	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Privacy notices provided	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Processing purposes clearly defined	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Transparency obligations fulfilled	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Data minimisation applied	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Accuracy procedures established	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

M.7 Data Subject Rights

Assessment Item	✓ ● ✗ N/A Comments
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Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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Procedures for access requests established	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Rectification procedures available	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Erasure requests managed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Restriction procedures implemented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Data portability supported where applicable	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Objection procedures available	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Consent withdrawal process established	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.8 Security Measures

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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Access controls implemented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Encryption used where appropriate	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Multi-Factor Authentication enabled	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Backup procedures documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Incident response procedures established	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Security monitoring implemented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Vulnerability management performed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.9 Data Retention and Disposal

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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Retention schedule maintained	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Retention periods applied consistently	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Secure disposal procedures documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Disposal records maintained	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.10 Third-Party Processors

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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Processor register maintained	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Data Processing Agreements executed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Processor assessments completed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Ongoing processor reviews conducted	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.11 International Data Transfers

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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International transfers identified	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Appropriate transfer mechanism documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Transfer Impact Assessments completed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Additional safeguards implemented where required	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.12 Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIAs)

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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DPIA procedure established	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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High-risk processing identified	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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DPIAs completed before processing begins	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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DPIAs periodically reviewed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.13 Personal Data Breaches

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
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Breach response procedure documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Incident register maintained	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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72-hour notification process established	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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Lessons learned documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
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M.14 Training and Awareness

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
Privacy training completed for relevant personnel	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Annual refresher training conducted	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Specialized training delivered where required	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Training records maintained	☐	☐	☐	☐	

M.15 Artificial Intelligence Governance

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
Responsible AI Policy adopted	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Human oversight implemented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
AI processing documented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
AI risk assessments completed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
AI transparency measures implemented	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Personal data used for AI training appropriately governed	☐	☐	☐	☐	

M.16 Documentation and Records

Assessment Item	✓	●	✗	N/A	Comments
Privacy documentation complete	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Policies under version control	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Records securely retained	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Evidence available for audit	☐	☐	☐	☐	

M.17 Overall Compliance Summary

Area	Status	Priority for Improvement
Governance		
Data Subject Rights		

Area	Status	Priority for Improvement
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Security		
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Retention		
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Third-Party Management		
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International Transfers		
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DPIAs		
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Incident Management		
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Training		
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AI Governance		
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Overall Assessment:

☐ Fully Compliant

☐ Largely Compliant

☐ Partially Compliant

☐ Significant Improvements Required

Summary Comments:

M.18 Corrective Action Plan

Finding	Action Required	Responsible Person	Target Date	Status
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M.19 Management Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
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Assessor			
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Privacy Responsible Person / DPO (if appointed)			
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Executive Director			
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M.20 Review Frequency

This self-assessment should be completed:

- at least annually;
- prior to major external audits;
- before implementing significant new processing activities;
- following major legislative or regulatory changes;
- after significant personal data breaches;
- following substantial organizational or technological changes.

Where deficiencies are identified, corrective actions shall be documented, assigned, and monitored until completion.

M.21 Related Documents

This checklist should be used together with:

- Data Protection & Privacy Policy
 - Appendix A – Personal Data Retention Schedule
 - Appendix B – Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)
 - Appendix C – Personal Data Classification Matrix
 - Appendix E – Personal Data Breach Report Form
 - Appendix F – Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)
 - Appendix G – Consent Register
 - Appendix H – Third-Party Processor Assessment Checklist
 - Appendix I – International Data Transfer Assessment
 - Appendix J – Information Asset Register
 - Appendix K – Privacy Incident Response Workflow
 - Appendix L – Privacy Training Checklist
 - Information Security Risk Register
 - Internal Audit Programme
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M.22 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to maintaining a culture of continuous improvement in privacy governance and regulatory compliance. Through regular self-assessments, ADP evaluates the effectiveness of its policies, procedures, technical controls, and organizational

measures to ensure ongoing alignment with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and other applicable legal and ethical standards.

This GDPR Compliance Self-Assessment Checklist provides a practical mechanism for identifying strengths, addressing compliance gaps, and supporting informed decision-making. By embedding periodic self-evaluation into its governance framework, ADP reinforces accountability, enhances organizational resilience, and demonstrates its commitment to protecting the rights and freedoms of all individuals whose personal data it processes.

Appendix N – Glossary of Terms and Acronyms

N.1 Purpose

This Glossary of Terms and Acronyms provides definitions of key concepts, terminology, and abbreviations used throughout the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX Data Protection & Privacy Policy and its associated appendices.

The glossary promotes a common understanding of privacy, information security, and data protection terminology and supports the consistent interpretation and implementation of ADP's governance framework.

Where definitions in applicable legislation differ from those presented here, the legal definitions shall prevail.

N.2 Glossary of Terms

Term	Definition
Access Control	Measures that ensure only authorized individuals can access information, systems, or resources.
Accountability	The obligation to demonstrate compliance with applicable privacy and data protection requirements.
Anonymisation	The irreversible process of removing identifying information so that an individual can no longer be identified, directly or indirectly.
Artificial Intelligence (AI)	A machine-based system capable of performing tasks that normally require human intelligence, including learning, reasoning, prediction, classification, or decision support.
Authentication	The process of verifying the identity of a user, device, or system before granting access.
Availability	The property that information is accessible and usable when required by authorized users.

Term	Definition
Business Continuity	The capability of an organization to continue delivering critical services during and after disruptive events.
Confidentiality	The principle that information is accessible only to authorized persons or entities.
Consent	A freely given, specific, informed, and unambiguous indication of a Data Subject's wishes by which they signify agreement to the processing of their personal data.
Controller	The natural or legal person that determines the purposes and means of processing personal data.
Cookies	Small text files stored on a user's device to support website functionality, analytics, or user preferences.
Cybersecurity	The practice of protecting systems, networks, devices, and information from cyber threats and unauthorized access.
Data Breach	A security incident resulting in the accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration, unauthorized disclosure of, or access to personal data.
Data Minimisation	Processing only the personal data that is adequate, relevant, and limited to what is necessary for the intended purpose.
Data Portability	The right of a Data Subject to receive personal data in a structured, commonly used, and machine-readable format and to transmit that data to another controller where applicable.
Data Processor	A natural or legal person that processes personal data on behalf of the Controller.
Data Protection	The legal and organizational framework for safeguarding personal data and protecting the rights and freedoms of individuals.
Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)	A documented assessment of privacy risks associated with processing activities likely to result in a high risk to individuals.
Data Subject	An identified or identifiable natural person whose personal data is processed.
Encryption	The process of converting information into a coded format to prevent unauthorized access.
Information Asset	Information that has value to the organization and requires appropriate protection throughout its lifecycle.
Information Security	The preservation of confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information through appropriate controls.

Term	Definition
Integrity	The property of information being accurate, complete, and protected against unauthorized modification.
Lawful Basis	The legal justification permitting the processing of personal data under applicable law.
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)	An authentication method requiring two or more independent forms of verification before access is granted.
Personal Data	Any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person.
Personal Data Breach	A breach of security leading to accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration, unauthorized disclosure of, or access to personal data.
Privacy by Default	Designing systems so that only the minimum amount of personal data necessary is processed by default.
Privacy by Design	Integrating privacy considerations into the design and development of systems, services, and business processes from the outset.
Processing	Any operation performed on personal data, whether automated or manual, including collection, storage, use, disclosure, and deletion.
Processing Activity	A specific operation or set of operations involving the processing of personal data.
Profiling	Automated processing of personal data to evaluate, analyse, or predict aspects concerning an individual.
Pseudonymisation	Processing personal data so that it can no longer be attributed to a specific individual without additional separately kept information.
Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)	The documented inventory of an organization's personal data processing activities required under Article 30 GDPR, where applicable.
Restricted Data	Information requiring the highest level of protection due to its sensitivity or legal significance.
Retention Period	The length of time personal data is retained before secure deletion or destruction.
Risk Assessment	A systematic process for identifying, analysing, and evaluating risks affecting privacy or information security.
Sensitive Category) Data	(Special Personal Data) Personal data requiring enhanced legal protection under applicable legislation due to its sensitive nature.
Special	Category Personal data revealing racial or ethnic origin, political opinions, religious or

Term	Definition
Personal Data	philosophical beliefs, trade union membership, genetic data, biometric data used for identification, health data, or data concerning a person's sex life or sexual orientation, as defined by Article 9 GDPR.
Third-Party Processor	An external organization processing personal data on behalf of ADP under contractual arrangements.
Transfer Impact Assessment (TIA)	An assessment evaluating whether international transfers of personal data provide an essentially equivalent level of protection as required under GDPR.

N.3 Acronyms

Acronym Meaning

ADP	Association for Digital Progress
AI	Artificial Intelligence
BCR	Binding Corporate Rules
DPA	Data Processing Agreement
DPIA	Data Protection Impact Assessment
DPO	Data Protection Officer
EDPB	European Data Protection Board
EEA	European Economic Area
EU	European Union
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679)
HR	Human Resources
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
IDTA	International Data Transfer Assessment
IP	Internet Protocol
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
MFA	Multi-Factor Authentication
NIS2	Directive (EU) 2022/2555 on measures for a high common level of cybersecurity across the Union

Acronym Meaning

OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
ROPA	Record of Processing Activities
SaaS	Software as a Service
SCC	Standard Contractual Clauses
SOC	System and Organization Controls
TIA	Transfer Impact Assessment
URL	Uniform Resource Locator
VPN	Virtual Private Network

N.4 Interpretation

Unless otherwise required by applicable law:

- singular terms include the plural and vice versa;
- references to persons include natural and legal persons where appropriate;
- references to legislation include amendments, replacements, and successor legislation;
- references to ADP policies include future revisions of those documents.

Where a defined term appears capitalized throughout this Policy, it shall carry the meaning assigned in this Glossary.

N.5 References

The terminology contained in this Glossary is based on internationally recognized standards and guidance, including:

- General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679);
 - European Data Protection Board (EDPB) Guidelines;
 - ISO/IEC 27001 (Information Security Management Systems);
 - ISO/IEC 27701 (Privacy Information Management Systems);
 - ISO/IEC 29100 (Privacy Framework);
 - NIS2 Directive (Directive (EU) 2022/2555);
 - OECD Privacy Guidelines.
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N.6 Maintenance of the Glossary

This Glossary shall be reviewed:

- at least annually;
- following amendments to applicable legislation;
- after significant revisions to ADP policies;
- when new technologies, processing activities, or legal concepts require additional terminology.

Obsolete terms shall be removed or revised, and newly adopted terminology shall be incorporated to ensure consistency across ADP's governance documentation.

N.7 Organizational Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to promoting a consistent and accurate understanding of privacy, data protection, and information security terminology throughout the organization. By maintaining this Glossary of Terms and Acronyms, ADP supports clear communication, effective policy implementation, informed decision-making, and a shared understanding of legal and technical concepts among its personnel, volunteers, partners, and stakeholders.

This Glossary forms an integral part of ADP's privacy governance framework and contributes to the organization's commitment to transparency, accountability, and the responsible management of personal data in accordance with internationally recognized standards and applicable legal requirements.
